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THE
LIGHT OF EGYPT
OR
THE SCIENCE OF THE SOUL AND THE STARS
IN TWO PARTS

BY

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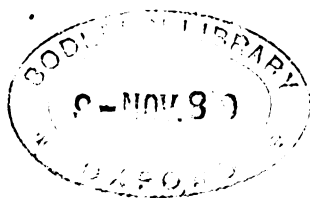
"Write the things *which thou hast seen*, and the things which are,
and the things which shall be hereafter; THE MYSTERY OF THE
SEVEN STARS — which thou sawest in my right hand."

--*Revelations*, Chap. I., V. 19 and 20.

LONDON
GEORGE REDWAY, YORK STREET, COVENT GARDEN
1889

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DEDICATION

TO THE BUDDING SPIRITUALITY OF THE OCCIDENT
AND
THE RISING GENIUS OF THE WESTERN RACE

THIS WORK IS RESPECTFULLY

DEDICATED

By the Author

PREFACE.

The reasons which have induced the writer to undertake the responsibility of presenting a purely occult treatise to the world, are briefly as follows:

For nearly twenty years the writer has been deeply engaged investigating the hidden realms of occult force, and, as the results of these mystical labors were considered to be of great value and real worth by a few personal acquaintances who were also seeking light, he was finally induced to condense, as far as practicable, the general results of these researches into a series of lessons for private occult study. This idea was ultimately carried out and put into external form; the whole, when completed, presenting the dual aspects of occult lore as seen and realized in the soul and the stars, corresponding to the microcosm and the macrocosm of ancient Egypt and Chaldea, and thus giving a brief epitome of Hermetic philosophy.*

Having served their original purpose, external circumstances have compelled their preparation for a much wider circle of minds. The chief reason urging to this step was the strenuous efforts now being systematically put forth to poison the budding spirituality of the western mind, and to fasten upon its mediumistic mentality, the subtle, delusive dogmas of Karma and Re-incarnation, as taught by the sacerdotalisms of the decaying Orient.

*The term Hermetic is here used in its true sense of sealed or secret.

From the foregoing statement it will be seen that this work is issued with a definite purpose, namely, to explain the true spiritual connection between God and man, the soul and the stars, and to reveal the real truths of both Karma and Re-incarnation as they actually exist in nature, stripped of all priestly interpretation. The definite statements made in regard to these subjects are absolute facts, in so far as embodied man can understand them through the symbolism of human language, and the writer defies contradiction by any living authority who possesses the spiritual right to say, "I know."

During these twenty years of personal intercourse with the exalted minds of those who constitute the brethren of light, the fact was revealed that long ages ago the Orient had lost the use of the true spiritual compass of the soul, as well as the real secrets of its own theosophy. As a race, they have been, and still are, traveling the descending arc of this racial cycle, whereas the western race have been slowly working their way upward through matter upon the ascending arc. Already it has reached the equator of its mental and spiritual development. Therefore the writer does not fear the ultimate results of the occult knowledge put forth in the present work, during this, the great mental crisis of the race.

Having explained the actual causes which impelled the writer to undertake this responsibility, it is also necessary to state most emphatically that he does not wish to convey the impression to the reader's mind that the Orient is destitute of spiritual truth. On the contrary, every genuine

student of occult lore is justly proud of the snow white locks of old Hindustan, and thoroughly appreciates the wondrous stores of mystical knowledge concealed within the astral vortices of the Hindu branch of the Aryan race. In India, probably more than in any other country, are the latent forces and mysteries of nature the subject of thought and study. But alas! it is not a progressive study. The descending arc of this spiritual force keeps them bound to the dogmas, traditions and externalisms of the decaying past, whose real secrets they cannot now penetrate. The ever living truths concealed beneath the symbols in the astral light are hidden from this view by the setting sun of their spiritual cycle. Therefore, the writer only desires to impress upon the reader's candid mind, the fact that his earnest effort is to expose that particular section of Buddhistic Theosophy (esoteric so called) that would fasten the cramping shackles of theological dogma upon the rising genius of the western race. It is the delusive Oriental systems against which his efforts are directed, and not the race nor the mediumistic individuals who uphold and support them; for "*omnia vincit veritas*" is the life motto of

THE AUTHOR.

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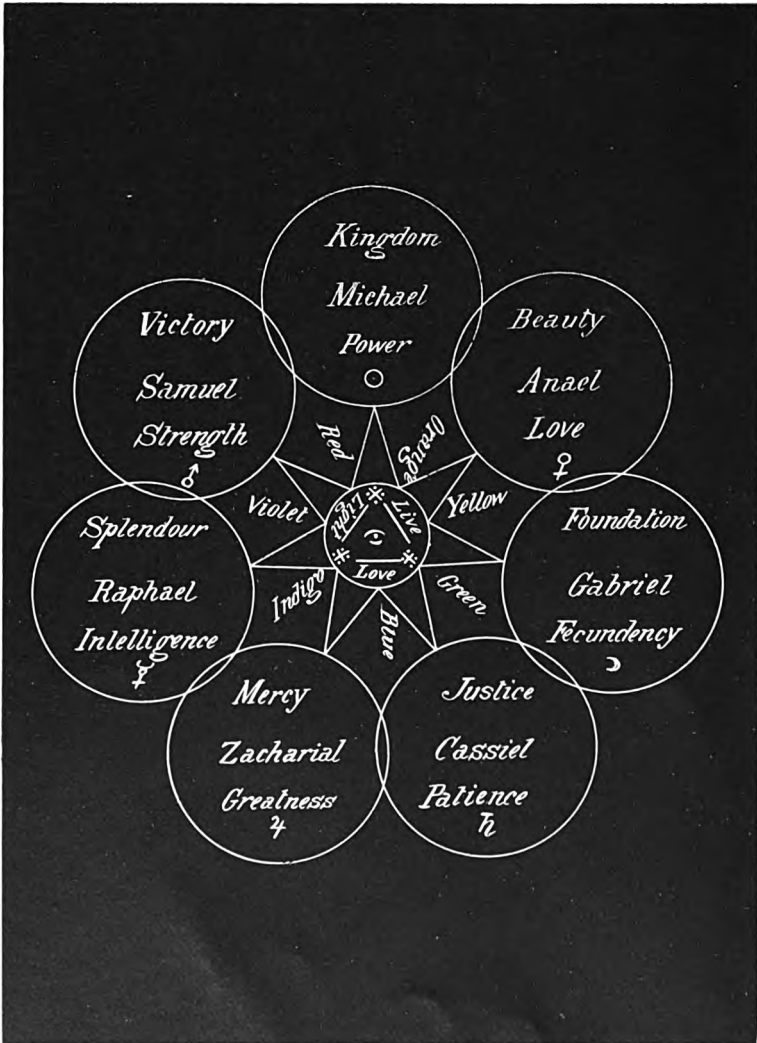
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THE REALM OF SPIRIT.



"IN THE BEGINNING WAS THE WORD,
AND THE WORD WAS WITH GOD,
AND THE WORD WAS GOD."—St. John, Chap. I, vi.

PART I.

INTRODUCTION.

At the very first step the student takes into the hidden pathway of nature's mysteries, he is met face to face with this startling fact, that all his preconceptions, all his education, all his accumulation of materialistic wisdom are unavailable to account for the most simple phenomena that transpire in the action and inter-action of the life forces of the planet on which he lives. As a chemist, he may pursue the atoms of force until they become lost within the realms of the imponderable, "the great unknown," or, as it has been facetiously christened amid the groans of scientific travail, "the aching void." But he can get no farther. As a physicist, he may decompose light and sound into their component parts, and, with scientific accuracy, dissect them before your very eyes as a surgeon would his anatomical subject. But no sooner is this point reached, than the shy molecules and timid vibrations become alarmed as it were at man's daring presumption, and fly into the realm of the infinite unknown. There, in "the aching void" to sport in delight, safe from man's intrusion. This realm of the unknown imponderables is the universal ether, an infinite ocean of something, which science created in her frantic endeavors to account for the material phenomena of light and heat, and for a time she was infinitely pleased with

her own peculiar offspring. But it has now become a restless phantom, a grim, unlovely spectre, which haunts the laboratories of her parent, night and day, until at last science has become frightened at her own child, and tries now in vain to slay the ghost of her own creation. She dares not enter the "aching void" she has called into existence, and there pursue and recapture the truant atoms and timid vibrations of this sublunary sphere.

Therefore, at the very outset of his pilgrimage through these vast and as yet "scientifically unknown" regions, the student had better unload, so to say, all the heavy and useless baggage of educated opinion and scientific dogmas that he may have on board. If he does not, he will find himself top heavy, and will either capsize or run off the track and be buried amid the debris of conflicting opinions. The only equipment that will be found useful, and will repay the cost of transportation, is an unbiased mind, logical reasoning, genuine common sense, and a calm, reflective brain. Anything else for the voyage upon which we are now about to embark, is simply so much useless, costly lumber. Hence, so far as modern science and theology are concerned, the less the student has the better it is for him, unless he can use his scientific acquirements merely as aids in climbing the spiritual steps of Occultism. If he can do this, then he will find science a most valuable auxiliary force. But this achievement is an exceedingly rare gift, and one that is seldom found. It is also a most delusive snare, because nine out of every ten seriously cheat themselves into the belief that they possess this ability, whereas in reality they are

woefully deficient. Hence it is always a safe course to mistrust the absolute impartiality of our opinions and reasoning.

Before starting out on such a mighty and important undertaking, we must draw the reader's attention to the chief obstacle of the voyage, and the one which he will have the greatest difficulty in surmounting. This hidden rock, upon which so many otherwise profound students of the Occult have become shipwrecked, is the non-realization of the duality of truth, viz., the truth of appearances, and the truth of realities. The former is relative only. But the latter is absolute.*

If we possess half of anything, we know by the laws of common sense and logical reasoning that there is another half somewhere. No subtle twist of metaphysical sophistry can cheat us into the belief that we possess the whole when we know and see that we have just exactly half and no more. Further, when we look at any known thing we know that to possess the attributes of a thing it must possess three dimensions, viz.: length, breadth and thickness. This being so, we also know that it has (broadly speaking) two sides, an outside and an inside. The outside is not the inside any more than the boiler is the steam which drives the engine. This logical process of reasoning is the only chart that has so far been prepared for the Occult explorer. It is vague and probably very unsatisfactory, so far as details are concerned, but when used in conjunction with his conscious intuition—the only true compass man

*We do not mean merely taking for granted that truth is dual and so assenting to the statement; but we mean that the great majority of Occult students *fail to realize* this conception *within themselves*.

has by which to guide him in his winding, uneven pathway upon the shores of the Infinite—he never need fear being lost or failing in his endeavors to know the truth.

In order to carry out the same line of reasoning a little further, let us take a type of architecture, say the Gothic, and mentally examine some well known handsome specimen of this structural conception. The world's thought will say, "what a beautiful building ; how imposing and grand ; what a triumph of man's mechanical skill !" So it appears, and upon the plane of appearances, so it really is. Consequently it is a truth for the time being (so far as it goes). But when examined by the light of Occult science, we find this truth is only relative, that it is only true upon the external, transitory plane of material phenomena. We see that, in addition to being the result of man's trained mechanical ability, it is also the external form of his mental ideal. It is, in fact, the phenomenal outcome of his creative attributes. When we look at the solid building, from the earth's plane, we see only the outside of a thing having length, breadth and thickness. Now since we know that there must be an inside, we must enter the interior plane before we can see it, and therein we shall find that it exists within the subjective world of its architect. The solid stone edifice will, in time, crumble to decay, fall, and finally not one material atom will remain to indicate the place whereon it stood. Hence it is not real, it is only a passing appearance assumed by matter under the moulding forces of man's mechanical ability. As soon as the forces which gave it form become polarized by the restless oceans of planetary

magnetism, it will dissolve and finally vanish "like the baseless fabric of a dream." But though the external structure of stone and mortar is lost within the realms of "the great unknown," the idea which created it is eternal, because it was a spiritual reality. Therefore, we see that the absolute truth (the reality) upon the plane of matter appears to be the non-reality; while the true non-reality appears to be the only thing which is real. It is these delusive appearances that have created the almost hopeless confusion regarding the exact meaning of the terms "Spirit" and "Matter." Science refers all she cannot grapple with to some of the undiscovered forces of "Matter," while theology refers all that she cannot explain to the unknowable workings of the "Spirit." Both are right, and both are wrong. And as we shall have to explore the territory belonging to both of these terms during the progress of our journey, we will in this place briefly add that spirit and matter, as we know them, are but the dual expression of the one Deific principle, due to differences of polarity. In other words, a unity under two modes of action. This duality can only be comprehended in its true relationship when viewed from both planes and realized by the science of correspondences, which science is but a material system of symbolism from which we can justly regulate our conceptions of *all* things.

Plato once said, "Ideas rule the world." So far Plato was right; for, before the divine idea was evolved from within the divine sensorium of the Infinite One, the universe was not. Hence the result of the divine idea was the evolution of a pure symbolic form.

Just as symbols are the product of ideas, so, in their turn, ideas are the symbols of thought, and thought itself is but the symbolic response of the Ego to the pulsating throb of the Deific will, the divine radiant soul of the Infinite One. Back of this we cannot penetrate, even in our most exalted conceptions. Hence all serious study and meditation as to the nature and existence of God are unprofitable, and cannot bring the student any substantial return either in this world or the next, seeing that the Infinite can never be comprehended by the finite. Therefore we must rest satisfied with the certain knowledge that we can by one grand chain of sequences trace the transmission of thoughts, ideas and symbolic forms to their source.

Thus the angelic world is but a prototype or symbolic expression of the divine sphere of the Infinite. The celestial world is a reflection of the angelic. The spiritual world is a prototype and symbolic outcome of the celestial heavens. The astral is the reflection of the spiritual sphere. And, lastly, the material is but the concrete shadow of the astral kingdoms.

Hence the reader can perceive that we, in our present state, are a long way down in the scale of creative life. But if we are, we know by the laws of our being that we can and shall win our way back through this valley of the shadow, this plane of inverted images and delusive appearances, into the bright realms of our former state, those spheres of pure angelic life where alone exist the ever living reals of all the infinitude of apparent realities.

SECTION I.

CHAPTER I.

THE REALM OF SPIRIT.

(*Involution.*)

“Being, Uncreated, Eternal, Alone,” says Dr. John Young, when speaking of “the Creator and the creation,” and certainly no inspired writer ever penned a more sublime truth than is contained in the above words.

Pure spirit, *per se*, is diffusive, non atomic, uncreated, formless, self-existent being. Silent, motionless, unconscious, Divinity; possessing in its sublime purity the one sole Deific attribute expressible in human language as absolute and unconditioned potentiality.

Such is the realm of spirit, which, for the sake of linguistic convenience, has been termed by the Occultist “the realm of unmanifested being.” With the first emanation of this inconceivable state we have now to deal. The Kabbalah contains long and elaborate treatises upon the various emanations of the ten sephiroth, which for the most part are written in such an allegorical style as to be practically useless to most Western students, and even to Oriental minds are unsatisfactory, and in many respects misleading. The first emanation from this realm of formless being claims the student’s closest attention. It forms the Deific key note of

the divine anthem of creation. This first emanation, called by Kabbalists the Crown, means, when stripped of its mystical veil, simple and naked activity or motion. Thus we see that the first action of the unconscious mind is thought, and thought implies vibration or motion. At the moment the Deific mind vibrates with thought there springs forth, from the infinite womb of divinity, the duad of all future greatness. This duad is the Kabbalistical twins, "Love and Wisdom," which, in turn, mean the attributes attraction, repulsion, of force and motion. They are male and female, co-equal and co-eternal, and express themselves externally as activity and repose. No matter how recondite or abstruse our speculations may be, when the orbit of our metaphysical meditation is complete we shall find ourselves face to face again with our original starting point, which is this infinite triad of Love, Wisdom and Crown, or, in other words, the one primal force containing unlimited potentialities within itself. With this divine trinity or Godhead we, as students and investigators of nature's occult mysteries, must rest contented, consoling ourselves, whenever necessary, with the certain knowledge that the nearer we appear to approach the great white throne of the Infinite, the further does that divine center recede from us. If this were not so, there could be no such thing as eternity for the atoms of differentiated life. Consequently the immortality of the soul would be an empty dream, a mere figment, hatched by some infernal power within the overheated imagination of poor deluded man.

Before going further the reader should commit to mem-

ory the following primary doctrines, taught by the Occult initiates of all true wisdom. They are doctrines to us in our present state, in so far that we cannot demonstrate them externally by any known form of experiment.

I. "The whole universe is filled with the Deific presence of God." That is to say, the universe is permeated with the pure, motionless, formless spirit of Divinity.

II. "The universe is boundless and unlimited, a circle whose circumference is everywhere and whose centre is nowhere." That is to say, the universe is dual and consists of the manifest and the non-manifest. Hence Deity is progressive in his infinite scheme of spiritual enfoldment.

III. "The divine one life principle emanates from the pure vortices, the central spiritual Sun of the manifested universe. From this mighty inconceivable center of life emanate the spiritual rays of the Father, scintillating with the divine activity, whereupon the vast, motionless void, the awful universe of God's silent, formless spirit becomes alive with an infinite number of subordinate universes." That is to say, the rays of Divinity at various points in space are brought to a focus. These points or foci form the spiritual centers of smaller universes. An example of this can be seen upon our material plane by observing that primary suns throw off a series of secondary suns. These secondary suns throw off planets, and the planets become the parents of moons. By the science of correspondence, "as it is above, so it is below." Remember these facts.

The divine purpose of creation is the differentiation of the unconscious formless one, and the grand outcome of

this divine purpose is the ultimation of Deific intelligencies; separate minds reflecting the divine idea of the universal mind, conscious, individualized mentalities possessing immortal souls capable of eternal progression, who, as differentiated life atoms of the Creator—the grand Arbiter of the whole—become themselves secondary creators and the arbiters of the destinies of worlds.

The processes of creation are dual, and consist of Involution and Evolution. The one is inseparable from the other. Paradoxical as it may appear to the uninitiated, it is, nevertheless, a divine truth that the Evolution and ultimation of spiritual life is accomplished by a strict process of Involution; from the without to the within, from the infinitely great to the infinitely small.

To better understand this mystery we must have recourse to a series of symbols. Accordingly, we conceive the divine focus of the primal essence as the spiritual center of a universe. This Deific ray constitutes a triune God-head, from which emanates the pure white light of the formless one, or, in other words, this center constitutes a realm of sephiroth, a sun-sphere of living potentialities, divine beings infinitely beyond the highest archangelhood. As such we may conceive it floating as a speck in the infinite ocean of divine love, surrounded by the effulgent brightness of the nameless Crown. This divine sphere is passive in such a state. Nirvana reigns upon the blissful radiance of its motionless bosom. But the time now approaches when its mission in the scheme of creation must commence. The moment arrives, and as soon as the first creative pulsations

of thought vibrate the whole sphere of motionless, formless light flashes forth sparkling with living energy. And now, behold what a change has taken place! The soft, white light has ceased to be and in its place there is raying forth in every conceivable direction mighty oceans of force; each ocean differing in velocity, color and potentiality. The passive has become active, and the motionless has commenced to move, traversing the void of space upon the wings of light. Deity has become refracted; a portion of the infinite soul decomposed, and its original unlimited potentialities resolved into a series of active but limited attributes. This is related in the mystical language of the Kabbalah as the evolution of seven active sephiroth from the first trinity, Love, Wisdom and Crown. It is these seven active sephiroth that constitute the seven principles of nature. They form seven points or sub-centers around their parent center, the spiritual Sun, and are the seven states of angelic life from whose divine matrix issue all the life atoms of their universe.

From the foregoing the reader will see, that when the dawn of any universe commences, the pure formless essence is indrawn, previous to being involved by the deific will of the angelic hierarchies, from the realms of the unmanifested into their sun-sphere of creative life, and by such contact it immediately undergoes a change. It is formless no longer but atomic, and endowed with an attribute or state it had not before, viz., polarity. This polarity at once evolves a sort of partnership, and equally divides the formless substance into two parts, each a necessary attendant upon the

other in manifested existence. One is positive, the other, of course, negative. The positive ray is that which constitutes the living spiritual fire of all things, and its atoms are infinitely fine. The negative ray is ever tending toward a state of repose or inertia, and its atoms are coarse and loose as compared with those of the positive ray. It is the substance formed by the negative ray that constitutes every species of matter, so called, from the inconceivably fine etherealized substance, which composes the forms of the divine archangels of the sun, down to the mineral veins of dense metal.

Therefore, when speaking broadly of spirit and matter, the terms are perfectly unmeaning in an occult sense, for that which we call spirit is not pure spirit, but only the positive or acting attribute of that which we term matter. Hence matter is so far unreal, it is only an appearance produced by the negative ray, and this appearance is the result of polarity or mode of motion; one is straight and penetrating, the other is round and enfolding.

With this brief but necessary digression we resume. From the seven angelic states before mentioned, spiritual involution commences. Each one of the seven spheres is a reflection of one of the seven refracted principles, which constitute the divine mind of the angelic creators. From this reflection spring forth angelic races, second only in mental power and potentiality to their parents. Then, in turn, are produced still lower celestial states, each state or sphere corresponding in nature, color and attribute to the sphere from which it was born or reflected. But though

each state in the descending scale is similar by correspondence, it becomes less in size, more material; the spiritual potencies of its angelic races are weaker, that is, less active, because they are more and more involved within matter as they descend in the scale. Thus does involution proceed ; involving state after state, and sphere after sphere, forming a series of circles whose line of motion or descent is not in the plane of its orbit ; hence the form ultimates itself as a spiral until the lowest point is reached. Beyond this motion is impossible, and the infinitely great has become the infinitely small. This is the great polarizing point from which the material world is reflected. It is the lowest possible spiritual state of life, which formed the first ethereal race of human beings upon our planet, and thus ushered into existence the famous golden age of mythological celebrity.

EXPLANATION OF THE DIAGRAM.

The central triad represents Love, Wisdom and Crown. The seven-pointed star, the seven rays issuing therefrom. The seven circles show the seven angelic worlds formed from the seven active principles. The names Cassiel, Michael, etc., are cabalistical ones for the sephiroth, while the words above and below show their attributes.

CHAPTER II.

THE REALM OF MATTER.

The term evolution is from the Latin *e* and *volvo*, which means to roll from, or unroll, and the evolution of matter means precisely what the term implies, viz., unfolding, expanding, opening and evolving. The whole of which can be summed up in the word progressive.

Matter *per se* is the polar opposite of manifested spirit. It is the reaction of spiritual action. It is energy in a state of rest. It is force and motion in an exact state of equilibrium: in short, matter simply means solidified spirit. When two imponderable forces equal each other, both powers become polarized, force is resolved into inertia, motion is transformed into rest; in other words, spirit becomes matter, its refinement or its density depending upon its degree of etherealization.

The progression and ultimatum of the life forces latent within matter, must be accomplished by a process of unfoldment. The potentialities, in order to expand and put forth their infinite possibilities, must EVOLVE, and this is so, because they have become incarnated by the opposite forces of enfoldment. But having become involved in the degradation of the material, by the fall, and cast into "the bottomless pit" or crystallizing point in space, the only possible means of return to the original pure spiritual state is through the progressive cyclic pathways of material unfoldment.

The evolution of matter, like everything else within the realms of manifested existence, must have some point of commencement. If matter is, as previously stated, but the manifestation of spirit—the negative ray externalized and in a state of crystallized inertia—then matter must be the first offspring of spirit, and both combined must comprise the all of all things, yea, even Deity itself; for an infinite creator cannot get beyond his creation, nor exist apart from himself, because the great law of polar opposites is the direct emanation from his own divine nature. Consequently, He must also be governed by the self same laws and principles which control his creative activities, and when traced to their source we have seen how beautifully simple such primal laws are, viz., “Love and Wisdom,” and, convertibly, male-female, positive-negative, activity-repose. Briefly stated there is but one law, one principle, one agent and one word. This sacred law is SEX, a term wherein may be summed up the grand totalities of the Infinite Universe.

Sex is dual, and finds expression in the *yohmi* and *phallus* of animated nature. This same sexual law operating throughout nature limits the sources from which our knowledge of nature can be obtained; in other words, there are but two sources from which knowledge of any kind is received: one is subjective, the other objective: the former gives us knowledge of the spiritual or causal side of the cosmos, the latter the material side, which is the world of effects, on account of its being evolved out of the former, as the poet hath said:

“The outward doth from the inward roll,
And the inward dwells in the inmost soul.”

The great first cause has evolved out of himself the esoteric, or subjective world; and out of the subjective, by a simple change of polarity, which at once brings forth a change of energy and substance, he has evolved the objective world. Therefore the antecedents of the objective are to be found in the subjective.

We have now completed the cyclic outline of our present research, and, as a result, we know that the point of commencement in material evolution which we have thus far been seeking, lies hidden within the realms of spirit, of which realm we have already spoken.*

In order to clearly comprehend nature's processes in the unfoldment of matter, a careful study of the seven creative principles is very necessary, not studied as so many intelligencies or states of conscious life, but as seven principles or forces, which, though unconscious and blind in their activities throughout their different spheres of operation, yet act strictly in harmony with each other as the refracted parts of a whole, fulfilling the creative design. These seven principles are not in themselves intelligent, but are simply powers directed by intelligence, just as the electric current is a power which, when governed by intelligence, becomes a medium for the expression of that intelligence and capable of transmitting its master's thoughts and desires, instantaneously, to any part of the globe that has been prepared to receive them. The intelligence which directs these powers by the laws of harmony are the seven angelic worlds mentioned in the previous chapter, and as

*See Chapter I—The Involution of Spirit.

they are a perfect epitome of the divine law, it necessarily follows that the objective world of matter must be a perfect epitome—a solidified expression of its progenitors, and must contain within itself the latent attributes of the whole.

Powers, like individuals, are limited in their activities. Before any force can manifest itself it must have some point of contact or rapport at the point or place of manifestation, or, as stated in the above illustration of the electric current, the place and object of such phenomena must have been prepared for the expression of such power. Hence the necessity (if we may use such a term) of the objective world being a perfect epitome of and containing the latent attributes of the higher and more interior worlds of cause. If this were not so the perfect evolution of matter would be an impossibility, because no subjective power, state or principle can act or react upon an objective form unless a portion of itself lies within that form. We must carry this line of reasoning a little further.

Man, in his physical body, is a perfect epitome of the planet upon which he lives, while the celestial worlds find their perfect expression in his soul, and these worlds, in turn, are but the higher and more interior expression not only of man's physical organism, but of the planet which gave it birth. We see, therefore, how beautifully harmonious mother nature is, even in her most secret parts. She has made every known "thing" dependent upon a something else, and all things, therefore, are mutually dependent upon each other. Evolution is dependent upon involution; the objective upon the subjective, and man dependent upon

the planet. All contain the same eternal seven principles; the subjective, in its imponderable essences; the objective, in its solids, fluids and gases; and man, as the spirito-natural medium and meeting point between the two great worlds, treasures up the seven mineral qualities in his body and their magnetic counterparts in the odylic sphere of his soul. In this recondite sense alone can we fully understand the occult axiom of the ancients: "Man is a microcosm—a universe within himself."

The seven principles of nature correspond in their chemical affinities to the seven prismatic rays of the solar spectrum, and also present a perfect correspondence to the seven progressive states of manifestation, which have been very appropriately termed the "The Life Waves." It is these waves of the cosmic life energies that carry out the grand ascending scale of material evolution.

When a "wave" commences, its evolutionary activities at once set in motion a series of responsive vibrations within that realm of force which forms its material correspondence, and thus acting and reacting upon each other like the ebb and flow of the tides, another scene in the sublime drama of external life is enacted. These waves, seven in number, succeed each other in the following order :

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|---|-----|--------------------|
| I.—The Spiritual or realm of creation, symbolical of | - | <i>The Word</i> |
| II.—The Astral or realm of design, symbolical of | - - | <i>The Idea</i> |
| III.—The Aerial or realm of force, symbolical of | - - | <i>The Power</i> |
| IV.—The Mineral or realm of phenomena, symbolical of | - | <i>The Justice</i> |
| V.—The Vegetable or realm of "life," symbolical of | - | <i>The Beauty</i> |
| VI.—The Animal or realm of consciousness, symbolical of | - | <i>The Love</i> |
| VII.—The Human or realm of mind, symbolical of | - - | <i>The Glory</i> |

The student will form a clearer idea of these mighty principles, if we travel over the same ground again in an explanatory manner :

I. The world of creation signifies the angelic world from which the original impulse first emanated. This spiritual impulse travels the whole of the future orbit of the "system" about to be evolved, and prepares the spaces for the reception and manifestation of a less ethereal force.

II. The world of design is the subjective cause-world in the astral light, containing all the germs, forms and ideals possible for that system to ultimate.

III. The world of force is the ever circulating oceans of mundane, sub-mundane, and super-mundane forces, with which "science" is only just becoming acquainted in the forms of light, heat, magnetism, universal ether, etc.

IV. The world of phenomena needs no explanation, it being the world of matter.

V. The world of life is the fluidic, the first forms of all things, that is, organic forms "wherein there is life" are vegetables, and originate in water, the grand matrix.

VI. The world of consciousness. The first rudimentary expression of consciousness, generally termed instinct, manifests itself in the animal kingdom. It is intelligent *mind* expressing itself through the lower forms of etherealized matter.

VII. The world of mind contains the human principle, Man being the culminating point of material evolution. In this realm the mind begins once more to assert its supremacy over matter, life conquers death: hence the very significant

symbol of the Kabbalah, which terms this state "The Glory."

The processes of ultimation by the means of involution and evolution are inversely related to each other: the former is the original action, the latter is only the reaction — a necessary consequence of the former.

Before attempting to explain those occult processes connected with the evolution of matter, which are silently at work within the unseen womb of nature producing the endless series of causes, the activities of which externalize themselves in an infinite variety of forms, it is necessary to briefly review the ideas expressed in chapter I. "The Involution of Spirit," wherein we pointed out that, originally, our solar system was "without form and void," (Genesis I. 2.), that is to say it had no material objective shape ; that, previous to its external manifestation, it must have existed subjectively as an ideal form; and that this ideal form is but the symbolic expression of the ethereal forces projected during the evolution of thought. This is as far as we are permitted to go along the line of actual spiritual facts. But, in carrying out the same chain of reasoning, we are led to the conclusion that if we could only penetrate, even for a single moment, the sacred adytum of Nature's greatest of all mysteries, we should find that even thought itself was only due to the throbbing pulsations of the soul, and that these pulsations, in their turn, were but the sympathetic response — the expansion and contraction—of the spiritual respiration in harmonious obedience to the action and reaction of its divine Ego.

The primary ideas which we derive from Chapter I. are as follows : I. That the macrocosm is the objective image of the divine subjective idea, and the microcosm a reflection of the macrocosm. II. That the former, as a whole, is essentially without form, not only because it consists of such an infinite variety of forms, but because of the endless succession of progressive manifestations of these forms ; hence, being without essential form, it is unlimited. III. That the latter, though a perfect epitome of the former, is finite, and as such possesses a form as a symbol of its limitations.*

So far we have simply followed out the ideas presented in the chapter upon the Involution of Spirit, upon the descending arc of their manifestation, in order to point out to the reader the realm wherein the final separation of the

*We do not claim any originality for the ideas put forth upon this subject, because they have been known to at least a thousand generations of the Hermetic initiates, in fact the great Hermes Trismegistus himself distinctly says that "The Universe is from God, and man *from* the Universe," which means, the macrocosm is a reflection of Deity, and man an *image* of the macrocosm. It can have no other interpretation.

Neither Pythagoras nor Socrates ever wrote upon the sacred science. They were essentially *thinkers*, in fact the vows of the former to the great hierophants of Egypt prevented him from *externalizing* truth as Plato did. Though Plato was the pupil of Socrates, he gives forth the Pythagorean philosophy in its entirety, in the form of allegory. The only mystery about the matter is, where did Plato's teacher obtain his Pythagorean wisdom ? The only reasonable solution to this query is, to suppose that he obtained it from his attendant dæmon. Our conception of the teachings of Pythagoras and Socrates can only be obtained by a knowledge of the fact that both Plato and Pythagoras *were initiated*—hence Plato simply wrote that which these old sages only *thought*. "The primordial essence," says Plato, "is an emanation from the Demiurgic mind," which mind "contains from eternity the *idea* of the natural world within itself." He further asserts that, "He (the Demiurgus) produces the *divine idea* out of himself by the power of his will." Thus only *re-expressing* the self same Hermetic doctrine elaborated by old Hermes at the very dawn of Occult philosophy.

divine unity takes place, and assumes the dual forms of energy termed "Spirit" and "Matter." Having reached this point of differentiation,* we must now turn our attention to the altered mode of motion, the changed polarity, so to say, of these two forces and examine the processes of their action which are silently at work in nature's invisible laboratory, gradually externalizing themselves as solid forms cognizable by the physical senses. Then we must show how these forms are ultimated as crystals, primary, molecular, crystals which constitute the first physical foundation of material phenomena from which issue the infinite variety of concrete crystallized forms.

In order that the laws of crystallization may be clearly apprehended, we must state at the commencement that crystallization means death. By death we do not mean death in the ordinary acceptance of the term, but we mean the lowest possible minimum in the activities of force—the state we call inertia. This much being granted, we are assumed to be at the beginning of our subject, and also of physical creation.

The first act in creation, according to the Hebrew cosmogony, was the creation of light, Genesis I. 3., "and God said, let there be light, and there was light." As we have

*The polarizing point, as we term it, seems to be an impenetrable mystery to most Occult students. The chief difficulty is in grasping the essential idea that change of energy is simply due to the necessary re-action of all action. The true conception is difficult to express in words, so we will try to illustrate it. If a ball is thrown up into the air spinning round its axis, directly the force which projected it becomes exhausted it will become stationary for one single instant, and then, obeying a different force, *re-action* sets in and it falls to the ground revolving in exactly the opposite direction. The stationary instant is the polarizing point.

already seen, the boundless realm of the universal ether containing unconditioned potentialities, requires but the faintest ripple or impulse of the divine mind to set it in vibration, and, instantly, there flashes forth LIGHT, heat, magnetism and molecular force: in short, our universe begins the grand march of cosmic evolution. The first logical effect of this vibration was light, a disruptive centrifugal force, and its correlatives radiating in straight lines, in all possible directions from a center, while from each line of force minor rays radiate at every possible angle to the axial ray. We have, thus, at the very outset of our conception, a complete and perfect net-work of rays, or lines of energy, moving at the rate of 185,000 miles per second through the formless, motionless, ethereal, medium of space. It will help us in our conception, if we call to mind the fact that matter, to produce in us the sensations we refer to matter, must possess at least three dimensions, viz.: length, breadth and thickness, and each of these dimensions requires at least two equal forces for its expression; also, that all these six equal forces must be concentrated upon a single impenetrable atomic point, and, lastly, this impenetrable atomic point must also consist of two equal forces. Therefore, to produce a single grain of solid matter—a solitary minute crystal—it requires the complete polarization of eight rays of cosmic energy.

Our first duty, then, is to discover our impenetrable atom. When two equal forces meet each other from opposing angles, both become polarized, a state of inertia is produced, and an atom—a veritable material atom—is the

physical result of this change of energy. From the infinite network of rays produced by the first vibrations of light, it is easy to conceive of the instantaneous evolution of an unlimited number of material atoms from the equally unlimited number of opposing rays of light. We have now our necessary atom, which, after all, is nothing but an unknowable something. This polarized something, however, gives us the first dimension of material forms. It is a point in space, and if we now take two more equal forces at this polarizing point, we have another atom, which, although it gives us nothing in the form of a solid, yet will supply us with the second dimension, viz.: a straight line or a

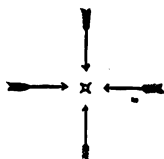


FIG. I.

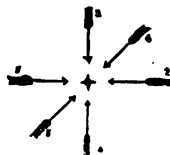


FIG. II.

point extended by an additional point. Let us now take our impenetrable atomic point, consisting of a single atom, and suppose that four equal forces are concentrated upon it, one from the right and its opponent from the left, one from above and its opponent from below (see fig. I), and the result is, we possess an ideal form, but still no solid: we have both length and breadth, but no thickness, hence it is only a higher form of the second dimension. But, instead of four, let us now suppose that we have six equal forces concentrated upon our impenetrable atomic point. In addition to those which come from above, below, right

and left, we have two more which come from the rear and the front. (See fig. II.) 1 comes from the right, its opponent is 2, from the left; 3 comes from above, its opponent 4 comes from below; 5 comes from the rear, its opponent 6 comes from the front. What is now the result? Why, we have length, breadth and thickness; we have six equal sides, and our unknowable atomic something has become transformed into an ultimate molecule, whose crystallized substance is a cube. It has, therefore, all the elements of a solid form that can be measured only by the imagination, since microscopes have not yet been invented powerful enough to reveal the first original forms of crystallization. Such wonderful transformations can only be seen by the eye of the spiritual soul whose piercing sight can penetrate the mysteries of Nature's Workshop—the astral light. It is from this source that the principles contained in the above illustrations are presented.

We see, therefore, that logically it requires six equal forces, meeting at an atomic or impenetrable point, to produce solid dimensional matter. It may, of course, be many more than six, so that they approach in pairs from opposite points. The only difference would be in the form of the crystal. By keeping in your minds that the atomic point can be made so by forces from all possible directions, you will see that as the possible angles are infinite, so the possible crystals are infinite, in strict conformity to the mathematical law, "each kind of crystal is the type of the substance it forms."

So far, we have spoken only of the three external dimen-

sions recognized by science. There are, in all, seven dimensions. In this chapter we shall speak only of the fourth, first introduced to the notice of science by Prof. Zollner, in his "Transcendental Physics." No matter how solid any external object may appear, it is not so, for every molecule of which it consists forms an extremely small atomic system of satellite atoms, revolving around their primary atom, which forms the impenetrable point of every crystal. There is space between every one of them. It is these unoccupied spaces that form the fourth dimension of matter.

To de-materialize objective matter, then, and resolve it into its original elements, requires the application of an external force, powerful enough to polarize the cohesive affinity of the atoms. If this de-materializing force is electric, the form is destroyed, as far as the external plane is concerned. But, if it is magnetic, the object is only etherealized, and in this state matter can be made to pass through matter, and immediately the magnetic dissolvent is withdrawn the object will re-assume its original objective shape. We need scarcely add, that in this natural fact lies the secret of spiritual materializing phenomena of modern spiritualism, and it forms the true foundation of all magical manifestations of a physical nature. A strong physical medium, even though a helpless tool under the control of a very questionable class of invisibles, can produce phenomena equally as well as the living adept. The only difference is, that the medium cannot control either the spirits or the phenomena, whereas the adept

commands both at will. If it were possible to reduce magical science to a technical formula the following would be, within certain limits, scientifically correct: "As the density of the atoms is to the mass of the substance, so is the power of cohesion to the form of the article." Master that magical receipt, and you will work wonders.

From the principles elucidated in this chapter, the reader will perceive that if all the forces of the universe were balanced, the external result would be a complete stop in the progressive work of creation; the variety of substance would be endless; there would be an infinitude of crystals, and our earth would be nothing but a dead crystallized sphere. All forces, when balanced, make crystals, but no motion. Crystallization is the negation of motion. It is death. In our next chapter, our energies will be directed towards the polar opposite of the inert crystal, wherein will be disclosed the origin of life.

CHAPTER III.

THE ORIGIN OF PHYSICAL LIFE.

When we speak of the genesis of life, we must be understood to mean "the origin of physical life" and not the genesis of life within the divine super-celestial sphere of God's infinite creation.

Man, his constitution, from whence he came, and whither his cyclic journey will carry him, is all that embodied man can hope to understand during his sojourn upon the external

planes of matter. The exalted adept craves no more, in fact he cannot obtain any absolute knowledge beyond this, because it is impossible for him to realize anything beyond himself. The perfect man, while incarnated within the astral vortices of humanity, cannot penetrate and know the details of truth belonging to the purely angelic state. Before he can do this he must be forever translated from the astral sphere of the planet which gave him birth, and become himself the angel. The mightiest hierophant* this world has ever produced has only been able to speculate as to details within these exalted states, and such speculations, without corroborative testimony, are as valueless when used as the foundation for a system of thought, as the speculations of any religious enthusiast. The only difference between the two consists in the different planes occupied by the respective speculators.

The involution of spirit, and the re-active evolution of matter, are based upon absolute laws, which man may realize for himself. That one form disappears only to give place to another more perfect, is a fact observed throughout nature in all her departments, and those who possess the attributes of soul-light in a sufficiently developed state, can perceive the hidden potentialities latent within the outward form. This being so, and we assert of our own spiritual experiences that it is, then we know that previous to this evolution which we can distinguish all around us, there must have been a process of involution, by which these latent potentialities became involved within the external

*Hermes Trismegistus

matter. From nothing, nothing can be produced; it is therefore only the blind, unreasoning atheist who can credit such an illogical creed as the one which has been thus summarized,—

“ From nothing we came, and whatever our station,
To nothing we owe an immense obligation.
Whatever we do, or whatever we learn,
In time we shall all into nothing return.”

To the cold, heartless supporter of this soul annihilating system of nothingness, who flaunts his superficially learned authority under the plausible name of Agnostic, we reply with the fully realized consciousness of a deathless, progressive immortality:

From an infinite source midst realms of light,
An offspring from God, my soul took its flight;
To gain amid matter, with its trials and pain,
The knowledge to carry it homeward again.

The immutable laws of nature may be traced backward into the remote eras of sun formation, or carried forward beyond the purview of the present into the equally dim vistas of the eternal future, by those who can see and realize for themselves the planes of both cause and effect. To be able to do this we must attain unto the soul state of equilibrium where both realms unite, where there is neither cause nor effect, but where the two are one. It is from such a state that the teachings contained in this work were derived, and as such we desire them to be closely studied.

The genesis of life must be viewed from the seven planes of its manifestation, to be thoroughly understood. These planes, taken in the order of their cyclic evolution, are as

follows: I. Celestial; II. Spiritual; III. Astral; IV. Mineral; V. Vegetable; VI. Animal; VII. Human. From the seventh or human state the life atoms again pass through the astral and spiritual to the celestial; the complete cycle of necessity being composed of ten great cycles, corresponding to the well-known Kabbalistical "Sephiroth." At present, we shall only speak of I, IV and V, these three constituting the foundations from which the others arise.

I.—The Celestial State.

Of this state it is impossible to give more than a general outline, containing, as it does, the mystery of those inconceivable laws, by the operation of which the Ego becomes a self acting entity. It must suffice to say, that it is this state of celestial life wherein is located the purely embryonic centre in the divine arc of progressive being, the point where the diffusive intelligence of the infinite spirit becomes differentiated and atomic; yes, we repeat the word; the divine Ego of the human soul is absolutely atomic. It is a self-existing absolute atom of Jehovah-God! which it is impossible to alter, transform, absorb or annihilate, from the supreme moment of its differentiation. It is as eternal and immortal as the infinite, of which it forms a part. But though atomic, it is only so as a purely spiritual conception, a point of radiant light, free from matter, and incapable of uniting itself with it except by means of reflection.

The process of differentiation now claims our attention. This process is consummated within the celestial matrix of angelic parents. By "angelic parents" we mean those divine

entities who dwell within the various spheres of purified angelhood.*

The twin souls, male and female, or heavenly Isis and Osiris, form the two halves, the masculine and feminine attributes of the divine Ego. They have their alternate cycles of activity and repose. During the cycle of their fruitful activity, the two natures respond with intense vibrations to the divine anthem of creation which creates an influx of the formless, motionless spirit into the celestial sensorium until the whole sphere becomes radiant with the scintillations of spiritual harmony. Obeying the creative impulse, these streams of spiritual force flow along the convergent poles from the various centers of the sphere, each force from the male being met and balanced by that of the female, the contact producing, by the exact equilibrium of the masculine and feminine natures, the living, external sparks of immortal life. In other words, these angelic vibrations transform the formless intelligence, which has been indrawn, into active eternal Egos. As man on earth is the natural outcome of the procreative powers of earthly parents, so the divine activities of the Ego are the spiritual results, in one sense, of the creative attributes of angelic progenitors in the celestial worlds. But we must not be misunderstood upon this point. The Ego is not created in the angelic state: it is only differentiated. The Ego never

*We do not use the term angel in the sense implied by ordinary lexicographers, who interpret the word as "a spiritual servant or messenger," but we use it to mean the highest and most interior state of life which it is possible for mortal mind to grasp. It is infinitely above the so called spiritual sphere.

had an actual genesis: it is coeval with Deity. The celestial harmony or vibrations merely endowed it with spiritual activity, aroused it from its unconscious state, and propelled it forward with the motion of eternal life.

These newly differentiated atoms remain within the paternal soul sphere until the vibrations have ceased. They then become attracted by the reactive energy, and are withdrawn from their celestial matrix and carried by the spiritual currents to the embryonic state of the Seraphs. Their next descent is to the paradisiacal worlds of the Cherubs, where the bisexual Ego becomes the Adam and Eve of Scripture. In the process of time, these pure twin souls, unconsciously obeying the internal impulse of their evolutionary tempter, become attracted towards matter. Up to this point they are pure and innocent, knowing neither good nor evil. Therefore the divine Ego, which is incapable of descent into matter, projects the two souls outward as spiritual monads into the vortex of cosmic evolution, where they become separated and ultimately incarnated within the mineral round of a planet, which is the lowest point in the arc. In this state they constitute the hidden fire of matter, latent force.

IV.—The Mineral State.

Having arrived at the mineral state, we must now ascertain the origin of its motion—its life—since we know that within the mineral lies concealed the potencies of an immortal being.

In the chapter upon the evolution of matter and the laws of crystallization, we endeavored to show that the forces all

balanced produced crystals, and in their production motion comes to an end. Now to help us in our search for physical life, let us again press into service our six equal forces, our cubic atom, and let us imagine that one of its forces is not equal to its opposite, *i. e.* the two are not balanced. Say it is less, and that it is the force coming from "before." It is evident that the point will move forward in a straight line, and that the weaker the force coming from the front, the greater will be the velocity of this movement. Now if this force coming from the front be less than its opposite, its motion will be infinitely slow. Now let us assume that two of our six forces are less than their opposites. Say the one from the "front" and the one from the "left." It is evident that we should have motion in a *curve*. But inasmuch as all the others are the same as when we assumed our point, it is plain that this motion in a curve will be in the same plane of surface, and will, in time, describe a circle. But let us assume also that another force is less than its opposite. Say the one coming from "above." What have we now? Our original point with *three* of its forces less than their opposites. The result will be motion, not motion in a straight line, but in a curve, but not a curve in the same plane of space, and hence it can never describe a circle, but will form a spiral. This spiral is life. That is to say, it is the motion of life. Just keep clear in your mind that one-half of the primitive forms that make an impenetrable point are less than their opposites, and you have the essential idea of life.

Chemical force is death, that is, balanced, still and mo-

tionless. The spiral motion is the type of life. It is the motion of life. It is a spiritual screw, with all the mechanical advantages of a screw in penetrating the universe of matter. The spiral varies in magnitude from the infinite to the infinitesimal. Conceive the lesser forces to be but an infinite fraction less than their opposites. Then the spiral will be almost infinite in its sweep of curve, and will require almost an eternity to reach its culminating point. On the contrary, the greater the diversity in power the less will become the curve, until we have the infinitesimally small spiral that will culminate almost instantly. Now between these two extremes we have every phenomenon of life, from that of the tiniest insect to the great cosmic life of an astral universe.

V.—The Vegetable State.

Since we have found that motion is the life of matter, we must now seek for a still higher form, the immediate product of matter. We therefore ask the student to mentally bridge the distance between the formation of crystalized atoms to the evolution of a planet with its gaseous envelope, called its atmosphere. This done, we will carefully notice the evolution of the first rudimentary forms of vegetable life from which primal forms all the infinite variety of the vegetable kingdom are evolved.

Having made the assertion that the spiral is the motion of life, it will be as well to see if the vegetable kingdom will substantiate our assertion. As some sort of external evidence, then, let us call to our aid the phyllotaxy of plants (as it is technically termed). On the stems of plants the

leaves are so placed that a line wound around the stem, and touching the petiole of each leaf, would be a spiral. Where the leaves are in two rows, the space between two opposite leaves is just half a circle or circumference of the stem, and where there are three rows, it is one-third the circumference, and so on to a regular successive series in different plants which express the ratios of 1-2, 2-5, 3-8, 5-13, 2-21, 13-34, 21-55. The external facts, demonstrated by botanical science, not only confirm our assertion, but also tend to show that vital force is subject to measurement in the plant.

In order to understand how the vegetable evolves from the mineral, not only must the spiral motion of life be held in view, but the various changes of atomic polarity must also be clearly apprehended. As, for instance, the atoms of oxygen and hydrogen by a certain combination produce water. In this union both become polarized, and form a substance which is the polar opposite of their original inflammable states. From this change of polarity we have clouds, oceans and rivers. Now when the vapor from these waters is drawn upward by the heat of the sun, an infinitely small fraction becomes decomposed into its gaseous state. Although decomposed, the atoms are actually the same after combining in the substance known as water as they were previously. They have only received a different angle of motion. Whereas before they rotated in a circle, they now ascend and revolve in the form of a spiral. In this ascension from earth they attract or are attracted by the atoms of carbonic acid gas, and instantly a violent rotation among the various atoms is produced. They combine and lo!

another transformation has taken place: a new thing has been produced, viz. : a molecule or germ of physical life. Under the control of a central atom of fire, the predominating forces being oxygen and carbon, this union produces another change of polarity, and they become re-attracted to earth. The water or moisture receives them, and a species of vegetable slime is the physical result. When this vegetable product has served its purpose and decays, its liberated atoms arise in their spiral and, in turn, become attracted, or themselves attract, some one or more of the atoms of air with which they have a natural affinity. The same process of polarization is repeated, with some slight variation, and a still higher germ of life is evolved, viz. : the lowest form of the lichen. From the liberated atoms of this spring forth still higher types of the same family until the climax is attained, when, by a higher and more ethereal attraction, the polarized germs bring forth the next higher form of vegetable life. Thus, as the ages roll on, from this original form issues species, classes, and families of vegetation, and from these evolve, through the medium of water, a still higher round in the gamut of being ; insect, reptile, animal and, lastly, MAN !

Space will not admit of our going into further details of this exceedingly interesting subject. Volumes might be filled in recounting the writer's personal experience in this department, watching with intense interest the weird but beautiful transformations of nature. Therefore, much that is necessarily left unnoticed must be made the subject of the student's private meditation, and personal research.

CHAPTER IV.

THE MYSTERIES OF SEX.

It has been well said by an eminent Occultist, "man is most ignorant of those things which are most manifest." In some departments of nature this is true, and probably in no other "manifested" department of his being is this truth more strikingly apparent than in that which relates to his sexual nature. He is aware that animal nature is divided into two great classes, male and female, but he knows almost nothing of the spiritual principles which underlie this physical expression of sex. He is fully aware that the union of the two organisms is necessary for the purpose of procreation, but he is fearfully ignorant of those interior processes which produce the actual germs of life. He is more or less acquainted with the fact that in the lower stratas of animated existence bi-sexual organisms are the general rule, and that, occasionally, this bi-sexual nature becomes manifested among men, as seen in the hermaphrodite, but he is quite at a loss to account for such "monstrous" productions. Hence it may be truly said that "man is most ignorant of those things which are most manifest." Therefore, in order to enable the general reader to clearly grasp the various connecting links in the mystical ramifications of sex, to see their perfect harmony, and to understand their relation to each other, we will first speak of the origin of sex ; secondly, describe, as clearly as possi-

ble its nature and functions, thirdly, point out the relation of the sexes to each other, and, lastly, present a brief application of the whole as it relates to Man, the Universe, and the Immortality of the Soul.

I.—The Origin of Sex.

Deity is unity. The infinite ocean of formless spirit within its latent bosom contains all that is, or that ever can be. Therefore it contains all the elements of sex in their primal state. When the first pulsations of that thought which evolved "the divine idea" became manifest, nature arrayed herself under the two modes of motion, action and reaction. The in-breathing and out-breathing of this divine thought thus instituted the first spiritual attributes of sex in the earliest dawn of creation. Each function of the Deific soul, which we may designate as the inspiration and respiration of the universal life current, thus became differentiated for all eternity as the primary fundamental principle of Manifested Being. The Kabbalistical initiates of the ages that are gone formulated this same biune spirit as Love and Wisdom. Love, as the negative or feminine ray, is content and ever seeks to enfold. Wisdom, as the positive, masculine ray, is restless and always in pursuit. The feminine forces are ever striving to encircle the atom, and the masculine forces to propel it in a straight line. From this dual action of the spiritual potentialities, is born the Spiral—the motion of life and symbol of eternal progression.

We cannot attempt any explanation of how the first Deific forms of sexual life became ultimated, nor of the why

and wherefore of this celestial existence. It is enough for us that we are enabled by the laws of correspondence to trace the origin of sex to the shores of the great fountain of all existence, and to proclaim it to the world as the first principle of that great central Ego from which all manifested egos derive their being. In order that we may comprehend somewhat of the mysteries of sex as we see them manifested in humanity, we must descend from these practically inconceivable heights of celestial glory and seek for the links of this continuous chain within the highest states of life approachable by the embodied human soul, viz., the angelic sphere of the soul world. Only in these states can we obtain any definite idea of the interior significance of sex, and its mighty importance as a factor in the immortality of the human soul. The first link of this celestial chain, as we have seen, lies concealed within the bosom of the Infinite One. What the succeeding ones may contain we cannot tell, but that they will bear a perfect correspondence to the angelic state we are certain, making due allowance for the difference of their respective states. Therefore, since we know the origin of sex, we will consider its correlatives which we have designated.

II.—Its Nature and Functions.

In the previous chapter we have described in a very brief manner the actual differentiation of the human ego, as a deific atom of life. We need not, therefore, repeat any of the description there given, so we will only add that it must be a self evident fact that this Ego contains within

itself all the primary elements of sex, but in a latent condition. These attributes have not as yet been subjected to the requisite conditions for their evolution. In this state, then, there is neither love nor wisdom manifested within the Ego. It cannot know happiness when it is ignorant of the contrary. It cannot form any conception of rest when weariness cannot approach. There can be no real love for the Ego when it has never experienced the various contrary conditions by which love is distinguished. The wisdom of the Ego in this state is equally latent, since it possesses no means of arriving at a true knowledge of its various surroundings. In this state, then, we behold the spiritual atom in its primal condition wherein the power of God hath just created it. It is the first spiritual Adam. The various series of states through which this divine Ego must penetrate in order to evolve its soul sphere, are the necessary means by which the internal potentialities of sex must be awakened. When this transpires the divine Ego becomes pregnant with the dual forms of its own organic life, and the twin souls are born, the male and female elements of its being, which are represented in Genesis as Adam and Eve, knowing neither good nor evil. A beautiful description this of the embryonic human souls. These twin souls are the absolute expression of the masculine and feminine rays of which every absolute atomic Ego is composed. The masculine ray contains a portion of the feminine elements or there could be no re-action of its forces. The feminine ray must likewise contain a portion of the positive qualities for the same reason. These souls,

therefore, contain a portion of each other. They constitute the sun and moon, so to say, of the Ego's creation, and when once they become differentiated they are as eternal and immortal as the Ego which called them into existence. They can be neither absorbed nor annihilated by time nor eternity.* They constitute the divine idea of this deific parent, and as such they become the divine expression of Love and Wisdom upon earth.

It is impossible for the absolute Ego to descend into more outward conditions than the paradisiacal state, so in order to attain the full development of its internal attributes its own soul, expressed as the male and female elements, is projected outward upon the subjective arc of the great cycle,

* This statement requires some slight qualification. We mean that no foreign or outside influence can absorb or annihilate the sexual qualities of the soul. It is therefore true that the masculine and feminine attributes of the soul cannot be destroyed as a whole. But the masculine portion may attract its feminine portion or soul mate, and by the intense selfhood of its own dominant forces virtually destroy her manifested existence. This absorption, however, is a very rare occurrence and only transpires in the case of those magical adepts of the astral plane who have attained their psychological powers by a complete polarization of all the truly human elements of their internal natures. Such magical adepts become the concentrated centers of spiritual selfishness, but teach the external masses that self is the very demon they have conquered. These occult processes have transformed them into sexless beings, who are neither human nor divine, and yet they profess to be the guardians of "the secret doctrine" of "the sacred science." In this latter capacity they have formulated much erroneous philosophy, since they are self magnetised and self-deluded by their own positive idea of nature to such an extent that they cannot penetrate beyond their own astral spheres, nor receive any knowledge which elevates the soul to higher views and truer conceptions of God's infinite resources. It is from this magical school of thought that mankind have received the doctrines which teach that sex is only the appearance of matter, and not a spiritual reality; whereas, nothing in this mighty universe is so manifest and so eternal as the male and female expressions of the divine soul. These adepts profess to have blended the two; but they have simply polarized the one, and created a conscious selfhood of the other.

where, after passing through innumerable spheres and states of life, it finally reaches the polarizing point of creation which is the turning point in its cycle of necessity. From this point its journey back again, until it reaches the climax of material forms, is traversed upon the objective arc.

We see, therefore, that the nature of sex is to give perfect expression to the two grand attributes of deific life—Love and Wisdom; that to attain this end the divine soul of the absolute Ego becomes differentiated as the male and female consciousness of itself, in perfect expression of the positive and negative forces of its being; lastly, that when once this differentiation is completed they exist as the divine idea of the microcosm and constitute its universe, even as the myriad creations of space constitute the divine idea of the Deity. This being so, each portion of the dual soul maintains forever the perfect symbol of its internal qualities and always gives expression, in its outward form, to the symbol of its nature.

The functions of the soul are to awaken and round out those qualities and attributes which are latent within, and as we have seen that there are two sets of soul qualities, one the necessary outcome of the other, we see the harmony and the philosophy of the twin forms of life to express them. Both male and female, as we have endeavored to show, possess the necessary positive qualities for the perfect subjugation of material forces. Hence it is that, when the souls are projected on their journey into matter, they travel upon divergent lines. These lines (if it were possible to measure them) would form two sides of an equilat-

eral triangle with matter as a base, while the apex indicates the central ego or point of projection. The return journey between the mineral and man forms another triangle, which marks off the objective and subjective arcs of the soul's evolution. See Figs. I and II. When both arcs are combined they represent the mystical seal of King Solomon, the double triangle or six pointed star. This completes two acts in the grand drama of life. The closing tableau in the first represents the stationary forces of the crystal; in the second the external conditions of human

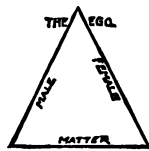


FIG. I.

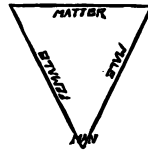


FIG. II.

life. The third and last act in the human arc* briefly reviews the whole of the previous two, and evolves another six pointed star which represents the higher and lower planes of manifestation. But in its grand outlines it is also a spiritual trine whose closing tableau represents the reunion of the twin souls symbolized by St. John as the celestial marriage of the lamb. Thus we have the one divine monad or Ego to begin with, and in the course of its expression and of the gradual evolution of its sexual attributes we see it slowly transform into a trinity. This trinity, in the sub-cycles of its evolution, forms three triangles, which

*This last act is the transit of the soul through the seven super mundane spheres of disembodied existence from man to the angel.

constitute the symbol of its forces three times expressed upon the three sub-cycles of its journey, viz.: the subjective arc or the cycle of unconsciousness, the objective arc or the cycle of intelligence, and the ethereal arc or the cycle of soul consciousness. The results so far of our present research show that the origin of sex begins with God; that the nature of sex is the manifestation of his biune spirit, and its functions the spiral motion of its evolutionary forces that awaken and round out its latent possibilities. It now becomes our duty to consider the third section of our subject.

III.—The Relation of the Sexes to Each Other.

Male and female exist in nature as the representative expressions of love and wisdom. Their functions correspond exactly with their sex, and in actual life it may be truly said that woman is ever the center of the love element of humanity. Her thoughts and desires constitute the index of her mission on earth. In her we hold the gentle, yielding, loving nature which softens and harmonizes man's positive spirit of aggression. In her delicate nature we see the lovely center of maternal care and affection. She is the weaker portion of the dual soul upon the physical plane, but her physical weakness constitutes the great center of her spiritual strength. As the weaker sex, we should naturally think that her true place was that of subjection to man, but, on the contrary, her more delicate forces become her most potent weapon, and instead of being the subject she ascends the throne of the conqueror. Man becomes a pliable medium

in her hands, and is led a willing captive by her subtle power and resources.

In man we behold the positive, aggressive Lord of Creation, that portion of the soul which becomes the restless explorer of nature, seeking for wisdom. Man's will is electric, penetrating and disruptive. The will of woman is magnetic, attractive and formative. Hence they express the polar opposites of nature's creative forces.

The twin souls are related to each other primarily as brother and sister, and finally as man and wife. In this latter state their true meeting place is the plane of embodied humanity, but during the present cycle very few of these spiritual unions take place. But whenever the two halves of the same divine Ego do meet, love is the natural consequence : not the physical sensations produced by the animal magnetisms of their sexual natures, but the deep, silent emotions of the soul—the responsive vibrations of their internal natures toward each other—the blissful silence of two souls in perfect rapport wherein neither careth to speak. This spiritual love is the outcome of their divine relationship, and should never be set aside nor crushed by any worldly considerations. But, on the contrary, wherever possible, these pure intuitions of the soul should be obeyed. They cannot deceive nor lead astray, because the soul never makes a mistake when claiming its own. Should circumstances in life or any other material consideration prevent their rightful union, the fact that they have actually met will constitute an invisible connection, a spiritual rapport, between them which no earthly power or device can break, and deep

down within the secret chambers of the heart the image of the loved one will be treasured up, and its continual presence will poison and corrode everything which pertains toward an ephemeral affection for another. If a female should marry under these circumstances, and become the mother of children, it will frequently transpire that the actual germs of spiritual life will be transmitted by this absent one. The external husband only provides the purely physical conditions for the manifestation of the spiritual offspring of the true lord. The rejected soul-mate, the spiritual bridegroom, is the real father, and very often the child born will resemble the image of its true parent.

By far the most important of the various relations of the sexes toward each other is that which pertains to their sexual intercourse. Untold misery, suffering and crime are born into the world through the sensual depravity of mankind on the one hand, and their benighted ignorance of human nature upon the other. We are sorry that such a delicate subject cannot be properly treated in the present work, therefore we will only add that man and wife should harmonize both in physical temperament and in magnetic polarity. No marriage union should be thought of where these essential points of comparison are wanting. Neither wealth, fame nor worldly position can compensate for the lack of these. Discordant unions are the harbingers of sorrow, crime and disease. Sexual union between inharmonious souls evolves the seeds of every species of wickedness and sexual disorder. It may not become apparent to the producer thereof, but it exists within the spaces of hu-

man life ready to spring into concrete form under the first favorable conditions.

The purely Martial man will prove a continual curse to the cold-natured Saturnine woman, and *vice versa*. This may not be any fault of the man or woman, but it is the discordant polarities of their astral constitutions. The same will hold good between natures of the Earthy triplicity and those born under the Airy; hence in this department of man a true knowledge of the science of the stars is necessary for the production of conjugal harmony.

The various sections of our subject are now completed, and it only remains for us to apply the logical outcome of the principles of sex as they affect man, the universe and the immortality of the soul.

As we view the outward forms of man and woman we cannot fail to observe the perfect harmony between the external appearance and the internal cause. Their organisms are the concrete image of the principles concealed within, and it would be the extreme height of absurdity for us to believe that a materialized form bears no correspondence to the forces which created it. The form cannot exist without an internal cause, and the internal cause is powerless to produce any external form apart from the reflected image of itself and its functions. Under these circumstances it must be self-evident that every male organism is the absolute outcome of masculine forces, and every female organism the product of feminine qualities. Therefore, a male soul cannot be born into the world under the cover of a female form. Neither can a female soul be ushered upon

the planes of humanity imprisoned within the masculine body. These are nature's simple facts, which ought to be apparent to every thinking mind. But it seems that such is not the case, for we are seriously informed by certain theosophical writers that during the various incarnations of the human soul within the human form, man may incarnate in the form of a woman, and *vice versa*. We can only say that such unutterable nonsense is almost beneath the notice of any sane mind, and those who make such ridiculous assertions are not only bound to the external planet of appearances,* but are completely ignorant of the true light of Occult Science. The Buddhistical conception of man and woman rounding out until sex becomes obliterated, is probably the most transcendental delusion that ever originated within the oriental brain—therefore, we will take no further notice of such mystical folly.

The human form, then, applies to man as the material culmination of nature's sexual expression. Upon this plane she can go no further, for beyond this limit we step within the spaces of the ether where nature continues her wonderful expression of sex in strict harmony with the laws of correspondence to the planes below. While dealing with the forms assumed by man, we must briefly notice those vital secretions which form the physical conditions for re-production of his kind. The seminal fluids are the most ethereal of all physical secretions, and contain the very quint-

*It often transpires that we find men who appear to possess true feminine natures, and women who seem to be masculine in temperament, but this is not really the case. It is only an appearance caused by the combined influence of pre-natal conditions, and stellar positions at birth.

essence of human nature. The sexual organism exists as a factor in procreation, therefore the organs have their proper functions and use or they would not be present. To suddenly and completely suppress their natural functions will do a great deal of physical and spiritual harm, because the re-action will create violent discord with the ethereal constitution. In fact, the complete suppression is almost as bad as the excessive use or sensual indulgence. It is only one of the two extremes, nothing more. When the sexual organism is evolved above the physical plane of its manifestation, the seminal fluids are absorbed by the magnetic constitution and the more etherealized atoms help to build up the spiritual body of man. But when this is not so these seminal germs, if not passed off amid the other secretions from the body, live and germinate a swarm of elemental life-forms which rob the organism of a portion of its vitality.

To obey the laws of nature is the only safe and sure road to the spiritual evolution of the senses of the soul, and one of these laws is the rightful union of the sexes. Celibacy in itself is not a natural state: it is purely artificial, because it ignores one of the principal elements of its being. Therefore there is great spiritual danger in a celibate life, and nine tenths of the mystical manias and spiritual saturnalia of past history have originated among celibates. It is well to remember this at the present day, as there is some considerable danger of history repeating itself.

Celibacy, as a means of artificially stimulating and thus quickly producing certain so-called spiritual powers and mediumistic states, is a successful method so far as mere

psychological results are concerned, but one that is fraught with terrible danger. It is a method that should be discouraged in all cases wherein the spiritual constitution of the organism is in a negative condition, and under the most favorable circumstances it is a very questionable practice unless the spiritual nature is sufficiently active to absorb and use the etherealized atoms of the seminal fluid which has become dematerialized by the magnetic activities of Occult training. Any species of "forcing" the attributes of the soul, renders their manifestations weak and unhealthy, hence liable to error and delusion. It is upon this basis that we account for the spiritual absurdities of many oriental mystics. Their severe asceticism renders them the unsuspecting prey of every imaginable species of Occult delusion. Celibacy, then, must only take place when the animal nature has been so far evolved upward toward the higher principles, that the sexual propensities are susceptible of extending their vibrations to a higher plane of action. In this case celibacy becomes an absolute necessity of further Occult progress. Herein we see once more the paradox of truth. Upon one plane it becomes a delusion and a snare, but upon a higher plane it contains all the elements of a glorious truth. Consequently no being, human or divine, can lay down any hard and fast line to guide the various processes of spiritual development. Each organism requires a system that is peculiar to itself, each soul a training specially adapted to the plane it occupies.* And only those

*From this it will be seen that nothing more than the general principles of Occult training can be given. From such outlines each must adopt such rules and exercises as are applicable to him.

who are themselves spiritually enlightened can see the true state of the soul and, physician-like, scientifically prescribe for its various disorders.

When we regard the mystical ramifications of sex as represented in the universal creation of suns, stars, moons and planets, we see the same principles at work throughout every department of their being, even to their shape and the form of their orbit. The suns are masculine, and represent the cosmic male spirit. The planets are feminine, and consequently become the fruitful wombs of progressive life. The moons are neither the one nor the other: they are the conflicting offsprings of the disturbing forces within the sun and its planet. They are the lowest organic expression of planetary life, and as such represent the state of the hermaphrodite, so that both in the man and in the universe the potentialities of sex swing the mighty pendulum of thought and motion.

The grand object which the divine Ego seeks to realize in the evolution of the human soul, is the complete differentiation of its latent attributes. The soul, therefore, must become the expression of both its qualities, and must express the true nature of the biune spirit; hence male and female evolution is the outcome. Each soul rounds out and completes, so to say, its own section of the Ego, and in doing this it becomes individualized as a complete expression of one ray of the divine idea, hence it has a perfect identity with its source. Both male and female complete the whole, and are related to each other as Osiris and Isis; their individuality, in the form of their spiritual identity, is

forever preserved, and their united as well as their separate consciousness becomes an attribute of their glorious immortality. Without sex there cannot be eternal life, and to absorb or destroy these principles in the human organism brings about a divorce between the man and his divinity, and thus robs the conscious humanity of its deathless immortality.

SECTION II.

CHAPTER I.

INCARNATION AND RE-INCARNATION.

Probably no truth has been more completely inverted by the ignorant and concealed by the learned than that of re-incarnation. In every age it has been thought necessary by the priesthood to over-awe the uneducated masses by some species of pious jugglery, and the popular theory of re-incarnation, as understood and taught at the present day, is a typical example of truth thus perverted.

By re-incarnation we mean, as now currently understood, the doctrine of the re-birth of the human soul in various human forms and personalities, in different ages, upon the same planet.

In every bundle of theological chaff* there is, undoubtedly, concealed a grain of genuine truth. This is particularly the case with this doctrine. Up to a given point its teachings are those of truth itself, but beyond this point the doctrine of re-birth into physical conditions becomes one of the greatest delusions with which the mystical student has to deal. To those who are purely upon the plane of appear-

*The reader must bear in mind that the doctrine of human re-incarnation is not, strictly speaking, a doctrine of Occultism. It is a theological doctrine of oriental sacerdotal systems, formulated by the priesthood either to conceal the real truth, or to account for what they themselves could not comprehend.

ances it possesses an almost irresistible attraction because it appears to account, in a most rational and philosophical manner, for the wide difference manifested in the mental, social and moral conditions of humanity. Upon the external plane it seems to settle the question of good and evil, and harmonizes all our inequalities with what seems divine justice. All these delusive appearances, however, are but empty shadows of the phenomenal world, and can only deceive those who are upon the external plane,* and who have obtained their knowledge of Occultism from the writings of others, and accepted such teachings without verifying the doctrines for themselves. There are two methods of verification: one, the actual experiences of the soul, the other, the response of the soul to the thoughts and ideas we derive from an author's work. But, unfortunately, this latter kind of verification is subject to very serious drawbacks, viz.: a mediumistic nature will respond to error because of the more potent thought of the writer or, if we are over-sensitive, we may be superficial enough to respond to an erroneous idea through pure sentiment. These means have been seized by the Inversive Brethren to enable them to fasten this re-awakening of the karma and re-incarnation delusion

*The reader must not suppose that because a person studies the various branches of Occult science, tries to lead an ideal life, and, after acquiring a very large stock of book-lore-occultism, begins to write and publish works upon mystical subjects, that *that* person is beyond the plane of appearances. On the contrary, this class are the most external of all, because they become dominated by the thought forms of certain Occult leaders upon the physical plane, and their sensitive natures become absolutely blind to the real spiritual truth. We have seen numerous examples of this among the popular writers upon Modern Theosophy. The soul alone is capable of penetrating the realm of shadows, and seeing through the inverted images.

upon the sensitive minds and mediumistic natures of the western race. The most finely spun ideals of "the higher life," of "Devachan," "The Masters," and "blissful Nirvana," have been and are continuing to be presented by a host of sentimental, spiritually-sick mystical writers to explain "the glorious mysteries" of nature and "the secret doctrine" of all religious philosophies, of which they themselves in real truth know very little, apart from the mediumistic ideas which are projected towards them by the Inversive Magic. The whole craze is merely a metaphysical delusion cast over their mentalities by means of a magnetic glamor.

It seems very strange that these external followers of "the path" which leads to physical re-incarnation, can be so blind as to imagine that this earth is the only place within God's infinite universe whereon divine justice can be satisfied, and due punishment meted out to the evil doer. The life beyond is far more real, far more earnest, and a much more conscious life than this. Surely, then, the soul can work out its redemption better there than here. Surely, the soul ought to have the privilege granted of being conscious of what it is suffering for, which is not the case according to the fallacies of esoteric Buddhism. But alas! the spiritually blind are blind indeed. They that have eyes to see let them see. For modern Buddhistic Theosophy cannot perceive in the slightest degree, beyond the dull veil of external matter.

As a typical example of such material conceptions, we will quote from a recent publication professing to give the

secret doctrines of all religions. It is entitled, *The Mystery of the Ages*. In a foot-note upon the subject of Karma, page 143, the writer says: "Karma is the law of consequences, by which every act receives its exact recompense in the next life when the soul is born again. But unless the same soul passes on through a succession of earth lives such a recompense is *impossible**, and neither could it ex-
piate or make amends for the injuries it may have done others unless again brought into contact with them."

So thoroughly materialistic are the ideas conveyed in the above extract that one would think that esoteric Buddhism was nothing but materialism run to seed. According to such erroneous theories we are to believe that recompense for evil doing is impossible except by physical rebirth. Such writers are so destitute of the higher spiritual perception that they cannot comprehend any process of repentance and purification except upon the material earth, and incased within a material organism. We can only say to the followers of such, that when authors set themselves upon such a pinnacle of knowledge as to declare what is not possible within the mighty spaces of spiritual existences, they ought to be in a position to verify their assertions. If they cannot do this, then they are simply boasting pretenders to a state of knowledge and spiritual development which they do not possess, and seeing that their teachings do not in any sense agree with the actual experiences of those who have penetrated the realm of spirit, and investigated the mysteries of life for themselves, we challenge their right to

*The italics are ours.

speak with such authority. How different from such ideas are the real truths of nature. How different are spiritual realities from oriental theories of dreamy speculations! The talented author of "Art Magic" and "Ghost-land," who for years had investigated the various unseen realms of life for himself, gives the world the brief results of his life-long research in the latter work. Speaking upon re-incarnation the writer says: "To my dim apprehension, and in view of my long years of wandering through spirit spheres, where teaching spirits and blessed angels guided my soul's ardent explorations, this brief summary of our pre-existent states explains all that the re-incarnationists have labored so sedulously to theorize upon.* * * The universal and reiterated assertions of myriads of spirits in every stage of a progressive beyond, convinced me there was no return to mortal birth, no retrogression in the scale of cosmic being, as a return to material incarnations undoubtedly would be, and all the demands of progress, justice, and advancement, are supplied by the opportunities offered the soul in the sphere of spiritual existence."

The author concludes the chapter of his experiences in the following eloquent words: "I have stood on the threshold of glorious lands, where my eyes could perceive the radiance of celestial spheres, the memory of whose brightness will warn and beckon me upwards forever."

*At the time "Art Magic" and "Ghost-land" were written and published, modern Theosophists knew nothing of the Buddhistical theories they have since adopted. Our author refers more especially to the re-incarnation theory of the "Spiritualists" of France. Not until the Theosophical Society removed its headquarters to India did it go crazy after India's subtle delusions.

The personal experiences thus narrated correspond in their results exactly with those of the present writer, and also with many true spiritually initiated Occultists with whom we are associated. Can the carefully tabulated results of all our united labors count for nought ? Is it possible that the unanimous but legitimate conclusions of scores of spiritual investigators, each and all of whom were specially qualified for research by reason of their own soul development, are false and delusive ? Must the result of our own personal research and actual experiences of the soul within the realm of spirit be cast away as unreliable, simply because they conflict with an old fossilized theory of some priestly metaphysicians ? Not so, reader ; not so. "Prove all things," saith the apostle, "hold fast that which is good ;" and such is our humble intention, and our advice to others.

We repeat what we have so often said to those who have studied under our care, that re-incarnation, as taught by modern writers, is nothing but a theory of the physical intellect. In other words, it is the metaphysical outcome of intellectual force destitute of spiritual intuition. It is an attempt of the external mind to harmonize good and evil, and nothing more. It contains nothing approaching to the pure intuitions of the spirit in its composition. It was formulated to deceive, by cunning priestly minds, in the first instance, and afterwards accepted as a divine truth by those who possess nothing but their intellectuality to guide them in their gropings for truth. And knowing as we do the Why and Wherefore of its present rapid diffusion, we challenge these esoteric Buddhists to produce one single

individual who is not an irresponsible medium, and who possesses the ability to consciously penetrate the realms of spirit for himself, who can truthfully say that the theory agrees with the actual results of his own personal investigations. From the beginning to the end this re-incarnation and Karma doctrine of Buddhism is a purely external theory which tries to explain the apparent contradictions of physical nature—hence it is destitute of spiritual proof, or of the possibility of spiritual proof, and it is palmed off upon the mental currents of western thought as emanating from supposed holy(?) mahatmas. But we deny *in toto* that such a theory is taught or ever has been taught by any real adept, as a true theory, apart from the magical hierophants of the Inversive Magi, and these beings we do not consider worthy of the name of Adept, seeing that they are the legionaries of the Dark Satellite, and as such are only adepts so far as the mysteries of practical magic are concerned. They cannot penetrate beyond the astral zones of the cosmic and magnetic elementals, hence they know absolutely nothing of the higher states of the soul world, or of the mysteries of angelic life. They deny their very existence, and substitute a delusive Devachan, and dreamy Nirvana of nothingness in their place.

Before going any further we would impress upon our student the fact that there is not a single doctrine within the whole range of Occult science that is not susceptible in its interpretation to the well known Latin proverb, "*cum grano salis*." Further, that every truth is a paradox when

viewed from different planes: this latter fact is especially true regarding re-incarnation.

Commencing at the point where we left off in our previous chapter, in the descent of life into external conditions, we must not omit to note the fact that in its descent the monad has had to pass through every state in the soul-world; through the four realms of the Astral Kingdom, and, lastly, re-appear upon the external plane at the lowest point possible, viz.: the mineral. From this point we see it enter successively the mineral, vegetable and animal life waves of the planet. In obedience to the higher and more interior laws of its own especial round, the divine attributes are ever seeking to unfold their involved potentialities. No sooner is one form dispensed with, or its capabilities exhausted, than a new and still higher form is brought into requisition, each in its turn becoming more complex in its structure and diversified in its functions. Thus we see the atom of life commencing at the mineral in the external world. The grand spiral of its evolutionary life is carried forward slowly, imperceptibly, but always progressively. There is no form too simple, no organism too complex, for the inconceivably marvellous adaptability of the human soul in its divine struggles of progressive life.

Yet, throughout the entire cycle of necessity, the character of its genius, the degree of its spiritual emanation, and the state of life to which it originally belonged, are preserved with mathematical exactitude. These states correspond, in a general sense, to the four ancient elements, Fire, Earth, Air and Water. Yet, as a matter of purifica-

tion alone, each atom must pass through all these states upon its upward journey. Not only so, but before the human monad can possibly attain the climax of its material evolution, which is the grand terminus of its earthly incarnations, it must also have passed through certain phases of its existence upon each planet to which its microcosmic nature in the embodied man shall bear a mathematical correspondence. Thus between the mineral and man there is a perfect scale of life; no one form being parallel with another in the grand chain of cosmic being. Even the insects count, in the links, as progressive states. In the whole of this chain are seven worlds through which the soul monad migrates, and from whatever point or planet it commences its toilsome cosmic journey the seventh planet is the end of its material orbit, and the sphere wherein it attains the human form divine. In no case does the soul monad commence as a mineral and attain unto the animal or human upon the same planet, but it becomes latent on each alternate orb. For instance, the mineral atoms upon this earth will undergo a purely impersonal cycle upon Venus, which is their next sphere, and then become incarnated within the vegetable circuit upon the next planet, and so on; while the mineral atoms of the planet Mars, when they reach this planet, are purely impersonal beings and do not incarnate here as objective forms but pass their cycle in the astral spaces, then enter material conditions again upon Venus. Thus the soul monad has four objective states, and three subjective. The objective are 1-3-5-7, viz.: mineral, vegetable, animal, man. The three subjective states are 2-4-6,

negative states of its embryonic being. This is carried out by the soul after it attains the objective human form or 7th state. The next is beyond matter. "Once and only once" saith the law. After this, nature shuts the door behind her. Eternal progression is the anthem of all creative life.* When we apply these laws to external life we can gauge the soul's past history with an accuracy which is truly marvelous. Thus, for instance, the truly Martial individual belongs to that state of life known in Occult phraseology as Fiery, and consequently those peculiar and especial attributes were "rounded out" upon the planet known as Mars. That is to say, the fiery characteristics of an atom belonging to that state of life corresponding to the Fiery triplicity, were evolved through various organic forms during its cycle of incarnation upon the plane of Mars. On the other hand, a Saturnine individual, during its sojourn upon the Martial

*We have omitted to note the exceptions to the general laws of re-incarnation which have been set forth.

There are three classes of exceptions in which re-birth within the human organism may be the usual course.

Class I. Cases of abortion, or of still-born children. These, not having attained consciousness of the external human state, may, and in fact generally do, become re-incarnated.

Class II. Cases of natural born idiots. Though it is very rare that even idiots are so lost to all external consciousness as to make re-birth necessary to them.

Class III. Cases of special "Messianic" incarnation by exalted souls, for the special purpose of enlightening the race. The laws which govern this mystery are unknown to any except the highest adepts. Such an incarnation transpires about every 600 years, and never twice in succession to the same race. In all cases of Messiahship these glorious souls are conscious of their mission from the moment of birth, though doubtless they wisely keep such precious knowledge to themselves as a protection against the tender mercies of the dominant priesthood of their generation.

In fact, this class may be called cases of conscious re-incarnation. The same spirit is never so incarnated more than once. Hence the stories of Buddha's numerous incarnations are pure fiction.

orb, was but little attracted to the Martial forms of existence. In fact, the soul monad, at that particular stage of its journey, passed through a kind of impersonal coma instead of an active evolutionary life. This was because there was but little affinity between itself and the planet. Consequently, the planet had not sufficient attractive power to project the impersonal soul into the more outward forms of organic being. The same may be said of each planetary characteristic. Their latent or active expression in the embodied individual reveals to the initiated mind the whole of the soul's past history during the various stages of its impersonal planetary life.*

During the process of the soul's involution, the monad is not actually incarnated in any form whatever. The soul descends into earthly conditions down the subjective arc of the spiral, and re-ascends upon the objective. Re-birth commences, as before stated, when the objective mineral state is reached. The process of the monad's descent through the various realms, is accomplished by a gradual polarization of its Deific powers, caused by its contact with the gradually externalizing conditions of the downward arc of the cycle. At each step the soul becomes more and more involved within the material. The sphere of the re-incarnation, embracing the birth of an external form, its transient life, then death, and the same soul's re-birth in a higher and more perfect form of life, is really comprised

*A careful study of this fact will do much to explain the deeper mysteries of Astrology. The planets at a person's birth do not make him what he is; they only harmonize with his conditions.

between the Mineral and Man. Between these two planes the soul must pass through countless forms and phases. It is an absolute truth that, as an impersonal being, "man lives on many earths before he reaches this. Myriads of worlds swarm in space where the soul in rudimental states performs its pilgrimages until its cyclic progress enables it to reach the magnificently organized planet, whose glorious function it is to confer upon the soul self-consciousness. At this point alone does it become man. At every other step of the wild, cosmic journey it is but an embryonic being, a fleeting, temporary shape of matter, an impersonal creature in which a part, but only a part, of the imprisoned soul shines forth; a rudimental form with rudimental functions, ever living, dying, then sustaining a brief spiritual existence only to be re-born again, and thus to sustain the successive round of births and deaths." With each change new organs and new functions are acquired to be utilized by the gradually expanding soul as a means of further development. We see it in the fire of the flint, and even as we watch the revolving sparks of the mineral soul, we can see it burst forth to the sun light in the garb of the lowly lichen. It guards the snow white purity of the lotus, and animates the aromatic glory of the rose. It is the butterfly springing from the chrysalid shell, and the nightingale singing in the grove. "From stage to stage it evolves; new births and new deaths; anon to die, but sure to live again; ever striving and revolving upon the whirling, toilsome, dreadful, rugged path until it awakes for the last time on earth; awakes once more a material shape, a thing

of dust, a creature of flesh and blood, but now a man." The grand, self conscious stage, humanity, is attained, and the climax of earthly incarnation is reached. Never again will it enter the material matrix or suffer the pains of material re-incarnation. Henceforth its re-births are in the realm of spirit.

Those who hold the strangely illogical doctrine of a multiplicity of human births, have certainly never evolved the lucid state of soul consciousness within themselves. Had they done so, the theory of re-incarnation as held by a vast number of talented men and women, well versed in worldly wisdom, would not have received the slightest recognition at the present day. We would strongly impress the fact that an external education is comparatively worthless as a means of obtaining a true knowledge of nature. Remember, that though the acorn becomes the oak, and the cocoanut the palm; the oak, though giving birth to myriad others, never again becomes an acorn, nor the palm the juicy nut. So it is with man. When once the soul becomes incarnated in the human organism, and thus attains the consciousness of external life, man becomes a self responsible being, accountable for his actions. This accountability constitutes his earth karma, (a subject which is explained in the chapter devoted to its exposition,) and the reward or punishment as the case may be is consciously and divinely administered in the state which each individual soul has prepared for itself. The soul is not ignorantly ushered again into the world, completely unconscious of its past load of karma. Such a means of redemption, instead of being

divine, would be void of justice. It would be diabolical. When human laws punish the criminal, he is conscious of the misdeed for which he is suffering. If this were not so the punishment would be horribly unjust. For this reason we do not punish irresponsible children, nor insane men. It is thoroughly useless, however, to deal any further with such a transcendent delusion. We will, therefore, only say that all the so-called re-awakenings of latent memories, by which certain people profess to remember certain past lives can be explained, and in fact are only really explainable, by the simple laws of affinity and form. This subject will be dealt with in the chapter upon Mediumship.

Each race of human beings is immortal in itself; so likewise is each round. The first round never becomes the second, but those belonging to the first round become the parents or originators of the second, so that each round constitutes a great planetary family which contains within itself races, sub-races and still minor groups of human souls; each state being formed by the laws of its karma, and the laws of its form and the laws of its affinity—a trinity of laws. At the expiration of one round, the polar day of evolution is brought to a close and the life wave leaves the shores of the planet. The second round of humanity—offspring of the first—does not commence until the human life wave, having gone round the whole planetary chain again reaches the planet, a period considerably over 15,000,000 years.* Hence man is similar to the acorn and the oak.

*The exact length of the polar day (the period of the earth's poles making one complete revolution in the heavens) is the exact duration of the life

The embryonic, impersonal soul becomes the man just as the acorn becomes the oak; and as the oak gives birth to innumerable acorns or embryonic oaks, so does man, in his turn, become the means of giving spiritual birth to innumerable souls. There is a complete correspondence between the two.

From what has been said the student will perceive that each round of humanity becomes more numerous. This is a truth, and the expanded material knowledge of each succeeding generation makes it possible for our earth to sustain a greater number upon a given surface.

CHAPTER II.

THE HERMETIC CONSTITUTION OF MAN.

The reader by this time should be somewhat familiar with the origin, nature and activities of the divine Ego which gives birth to the spirit monad of man. All things origin-

wave upon our planet, and though this period varies upon each planet, the average of the chain is exactly the same as that of our earth. This period is 2 592 000 years, or 50'' of space per century. Therefore, the exact time required for the life wave, leaving this earth, making the circuit of the chain to its re-appearance, is 15 552,000, or, as stated above over fifteen millions of years. Esoteric Buddhists have repeatedly said that none but their divine Mahatmas were acquainted with the exact length of these cycles. Well, here they are; the secret is no longer concealed. If the digits of 15 552,000 be added together, the sum will be 18. The digits of this number, added together, make 9 the sacred number of deity. The same is the case with the length of the life wave upon the planet. 2,592,000=18=9, and so it is with all sacred cycles. Nine is the grand key number which unlocks their mysteries. The six days of creation mentioned in Genesis are six polar days, or the space of time between which all the life waves pass successively over the earth until the appearance of the human wave at the close of the sixth day or the beginning of the seventh state.

ating as the objective outcome of the divine and subjective idea; the human Ego, the offspring of that celestial harmony; a differentiated atom of diffusive formless spirit, through the angelic activities of paternal souls who are representative of the Love and Wisdom—intelligence and truth—within the sun sphere of creative life. We have endeavored to make these points as clear as possible, because of their primary importance in realizing that that point in the arc, which is claimed by the Buddhist cult and their followers as the origin of the soul's formation, is not so, but is in fact only the great turning point, the bottom rung of Jacob's esoteric ladder, upon which the soul's ascent and descent is made.

The Theosophists of the human re-incarnation school, while admitting the absolute divinity of the Ego, fail to account for the genesis of the soul which the Ego evolves, otherwise than in matter. So far as we have been able to learn, not one of them has any conception as to how, when or where the differentiation, even of the Ego itself, takes place, and although they hold that there is a spiritual evolution preceding all material evolution, they consider that the first spiritual manifestation of the soul is an arcane mystery, which only the highest adepts may partake of. These adepts of the Buddhist Cultus however totally ignore the state of angelhood, they deny its existence, because they, in this concentrated sphere of absolute selfhood,* can form

*The charge of spiritual selfishness has often been made even by theosophists against the teachings of their mahatmas, and there is good foundation for the charge when their teachings are critically examined.

no conception of such a state. It is as much above and beyond the grasp of their minds as the doctrine of Nirvan is beyond the grasp of the African bushman. They are particularly fond of applying to outsiders that proverb which intimates that there are more laws in heaven and earth than are dreamed of in man's philosophy, but they fail to apply this truism to their own august selves.

In our chapter upon re-incarnation, we briefly pointed out the actual sphere of re-birth within objective forms, and in doing so many important features were omitted which appear to belong to that subject, but which in reality belong to the present one.

Re-incarnation within progressive forms is not for the sole purpose of evolving and energizing the latent powers of the human soul, as so many ignorantly imagine. If this were true, and man alone the sole object of development, it would constitute the basis of absolute selfishness, but as there is nothing approaching to selfishness in the creative design, we can safely assert that such human exclusiveness is only an appearance. When we penetrate below this plane of appearances, we find countless realms of beings, equally as immortal as man, going through their cyclic rounds, obeying the same universal law as ourselves. These realms constitute stepping stones for the external humanity in its journey towards the infinite, and the organisms of humanity in their turn form the evolutionary spheres or material means by which these same realms pass through their cycles of progressive life. If we make use of certain planes for our soul's advancement, it only follows as a matter of reac-

tionary law (justice) that we should render an equivalent service in return, hence the importance of a true knowledge of our hidden or Hermetic constitution.

Man, as we behold him by means of the physical senses, appears to us a wonderful specimen of mechanical skill and architectural beauty. Each organic part is so exquisitely formed, and in such perfect unison one with another, and each with the whole, that there is little wonder that the human organism has been taken as the finite type of the unknown infinite. If this be true upon the external plane, it is infinitely more so upon the internal, where bone, flesh, blood, and hair, the externals of the outward body, are seen to be nothing but the crystallizations of ethereal force, held together by mental being. Not held together as a matter of necessity, for the sake of its own especial evolutions, but simply as the natural outcome, the physical reaction of its ethereal activities. In order to present a clear and definite picture of what man really is, we will formulate his Hermetic constitution.

A. A physical form fourfold in its composition, consisting in a general sense of bones, blood, flesh, and hair. This form, as a whole, is composed of an infinite number of separate organic cells, each cell constituting a minute system of its own, which in its turn has been formed by the crystallization of imponderable forces around a living spirit entity.

B. An electro-vital body, seemingly composed of pale phosphorescent light, enclosing a glittering skeleton framework of electric fire. This is the purely electro-magnetic

form, inseparable from the physical body during life, seeing that this latter depends for its continued existence upon the active presence of the former. The pale phosphorescent light presents a very perfect outline portrait of the physical body, while the fiery skeleton shows the interior electro-nervous system of the organism. The branches of the nerve system, spreading out in every direction from the great trunk lines of the brain and spinal column, present to the trained spiritual sight the appearance of an infinitude of fine pencil rays of light darting in straight lines with inconceivable rapidity toward every point of the compass.

C. An astral form, so called because it is composed of the magnetic light evolved by the planet. This astral light differs in quality and degree upon every orb in the universe. It is generated from the universal ether of space, and it may be said to be the ether under a change of form and capacity. It is the soul of the material planet, consequently the cause world of that planet's external phenomena. To give a better and truer idea of this almost unknown astral light we will illustrate. We say that water is the universal material fluid. This is a truth, but some water is salt, some brackish, some bitter, others sulphuric or sweet and fresh. This is exactly the case with the astral fluid. It differs upon every star. It is this difference that constitutes the strikingly different qualities of planetary influence. With this slight digression we resume. This astral form presents a perfect image of the external personality, even to style and condition of the clothing worn at the time. This form is easily separable from the physical organism,

and constitutes the true or real personality. By personality we do not mean the individuality or identity of the person, but we mean the persona, or appearance assumed by the soul during its sojourn within the material vortices, or planes of cosmic force. This form is under the direct control of the mental being animating it, and, under suitable conditions, can be made to assume (temporarily) any ideal image or form within the grasp of the dominating mind. When the astral double is absent from the physical body, the latter, if awake, performs whatever it may be engaged in, in a purely automatic or mechanical manner, and is also susceptible to the pain and injury which may befall the absent double. The astral is also specially susceptible to magical operations, and probably nine tenths of all black magical injury are operated by means of or upon this ethereal form.

D. The animal soul, or that section of the animating entity incarnated within the microcosm, which constitutes the lower arc of its universe. This animal soul is formless as regards its separate expression, and can be traced only in the lower lines and shadings of the human countenance. It is the seat of the selfish desires, which are in themselves lower than the human sphere but evolving upward through it from the animal. Their activities are strictly confined to the astral and material planes.

E. The spiritual body, *per se*, a finely etherealized organism which in the majority of the present generation is either latent or embryonic. This constitutes the human form divine in the higher sphere of the soul world where

man becomes the angel. It is the white robe and golden crown given the elect in the Apocalypse of St. John. In other words, it is the soul's expression of the heavenly raiment of the purified man.

F. The divine soul, or that section of the entity incarnated within the microcosm which constitutes the higher arc of its universe. This soul, like the lower one, is formless as to its separate expression, and can be traced only in the higher lines of the human countenance. It is the seat of the good, unselfish, noble aspirations, and of all those actions which spring forth spontaneously to aid the weak, the suffering and afflicted, unassociated with any interested motives of self.

G. The pure spirit entity itself, called the divine Ego. This is the divine atom of life, the central controlling spiritual sun of the microcosm. It is never incarnated within the form until the seventh state or perfect manhood is attained.

The above are the exact divisions of the human constitution, as viewed from without and within. Upon the surface this division will not appear to differ very materially from the septenary formula of the Buddhist cult. But, in reality, there is all the difference which exists between Cause and Effect. The chief point of difference will be found in the fifth principle as they term it, and which is called also the human soul, *manas* or mind. 'Mind,' though correct in some respects, is, to say the least, a very vague and unsatisfactory term to express intellectual capacity or the power of thinking and reasoning, and reducing the objects of thought to a science. For this reason, mind exists

as a motive force all the way from the mineral to man, and surely Buddhists will not say that the rocks contain their fifth principle. It is upon this point in particular where, in the opinion of the student of Hermetic philosophy, Esoteric Buddhists make a very serious mistake. It is the evolution of this "principle," we are told, that gives us the power of understanding; without this we should be upon the plane of the animal and act from mere instinct; when this principle is active, man becomes noble, humane and capable of understanding, or, in other words, instead of being a creature of instinct only, becomes a reasonable being. We question the whole of such teachings. For instance, a man may be the intellectual giant of his age, so far as mere mental capacity is concerned, and yet at the same time be the most selfish, unjust and immoral. History teems with such examples; while, at the same time, some of nature's noblest souls have been those whose intellectual abilities have been very much below the average of the race. There are intellectual animals among mankind, human only in form; while, on the other hand, there are many demented human beings whose souls are akin to the angels. "This fifth principle," we are told, "is the highest principle of the animals."* But Hermetic initiates deny this *in toto*. They assert that this "principle" is no principle at all, but merely a form; that in real fact there are only three principles in an active state, viz.: animal, human and deific. The remaining four are merely forms or reactions. It is the action and reaction of these principles which produce every class of mental

*See page 175, "The Mystery of the Ages."

phenomena in existence, be it vegetable sensitiveness, animal instinct, human reason or deific perception. They form the three primary colors of the soul's spectrum; the remaining forms are simply complementary reactions.

The Hermetic constitution of man consists of three active principles—emanations from the one universal principle—and four secondary reactions. This constitution will correspond to the trinity of the ancient Gnostics and the modern spiritualists, as consisting of body, soul and spirit, in the following manner: Body, (A and B); Soul, (C and D); Spirit, (E and F and G). It also corresponds to the quaternary or fourfold constitution of the Kabbalists and the Greek speculators on Egyptian Theosophy, who taught that there is a body, an astral or magnetic body, the animal soul, and the divine soul. Body, (A and B); astral body, (C); animal soul, (D); divine soul, (E, F and G). And so may we proceed with every system we have any knowledge of, the only contradictions are the appearances upon the surface, chiefly due to an insufficient use, or to a misuse of terms. In reality there is no difference in any system, when it is traced to its primal source. The same may be said of the Buddhist constitution, when understood in its true spirit. The radical differences are due to their gross misinterpretation of the one fundamental law — one truth, one principle, one agent (or law) and one word.

We must now briefly sketch the Hermetic constitution, and present the four fold teaching of the Western initiates. Man consists of three duads* which stand in the relation of

*3 duads which make 6, and the Ego, total 7.

Refraction and Reflection to each other. They are as follows:

<i>First duad.</i>	<i>Second duad.</i>	<i>Third duad.</i>
Refraction.—Electro-magnetic form.	Animal soul.	Divine soul.
Reflection.—Physical body.	Astral body.	Spiritual form.

The whole of these three duads are controlled and carried forward in their cyclic orbit by the Divine Ego, the absolute atomic spirit entity. Thus the three duads and the Ego constitute the fourfold microcosm of the Hermetic schools. This is the most perfect system that can be formulated in words because the duads travel in pairs. At death we lose A and B. Then, during our purgatorial process through the sphere of purification in the soul states of the disembodied humanity C and D are gradually thrown off;* the unprepared atoms liberated and sent forward upon their own special lines, and all gross matter eliminated. The animal principles are no portion of the purified soul and are dispersed as separate cells within the cause world, and ultimately nothing is left but the trinity, E F and G, or rather the duad E and F, because the true Ego G does not become a part of it until it has ascended beyond these soul spheres. At this point man is the positive or male spirit or the Ego; woman, the feminine. The true angel requires the spiritual union of both principles.

Man, as he appears to the outward sight, is, as we have shown, very different from the being within. He contains

*Not separated, as one would quarter up an orange, but gradually thrown off atom by atom, as they are ready to move forward upon their progressive journey.

a universe of life within his organism; countless myriads of spirit atoms are evolving through him and are as independent of him, in reality, as man is of the planet which gave him birth. The truly human being is the most interior or spiritual soul. The whole of the lower nature and the external organism are only the various realms of being which the human monad has conquered and subjected to its imperial rule during its cyclic journey. We should say, to be true, that the externals are the reflections of those elemental states moulded more or less rudely by the human soul after its own divine form. The millions of separate entities within the human sphere are no more the real man than the forty million inhabitants of France were Napoleon who ruled them with his imperial will.

A few words now regarding the WILL and the REASON, and we must close. Will is universal, and it is as impossible to point out where it begins or where it ends as it is to separate the colors of the rainbow. The power of the will upon the external plane depends upon the strength of the electro-vital constitution B. While upon the spiritual plane it depends upon the activity of the spiritual constitution E. Within the astral plane the potent will must have both these well developed to be successful. If B alone is potent, only the elemental realms can be contacted. If only E is active, then the higher or spiritual world will be contacted, not the astral. Under these circumstances nothing but mediumship can be attained. The true form of training, then, is to evolve that which is most latent, so as to bring about the equilibrium. In the great majority of

cases, of course, it is the spiritual that requires evolving. Considering the will as a universal power, it naturally follows that the strength of our will must depend entirely upon the capacity we possess for absorbing and reprojecting the same. In fact, Man's will is only limited by his capacity to absorb the one Universal Will. This will is not, in itself, a principle; it is only an active result, viz.: transcendental matter in rapid motion. Everything utilizes some portion of this will in its own peculiar way.

The reason, manas, or mind, is simply mental capacity and, like the will, is not a principle but a result. Intellect is the offspring of innumerable and constantly changing causes or combinations of force never repeated under exactly the same conditions, consequently no two people are exactly alike. The seat or mainspring of reason, intellect, understanding and mind is consciousness, and whether it will be good or evil will depend upon the respective activities of the animal and divine souls. The higher the soul evolves the more spiritual the understanding becomes until perfect rapport with the divine spirit is attained. This is the true at-one-ment. Man made perfect.

From the foregoing the student must perceive that a man may be a perfect intellectual genius upon the physical plane, and at the same time a veritable idiot in a spiritual sense, and God only knows how many of the former are standing before the world as the grand repositories of absolute knowledge.

CHAPTER III.

KARMA.

“If we are ever to know anything clearly we must be released from the body, that the soul by itself may see things by themselves as they really are.”—*Socrates*.

We need scarcely say that we fully agree with the above remarks of Plato's teacher. While in the body we are completely fenced in by delusive appearances, and had the Greek sage been alive to-day those prominent individuals who so loudly and glibly speak and write upon the subject of Karma would have been very greatly inconvenienced by the Athenian's terrible logic.

“Karma is the law of consequences — of merit and demerit,” say the Buddhists. “It is that force which moulds our physical destiny in this world, and regulates our period of misery or happiness in the world to come.” We are also further informed that “Karma is the cold, inflexible justice which metes out to each individual the exact same measure of good and evil at his next physical re-birth that he measured to his fellow-men in this.” Not only so, but this karma at death remains somewhere or other down upon the astral planes of the planet, like an avenging demon, waiting anxiously for the period of Devachanic happiness to come to an end, in order to re-project the poor unfortunate soul once more into the magnetic vortices of material incarnation, where, with its load of bad karma hanging like a millstone round its neck, it will in all human probability generate a still greater load of this theo-

logical dogma, and consequently at each re-birth it will sink deeper unless the spiritual Ego can bring it to some consciousness of its fearfully sinful state. How this may transpire is not very satisfactorily explained. If the human soul only receives punishment for the sins and wrongs it inflicted upon others during a previous life, then, surely, the soul when it first became incarnated must have started on its human journey without any karma to suffer for. One is naturally led to ask, then, how it first began to commit sin? For we are distinctly told that what we now suffer at the hands of others is only a just repayment for our own past sins. If, then, we had no past sins, we should be perfectly free from trouble. We are distinctly taught that the first or pre-adamite men, *i. e.*, those of the golden age, were perfect. How, then, did this abominable karma get a start in the world? This question it is our duty to fully explain in the present chapter.

We have given a general idea of the Karma of Theosophical Buddhism, and before revealing the origin of this Oriental delusion we will present the Hermetic doctrine of Karma.

I. Karma is not an active principle but, on the contrary, it is crystallized force. It is the picture gallery or cosmic play of nature.

II. Karma constitutes the scenery, essence and mental imagery of a person's past existence.

III. The karmic sphere of an individual's existence, exists as the astral life currents along which the soul has traveled and which become crystallized forms, expressive of

the actions and the motives which prompted them. Therefore our past karma constitutes the soul's past history in the astral light, and can be deciphered by the properly trained lucid, and even by some mediumistic clairvoyants.

IV. Karma is the offspring of everything, or, in other words, everything possesses pictorial records of its past evolutions,—stones, plants, animals and men. It is by means of this karma that the Psychometric sensitive can read the unwritten past. Without karma, the powers of Psychometry would be useless. They, however, can only deal with small karmas. On a grander scale exists the karma of moons, planets, suns and systems. Races of men, species of animals and classes of plants also evolve special racial karmas which constitute their astral world.

V. The harmonies and discords of cosmic evolution generate their special karma just the same as thoughts and emotions.

VI. Karma is absolutely confined to the realms of the astral light, and consequently is always subjective. Karma can, therefore, only exist as long as the soul which generates it is attached to the same planet. When the soul leaves the planet the karma disintegrates. A soul cannot carry its karma around the universe with it, because this astral light differs in quality and degree upon each orb. (See Chapter II.)

VII. When the soul enters the spiritual states of the soul world (which Buddhists term Devachan), the power of its earthly karma can never re-attract it to earth; its influence over the soul is forever lost. The lower can never

control the higher, when once they exist apart. To assert that the past fossilized karma can re-attract the soul from the realms of spiritual happiness and re-project it into the mire of earth is to exalt matter to the throne of Deity, and degrade pure spirit to the level of a passive brute substance.

From the above seven statements it will be seen that the Hermetic initiates assert that karma is not the primary law of consequences and destiny. It is not an active principle always at work re-adjusting nature's ridiculous mistakes. Nature never yet made a mistake. On the contrary, karma is shown to be a result; the subjective outcome of innumerable laws and forces, and in this life it is utterly powerless to effect either good or evil, so far as our destiny is concerned upon the external plane. But, upon the interior plane, that is, upon or within the astral sphere of the disembodied soul world, this karma becomes the Book of Life from which all our actions in this are judged. At death we are surrounded by and compelled to exist within our own karma, we are forced by the laws of magnetic affinity to work out our own redemption ever face to face with the grim idols of our earthly past. The foul, unlovely pictures of every unclean imagination will haunt us, and set our very souls aflame with the consciousness of every injustice and wrong we have committed. The only redeeming feature will be the good karma, the kind unselfish thoughts and noble aspirations we have evolved; all our true, unselfish love for our fellow-creatures will spring up like flowers at our feet, and help to aid and brighten our path upward and onward through the spheres of purification and purgatory,

until at last we shall enter the sphere of immortal life where those whom we have loved below may be waiting to greet us.

We have asserted that karma is utterly powerless to effect either good or evil so far as the material destiny is concerned. Now, while this is true within certain limits, seeing that karma is but the astral record of the past, yet this statement requires explanation. It is not the actions we commit that can, in themselves, bring happiness or misery, benefit or misfortune to the actor, but it is the effects which our actions have upon others that really produce immediate material results, and the precise effect which any action will have will depend entirely upon the peculiar mental states surrounding us at the time. For instance, in one age it may be considered a very meritorious action to roast a poor helpless medium under the name of a witch, but at another period such an action will be followed by an indignant spirit of public resentment, and a terrible penalty will be imposed by the law of the state to satisfy the public sense of justice. The praiseworthy actions of one age become the criminal ones of another. We see, therefore, that the result of any action upon the material plane depends upon the physical, moral, mental and spiritual development of the race. This is not the case, however, within the astral soul world. There, absolute justice is the universal law: the mighty hero of a thousand fights, who dies surrounded by all the pomp and vanity of public worship, comes face to face with the fearful reality that he is, nevertheless, a blood stained murderer, and as such he must work out his own salvation amid trial and suffering. His purgatorial

state will depend in a great measure upon his motives, and the consciousness of his earthly actions. If he was a true patriot, who fought simply for the love and liberty of his country and people against cruel oppression, his conscience will deal very lightly with him. But if love of fame and martial glory were his chief motives, and constituted the greater part of his karma, then so much the worse for him.

The reader will notice that in the Hermetic definitions of karma, the soul when working out its past iniquities is perfectly conscious of its task, and knows the true why and wherefore of its suffering. Not only so, but it has also the certain hope of final emancipation, not, however, until, as the parable says, "thou hast paid the uttermost farthing." Herein, then, is the truth and justice of nature's laws revealed. But in the definition of Buddhism, this justice is absolutely wanting. In their outrageous scheme of esoteric philosophy, the millions of souls upon the earth are perfectly ignorant of what they are suffering for. They are ushered into the world for the purpose of undergoing the fiery torments of their old fossilized karma, and are completely ignorant of the fact. How can the average mortal work off his bad karma when he does not know that he has any, nor what he is working and suffering for? If we cruelly abuse a dog when it is full grown for some offense or other committed when a puppy, it would be considered an outrageous piece of cruelty, because the dog would be perfectly ignorant of what the punishment was for. The same may be said of inflicting punishment upon the material man for some forgotten offense of his infancy.

The reader should ever remember that no punishment is just, when the one punished is ignorant of the cause. Punishment under such circumstances not only ceases to be just, but becomes diabolical injustice. The common justice of human nature condemns such a proceeding. If this is true, how much more severe must be the condemnation of that justice which is divine?

At this stage of our subject, the student will doubtless ask, "if human suffering is not the result of previous karma, what is the real cause of so much misery in the world?" To this we reply, human suffering is the result of innumerable laws, which in their action and reaction produce discord at certain intervals in the scale of human development. For all practical purposes, they may be classed under two general heads as primary and secondary. The primary cause is that of racial evolution. Each round and each race of the round requires different external conditions in order to evolve its chief attributes; for each round and race become the special means by which a certain one of the soul's attributes is rounded out, as it is termed. Let us illustrate. The first or primal race were those of the Golden age. They were a purely ethereal race of beings, and cannot be strictly classified with what we know of humanity, nor can they be said to have been really incarnated in gross matter at all. For this reason, their penetrative power was very small; hence, though highly spiritual, they were correspondingly simple; they lived an ideal life amid semi-spiritual surroundings. The second race, that of the Silver age, penetrated deeper into matter than their Golden fore-

fathers, and their bodies consequently became more dense. Toward the termination of this race, and the beginning of the third or Copper age, the equator of our racial arc was reached in the descending scale. Here it was that the first murmurings of a mental storm began to manifest themselves; emigrations and partings took place between what had previously been a united people, and consequently separate national interests began to evolve. When our earth reaches the equinoctial points of the year, storms and tempests abound. Upon a higher plane, it is the same with the progress of man around the cycle. With the Copper race a still further descent took place, and a still greater increase of self-interest was evolved; from the national was evolved that of the family. Kings ascended thrones, and sacerdotal systems were formulated; the strong began to assert their greater force, and the weak gradually sank into subjection. A still further descent and we come to the fourth race, the bottom rung in the cyclic ladder, and fittingly known as the Iron age. This was the turning point of the seven races wherein the soul attains its greatest penetrating power; spirit can descend no lower. Kings and their priestly counsellors became true despots, and the masses the helpless and oppressed. Next comes a higher evolution. The fifth race, beginning at the end of the fourth, reaches up to the equinoctial line of the mental arc in the ascending scale, and consequently another stormy period commences. All is strife and turmoil. It is the struggle of the oppressed against the oppressor. It is not the gentle mental storm of the Silver equinox, because a spiritual period of light had

preceded that era, but it is the storm of war and blood-shed; of a fierce democracy battling for the rights divine of man against usurped authority. It is thus because the Iron age of oppression has preceded it. We are at the present day passing through this fearful equinoctial period. The fifth race is coming to a close, and already forerunners of the sixth race are among the people, aiding in the spread of glorious truth. No wonder, then, that the signs of the times are so significant, and that a real interest in mental and spiritual science is rapidly re-awakening within the minds of the masses.

The secondary causes are man's ignorance, and the reactions of his animal nature. That is to say, man makes the conditions that are necessary for his progress by alternately struggling with and yielding to his animal desires. But for this nature and the experience the soul gains thereby, material incarnation might be dispensed with. The state of suffering depends upon the race, as before stated, but the effects of that suffering are in exact fulfillment of mother nature's requirements. Mighty causes produce mighty effects,—results, let us say, and *vice versa*. This law is absolute. Every spiritual atom of life is the direct result of a cause. These atoms differ in power and potency, as the stars differ in magnitude. Nature's aim is not equality. In spite of the apparent fact that all forces are ever striving for equilibrium, her grand goal is diversity. Nature's end, then, is the very opposite of equality; for the grand ultimate aim of every force is the production of variety, and the only real difference in any of her infinite

number of parts is that of polarity. For instance, the only difference between the Hottentot and the intellectual genius of modern civilized society is that which marks off their souls' respective polarity. It is simply a question of personal opinion as to which of the two is the best and wisest. The civilized shams and personal adornments of society may more than counterbalance the crude decorations of the savage. The false Theology and cant of orthodox religion, combined with the many erroneous theories of so-called science, may more than make up for barbarian ignorance; for many savages are more learned in the real laws of nature than some of our college professors. But be that as it may, the savage will be the real gainer of the two in most cases, for he will not have false dogmatic opinions to unlearn and forget. And, lastly, we would add, the morality of any savage will compare very favorably with the morality of many of our populous centers. In fact, the external differences between the two are only appearances, evolved chiefly by our own thoroughly biased and artificial educations. Another factor in these secondary causes of human suffering is the human will, or rather, man's capacity for utilizing the great will-force of the cosmos. Ignorance alone limits human possibilities in this direction, for it is man's place in nature to sway the mighty pendulum of force between the higher and the lower states of life — the super-mundane and sub-mundane realms of being — and in so doing his mission consists in evolving the attributes of the soul, and gaining all the experience possible. If suffering is necessary to enable him to accomplish this,

then he will suffer. But be the causes and consequences what they may in this life, depend upon it that what the soul suffers from discord it will be justly compensated for by the sum total of results when the cycle of its purification is over, and the past can be measured at its true worth.

We have now presented, as concisely as possible, the Hermetic explanation of karma, and shown that it is not the all-ruling force that Buddhism would make it. We will now expose this oriental delusion, and reveal its priestly origin. To begin with, we must carefully bear in mind a few all important facts regarding the esoteric philosophy of the dreamy Orient.

I. Anciently the real truths of all religion, especially those relating to the soul, its nature, incarnations and karma, were rigidly concealed from the people by a jealous priesthood.

II. In the place of truth fiction was substituted, or, in other words, the real truth was veiled and the appearances of truth taught instead, and in order to obtain absolute power it became necessary to formulate the dogma that their high priest, the pontiff or hierophant as he was called, was a direct incarnation of the Deity or a re-incarnation of that being.

III. In process of time the priests themselves became corrupt and worldly, consequently their spiritual perception sank into mental reflection, and they not only lost the secrets of their religion and mythology, which were never committed to writing, but became themselves the dupes of their own theology, and accepted their formulated husks as divine

truth. We have a similar example in the christian clergy of to-day.

The history of the rise and fall of nations, and the researches of all genuine Occultists, will support the above assertions. In fact, "Isis Unveiled"* teems with facts corroborating our statements. Hermetic initiates assert most emphatically that both doctrines, viz.: re-incarnation and karma, are nothing more than the theological dogmas of an interested sacerdotal system. That is to say, the teachings based upon these doctrines by the Buddhist and other religious systems are false—that the real facts of re-incarnation and karma were originally concealed, and then forgotten in the lapse of time. It is very easy indeed to prove that the accepted theories of the Theosophical Buddhists of the present day are nothing but the popular external dogmas taught to the ignorant masses ten thousand years ago. Here are a few of the facts:

I. The oldest records we possess prove that human re-incarnation and karma were the popular doctrines of the masses, consequently they were only appearances—they were untrue because the real truth was always concealed from the people. Upon this matter A. P. Sinnet says: "This doctrine of karma is one of the most interesting features of Buddhist philosophy. There has been no secret about it at any time." Certainly, this is exactly what Hermetic initiates claim. It is a dogma of the Buddhist church,

*Notwithstanding this the author of the miscellaneous work in question has repeatedly attempted to explain these statements away; each attempt, however, has only made the original confusion more confounded.

and was never concealed because, being false, it was not worth concealing. On the contrary it was always taught to the suffering masses groaning beneath despotic rule. It was exceedingly potent as a means of making the people submit quietly to the authority of the church and the tyranny of the king, who always went hand and glove with the priest. The masses were taught to believe that by submitting to the yoke they were thus working off previous bad karma—a very convenient doctrine we must all admit.

II. The chief Hierophant of Buddhism and the Tibetan adepts is the Taley Lama of Lhassa. "Every Lama," says Madam Blavatsky, "is subject to the grand Taley Lama, the Buddhist pope of Thibet, who holds his residence at Lhassa and is a re-incarnation of Buddha." This assertion fully corroborates what we said previously. Note well the last sentence, "and is a re-incarnation of Buddha." Compare this with the fact II. on page 89, and you will discover that once more we find the leaders of Theosophic Buddhism re-asserting the theological dogmas of a church, and teaching them for truth. Buddhists would have us really believe that Buddha continues to incarnate and re-incarnate age after age. We can only say that no soul who has passed through the trials of material incarnation and the fires of spiritual purification would submit to continually exist within a material organism, and endure from age to age the hell of a Grand Lama's life. For the formulas, ceremonies and usages of a religious potentate are indeed a hell to the pure in heart.

We shall be met face to face with the assertion that

with very high adepts and other exalted souls these things are different, that nature's laws are either reversed or transcended. To this we would say that such statements are false; they are of the same stamp as the Roman Catholic Bulls of the past, nothing but priestly word-juggling. Nature is no respecter of persons, and neither Buddha nor any other soul can continue to re-incarnate from age to age. The most that such a dominant mind could do would be to obsess and mould an unborn foetus to suit its purpose and then, by virtue of such obsession, partially inhabit the same. Under these circumstances the physical body is but the helpless machine of a dominant foreign mind, and we need scarcely say that no purified soul would sink to such a plane of existence. This question of obsession brings us to the subject of our next chapter, therefore we must bring the present one to a close, merely remarking, as a conclusion, that the whole teaching of Re-incarnation and Karma as taught by Buddhism, esoteric (?) or otherwise, is purely dogma; it is materialism run to seed, combined with oriental speculations. It is a huge system of selfishness to work out good here for the sake of greater good hereafter. Such motives of exchange are corrupt. As Socrates says: "We give up some small pleasures for still greater pleasures." This, instead of being truly good, is the polar opposite. **MOTIVE ALONE** is the mainspring of action, according to the Hermetic doctrine. Do good, not for the sake of gaining good thereby, but for the sake of simple goodness and virtue alone. There is too much of the "I am holier than thou" about the teachings of karma. A prosperous

but self-righteous Pharisee gloats over his previous good karma when he sees his down-trodden brother, and when he aids it is because he thinks the karma of the action will well repay him. Then again, when any serious case of suffering is presented to these great Buddhist souls for their magical intervention and psychological aid, we are piously informed that karma cannot be interfered with. If, instead of this, they said that to aid was beyond the reach of their power, they would probably speak the real truth. Lastly, let us say distinctly that the present writer has put the assertion of old Socrates (heading this chapter) to the test. The whole of these Hermetic teachings have been personally verified when free from the control of the body, within the realms of spirit, and therefore we know whereof we write. In our next chapter we shall deal with some of the so-called evidences of re-incarnation and karma, and show them to be nothing of the kind.

CHAPTER IV.

MEDIUMSHIP—ITS NATURE AND MYSTERIES.

“All are but parts of one stupendous whole,
Whose body nature is, and God the soul.”

“What is mediumship, and who are the mediums?” was the question we once asked of the initiated masters of Occult science. The answer received was as broad in its application as the universe itself. “Everything is mediumistic, and every atom is a medium for the expression of

spiritual force. God alone is the great central controlling spirit," said the master. Long years of spiritual research have not only verified the truth of the answer received, but have established in the mind of the writer the certainty that every word is an absolute fact.

We find that throughout the vast infinitude of our universe the spiritual and the material are so intimate that to attempt to classify and separate them, or to account for phenomena on the basis of either alone, would be like erecting an edifice without a foundation, or building upon a ground work whose stability is as infirm as the sinking quicksands.

Modern science commences with matter, and confines its researches strictly to the domain of material forms and forces. It terminates at the very moment when its path impinges on the border of the imponderable, "the unknowable," whereas the real starting point of all true science is within the spiritual spaces. From this state its vast orbit sweeps downward throughout the whole universe of matter, recognizing but the different attributes and manifestations of the one Divine Force in every form of creation: its decisions again ultimating in the realm of spirit. Divinity is unity, and the two great attributes of the divine soul coalesce as matter and spirit in the universe of manifested being. Matter is visible, solidified spirit, that is, the passive or negative principle in a concrete, condensed or material form. Spirit is the movable, ever active, positive principle in motion, and between these two states there ramifies every grade of being.

Matter ranges and transforms itself from the lower and

denser state of the mineral upward to the ærial and invisible gases, terminating in the "universal ether" of science. In this refined condition the active and positive principles of Divinity again become united and are transformed into creative force. Hence it must be apparent to the thoughtful reader that the universal ether contains within itself all that is, that was, or that ever will be. Such being the actual facts of the case, what are the logical conclusions that the student of spiritual philosophy may draw therefrom? They are briefly these:—

I. That the universe is one mighty, inconceivable medium, and Deity the controlling and omnipotent spirit.

II. That Love becomes the medium of Wisdom, or, in other words, the passive becomes the medium of the active state; consequently matter is and must be the absolute medium of mind.

III. That the passive nature of the divine soul is the only means whereby the active spirit of Divinity can manifest itself, and upon this basis rests all the mysteries of the cosmos.

IV. In view of these facts we find that the universal will, utilized by the imperial soul of man, is alone the true center of all magical and spiritual power manifested upon earth. Man is the great pivot around which revolves every phase of magical, magnetic and mental phenomena embraced within the realms of mundane psychology.

It has seemed necessary to the writer to re-impress all the above facts upon the mind of the reader, notwithstanding the fact that they have been very fully elaborated in the

previous chapters, because they constitute the fundamental verities—the actual principles which underlie the realities of mediumship, and therefore are of primary importance.

Mediumship is a well-known term to the present generation, and is applied to that state of sensibility which, though found pure and natural in some individuals, has been artificially developed in others, whereby they are enabled to come *en rapport* with invisible intelligences, and other powers, both physical and mental; in other words, their odyllic sphere (magnetic aural) has received a degree of sensitiveness compatible with their becoming mediums of communication for said forces. A medium therefore is, properly speaking, a person or object in whom the capacity of reception and transmission is so fully evolved as to become of practical value in eliciting phenomena. That all human beings in their natural state are mediumistic—some in excess of others—must, after what has been stated, appear perfectly plain; especially when we comprehend the relation of humanity to Deity. In a similar manner all material substances are “mediumistic” in this sense of the term, viz., being capable of receiving and transmitting force. Therefore, when considering the various forms and phases of mediumship, instead of viewing them in the light of “spiritual gifts,” they must be viewed as the natural attributes of our internal nature, as the positive potentialities of the human soul. The various forms and degrees of mediumship are not spiritual gifts in any sense whatever. They are, when viewed from the interior plane, the senses of the soul, and hold the same relation to the spirit as our

five external senses do to the physical body. Just as our objective organism is governed and controlled by absolute and eternal laws, strictly applicable to its eternal nature, so is the internal, imponderable constitution under the government of correspondingly transcendental laws equally in harmony with its purely subjective nature. These laws constitute the "Science of the soul," and it is only by a thorough knowledge of this science that we can see the true realities of mediumship—understand them, and not only guard ourselves from its terrible dangers, but enjoy without fear its countless and unlimited blessings. By the aid of this glorious knowledge we are enabled to perceive the action and interaction of the two great planes of existence, and observe each coming day with renewed delight the marvellous transformations of mediumistic adaptability. The flower that blooms in beauty, breathing forth to the air its fragrance which is at once grateful to the senses, and stimulating to the nerves, is a perfect emblem of nature's faultless mediumship. The flower is a medium for the transmission to the human body of those finer essences, and of their spiritual portion to the soul; for the aroma of the flower is spiritualized to such a degree as to act upon the life currents of the system, imparting to the spiritual body a nutriment of the finest quality that physical substance can afford. Herein may be seen some of the mysteries of incense, and the great value of its use, especially in religious ceremonies.

In this study of mediumship it must ever be remembered that spirit inheres in every grade of matter as the insti-

gator of life, force and motion, being attendant upon the ethereal currents that permeate all worlds and bind the universe together as a complete whole. And in exact proportion to the refinement of substance, is the sphere vitalized by spirit. In the brain and nervous system of the human being the climax of material vitalization is reached. Here spirit blends with matter in such requisite force and grade as are sufficient to form the astro-magnetic link of connection between the two worlds of cause and effect. It is the same with mental powers: intelligence is ever vitalized from the great Deific fountain of Wisdom; Sympathy and Affection are derived from the same divine soul of Love. No matter what the grade may be, whether that of the seraph basking in the very sunlight of divine purity, of man in his lowest estate, or of the brute raised but one degree above the planes of inanimate nature—the spark which vivifies the brute, the brilliant luminosity that lights up the brain of the perfectly developed human being, and that radiant glory flashing from the brow of the seraph are alike kindled from the same eternal flame; for it is the grand prerogative of each grade of being, differing in degree of evolution, to transmit that which it receives from the realms above to the planes immediately below. From the glorious pulsating soul of the central spiritual Sun, descending through every sphere of creation, deep down into the very bowels of matter, midst stratas of cold granite rock to the mineral lodes of dense metal, one eternal and harmonious chain of spirit mediumship prevails, each plane depending upon the

ascending one, and each in its grandly sequent rotation transmitting the grosser portions to the planes below.

When the whole of this mighty scheme is taken into consideration, Occult students will see how necessary it is for those who wish to develop their spiritual possibilities to live upon a purely vegetable diet, while at the same time it certainly demonstrates the fact that a life spent amid the flowery fields and pine clad mountains is the only existence that can fit the mind and educate the soul to the highest point compatible with material existence. Upon the contrary, the thinking mind will not fail to see that those who live in close, unhealthy, and densely populated towns, and are, in addition to this, surrounded by a group of sickly or selfish minded neighbors and relatives, become subject to the very lowest planes of spiritual activity, which often form the very hotbeds of error, spiritual and mental, and evolve the means of elementary obsession and wickedness. Under such antagonistic conditions progress is absolutely impossible, and those laboring under such adverse circumstances should avoid practical interference with magic, spiritual phenomena and mediumship, as they would avoid coming in contact with a deadly pestilence. It is to be hoped that these words of warning will be remembered.

Having given a general outline of the nature of mediumship, it now becomes our duty to elucidate its laws and mysteries, and here we are met with the mightiest subject within the whole range of Occultism. No branch is of greater importance in the study of truth, nor more completely unknown and misunderstood by that large body of

thinkers of the present day known as Theosophists,* singularly so-called so far as the vast majority are concerned, since the term Theosophy means "Divine Wisdom," and their lack of esoteric illumination constitutes their most conspicuous feature.

Mediumship, though governed by well defined laws, so far as its general principles are concerned, is so subtle and intricate in its different degrees, forms and phases, as to be absolutely beyond the grasp of the ordinary mind. In fact, its ramifications and the results of its actions are as unlimited as the infinite. Therefore, it is only the more prominent and apparent forms that we shall attempt to outline in the present chapter; for to do the subject justice more than one large volume would be required. As a matter of convenience, we shall divide the general laws of mediumship into two general classes; that of the controlling force, and that of the mediumistic instrument, known to initiates as the laws of Reception and Transmission.

The laws of Transmission.

- I. Activity.
- II. Positiveness.
- III. Attraction.

The laws of Reception.

- I. Passivity.
- II. Sensitiveness.
- III. Affinity.

The first trinity belongs to the controlling force; the second to the medium. In order to grasp the full significance of the above laws and of their inter-relationship, it must be borne in mind that the lower states of life are always the mediums of and consequently subject to the

*We mean those modern mystics who proclaim the doctrines of an esoteric Buddhism to the world as the essence of truth and wisdom.

higher. Therefore, every realm, from Deity to the crystallized mineral, must not only possess the quality of mediumship, but also exercise the power of spirit control, the two poles being God and crystallized matter. To illustrate this idea let us take the organism of man. Man, as we know him, is the mediumistic instrument through which higher states manifest their wisdom and power. This mediumship, on general lines, extends from the lowest specimen in the scale of humanity upwards to the highest initiated adept;* the only difference between the two is that of development. In other words, the only difference is one of quality and degree corresponding to their respective states. Man, according to his state, assimilates the specific grade of life essence from the universal force which corresponds exactly to the quality and development of his soul. As man ascends higher in the scale of spiritual development he becomes the recipient of finer essences, the coarser atoms are repelled and transmitted to less perfect organisms. This transmission goes on until the lowest state of humanity is reached, and from thence the life essence is transmitted to the sub-mundane realms of life, which thus become the mediums for the expression of the surplus spiritual force rejected by man. This primal life force, in its original purity, contains all the requisite grades of spiritual nutriment for every form of existence in the universe, from God to the mineral. This is the terminus, so to say, from

*This is an absolute fact. The exalted adept is actually a medium, in one sense, for the expression of still higher states of life than his own. No real adept denies this, though mere mystical pretenders always do.

which all phenomena react. There is no medium below this state. It is not the end of creation by any means, but only the turning point in the scheme of creation, where force comes to a focus and from which it reacts in both directions. Within each realm the same laws are also in force. Those forms of life which, by comparison, are passive, become the mediums for those which are active. Ascending to the mental plane we find it precisely the same with knowledge. The active research of powerful penetrating minds accumulates this knowledge, and then formulates the same into systems composed of more or less truth and error. This combination of wisdom and ignorance constitutes a religious sect or school of philosophy, which, in turn, impresses its force upon the less positive minds of the masses. The ignorant, therefore, become the mediums of the wise. This wisdom may only merit such a name, however, by comparing it with the ignorance by which it is surrounded. The sum total of a nation's wisdom or ignorance may always be found by examining its laws, constitution and religion. In politics, also, we find the same law in force. A great political leader, a giant mind, impresses its force upon a circle of kindred but less positive minds. These, in turn, react upon others, transmitting the same power of thought to them, and so on until that central mind—like a sun—sways the destiny of millions of its fellow-creatures. These millions are simply the mediums for the expression of mental force. Again, the visible head or center of this force may, in its turn, be the medium of some other but invisible head, whether such invisible power be

mortal or spiritual, embodied or disembodied, makes no difference to the law.

All of these forms and phases, however, are to be classed as unconscious mediumship; because it seldom transpires that the operator is conscious of the magical powers he is using, or that the mediums are conscious of their mediumistic subjection. We think these brief illustrations will convey to the reader's mind something of the magnitude of the present subject.

We will now briefly notice a few of the most prominent forms of mediumship recognized as having a more direct connection with practical Occultism at the present, viz.: the mediumship of spiritualism, and then conclude with some of its more recondite phases.

The *sine qua non* of all trance, or physical mediumship, is embraced in the term "passivity," and exactly in proportion to the degree of passivity attained is the power or strength of a person's mediumship increased. The question as to whether a given person will develop into a trance speaker or into a physical medium depends first, upon the brain conformation, and secondly, upon the magnetic temperament of the body. Some individuals are so complex that they may become either the one or the other, according to the prevailing will of the developing circle. The chief point to be observed in these forms of mediumship, is that they tend toward the destruction of individuality. They can only be attained in the passive state, and the developing process is a means toward destroying whatever amount of will the poor medium might have originally possessed. This

destruction of the human will (subjection to spiritual intelligences as spiritualists ignorantly call it), is the greatest curse of mediumship. The controlling forces of such willless creatures may be anything and everything, according to "conditions" and circumstances. A medium that is said to be "developed" (?) stands upon the public platform, and is supposed to be controlled by some disembodied intelligence. But in nine cases out of every ten it is the psychological influx of the audience which, centering upon the sensitive organism of the medium, produces that peculiar semi-mesmeric state known as trance. Under such conditions the inspired oration will harmonize with the majority of the minds present, and, in numberless cases, the exact thoughts of individuals in the audience are reproduced. To the orthodox spiritualist the oration will be received as an actual inspiration received from the "Spirit World" of translated humanity. Spiritualists should learn the fact, that mediums that can be controlled by a spirit can be equally controlled by a living person, and further, that of all places the public platform is the least likely spot to be the center of that spiritual inspiration which emanates from ascended human souls.

Those forms of mediumship, known as Psychometry and Clairvoyance, depend chiefly upon the degree of sensitiveness attained; brain formation and magnetic temperament possessing only secondary influence in their evolution. Consequently, animals as well as human beings may possess these phases. Their characteristics are too well known to require further notice.

We must now notice two of the most subtle, and so far almost entirely unsuspected forms of this spirit mediumship. The first we will designate as "semi-transfer of identity," the second as "thought diffusion."

I. In a previous chapter we have shown how a person, during life possessing an active, potent mind, will leave within the spaces of the astral light powerful thought forms or psychic thought embryos. These thought forms are the earth karma of the human soul. Now, under certain conditions this earth karma of disembodied souls can be, and is contacted by those still in the flesh. Thus, for example, a person of strong positive mind, having rendered his soul sphere contactible by partial development while his brain still remains positive, becomes a true medium, so far as the soul sphere is concerned, and always without knowing it (unless properly initiated). Being self-conscious, as far as the mind and brain are concerned, he scorns the idea of mediumship, but in real truth he is as much a medium as a trance speaker. In this state he comes into magnetic rapport with certain thought forms within the astral karmas of the disembodied, and in this condition a semi-transfer of identity takes place, and he seems to exist in some previous age. He becomes identified with the karmic form controlling his sensitive sphere, and under these circumstances he becomes deceived by his ignorance, and imagines that he is recalling some incarnation of the past, if he is acquainted with the dogmas of the re-incarnation school. If ignorant of these doctrines, then he simply puts the whole matter down as a sort of day dreaming. Esoteric Buddhists, and others

of the same school of thought, unable to account for such phenomena have, in their benighted ignorance, invented their "re-awakened memory" theories. They consider these phenomena as veritable recollections of their past experiences, whereas they are nothing of the kind. They are indeed past experiences, but not theirs. They come into contact with them because of their magnetic mediumship. The forms they thus contact are those of individuals who belong to the same spiritual state of life, and who possessed, when upon the earth, a similar mental and magnetic temperament. All such evidences of re-incarnation are due to the simple action of mediumship. When the soul receives its true spiritual initiation, all these earthly errors vanish, and the fleeting phantoms of the astral world appear in their true light. The writer once believed in such images as evidences of his past earth lives. Further development, under a strict discipline, revealed the whole delusion. There is no true evidence to be obtained in support of that which is fundamentally false, neither is there any experience that appears to favor or sustain a re-incarnation theory that cannot be explained by the laws of mediumship.

II. Another form of this recondite phase of mediumship is that of thought diffusion. It is by this means that the potent, self-willed minds behind this veil of outward Buddhism are silently subjecting certain sensitive minds, in order to regain their lost sacerdotal power upon humanity. Thought diffusion is the power of diffusing certain thought forms containing certain positive ideas. These currents of thought circulate around the various mental chambers of

the human mind, and, wherever they contact a sensitive sphere possessing any magnetic affinity to the center of such thought, they gradually impress their force and ultimately (in the majority of cases) subject that soul to those dominant ideas, and so prepare the way for the reception of the doctrines behind. In this way, by the subtle mental magic of its devotees, religious theology obtained its first foothold upon the human mind. But though the action of this mediumship is sure, yet the re-action is equally certain, and it is this re-action that ultimately destroys Theology. The magical offspring destroys its magical progenitor.

This diffusion of ideas is in active operation upon every mental plane; thus one potent mind evolving thought forms in Boston may suddenly set in vibration hundreds of sympathetic but less positive minds upon the other side of the Atlantic. They begin to think similar ideas, and to form similar conclusions. These ideas may become universal and constitute public opinion, if the projecting minds are potent enough. But few, very few indeed, are conscious of such ramifications of mental magic. Esoteric Buddhism owes its origin to such magic, and depends absolutely for its continued existence upon such Occult processes. Its followers never dream that instead of being independent, self-conscious minds, they are the mediumistic sensitives of Oriental control. But re-action is already apparent. The reader should never forget that upon the external plane there is nothing so potent as the magic of the human mind.

The conflicting theories of Buddhistic Theosophy on the one hand, and Spiritualism on the other, regarding the nature and source of those invisible forces which produce the various kinds of phenomena known to modern spiritualism, have given rise to much perplexity in the minds of many earnest truth seekers. The spiritualist, as a rule, affirms that such phenomena are due wholly to the action of disembodied human souls (many advanced spiritualists now freely admit the possibility of other intelligences than those of humanity controlling mediums); while the Theosophist utterly denies the possibility of such a course (except in the case of his Mahatmas, or with vicious human elementaries), and asserts that all the various forms and phases of spiritualistic phenomena are produced by one or more of the following agencies, either singly or combined :

- I. Elemental spirits, termed spooks.
- II. Human elementaries (*i. e.* the lost souls of depraved mortals).
- III. Disembodied shells (the lifeless forms of disembodied mortals).
- IV. The mesmeric influence of living individuals.

The actual truth is midway between these two extremes. It is, indeed, a most glorious fact that disembodied human souls can and do return and commune through various mediumistic natures with embodied humanity. Still the action of these souls is chiefly confined to, and manifested upon, the impressional and inspirational planes of mediumship. In so far the spiritualist is correct. There is, however, much truth, together with much that is false, in the

Theosophist's theory. Let us, therefore, consider the agencies just mentioned, and in the order given.

I. Elemental spirits, termed spooks. There are innumerable classes and species of impersonal elementals in the various rounds and spaces, but only three classes have any influence upon mediums and spiritualistic phenomena. The first and lowest in the scale of intelligence, is the class of cosmic elementals, generated in the four realms of Occultism,—Fire, Earth, Air and Water. These creatures cannot deceive the medium. They are incapable of personating or imitating anything beyond themselves, unless they are impelled to do so by the medium's internal desire for such deception. In this case they may obey the impulse of the medium's mind. As they are completely subjective to the human will when psychically directed they possess no real individuality of their own, they are simply the blind forces of nature, either active or latent according to magnetic conditions, and therefore would be correctly designated as the undeveloped mind of matter. The second class in the scale of intelligence is the Animal Elementals. These beings are the souls of animal forms of life undergoing the magnetic cycle of their impersonal existence within the astral spaces of the "*Anima Animalis*." When any animal dies upon the earth, it undergoes another cycle of life within the karmic spaces of its kind in the astral world, evolving the forces and conditions to be utilized for its next incarnation. These souls, if we may call them such, especially those of domesticated animals, frequently become attached to human beings on earth with whom they have some pecu-

liar magnetic affinity, or to whom they become attached during their external life. It is these beings that become the innocent instruments of fraud; that is to say, they respond to the desires of the medium or to the secret wish of the circle or those who consult the medium. Under these circumstances it will invariably transpire that when a person consults a medium upon any given subject upon which he possesses a positive opinion, the answer he receives will correspond thereto, whether it be correct or otherwise. The same thing will happen when the client asks the advice or the opinion of a medium upon worldly matters. The answer will always respond to the secret desire which the animal elemental perceives in the mental sphere of the querent. This "control" cannot be charged with fraud any more than a pet dog can be so charged who fulfils his master's desire. The benighted ignorance of both medium and client is the only cause for the apparent fraud. Mediums who become the instruments of this class of intelligences are generally those of unbounded personal egotism, who formulate the idea that their spirit guides cannot be any other than the most exalted personages. Abraham, Isaac, Jacob, Moses, Aaron and the whole of the prophets have in turn been claimed as their inspiring guides by this class of mediums. Such is not the case, except in the most rare instances. The obliging imitative soul of the animal elemental feels the full force of the medium's egotistical thought desire and immediately responds thereto and fulfils this mental idea. Even Jesus Christ and Buddha have been thus personated by impersonal controls of

mediumistic dupes. But no matter who they claim to be they will always correspond to the ideal image of that personage existing in the medium's mind, so that should the medium be ignorant of the lives, times and circumstantial surroundings of their ideal guides when on earth, then their ideal guide will be equally ignorant of himself. The writer has frequently met with spirits claiming to be Pythagoras who did not comprehend the first principles of Occultism, and who had entirely forgotten the order he instituted or the country he belonged to. We have met with Roger Bacon spooks who had never heard of alchemy and knew nothing of monastic life; with Ben Jonsons, who knew nothing of the times in which he lived on earth; with Shakespeares, who had forgotten their own plays, and the humble circumstances of the poet's early life. Nearly all these instances were where the mediums were actually controlled by the astral souls of domestic animals, chiefly dogs.* The reason we assert that they were dogs is because, having evolved the lucid state we could ourselves see the thoughtless impersonal creature responding to every latent thought in their medium's mind, and when we formulated the positive thought that the control was not what he represented himself he would generally confess that he was not, whereupon the medium would commence blaming "the conditions." Our personal investigations, extending over a series of years in England, France, Germany, Austria and the United States, with various types and phases of mediums, prove most con-

*This class, and also the cosmic elementals, are the chief agencies in all physical phenomena. They act under the control of human souls.

clusively that nearly half of that class of mediums who style themselves "business clairvoyants" and "test mediums" are controlled by various kinds of animal elementals, or "spooks." The third class in the scale of intelligence is the magnetic elementals corresponding to the seven planetary divisions of nature. These intelligent creatures are too bright and ethereal to be guilty of fraud. They are generated by the life forces of the planetary chain existing within each orb, and are the intermediate agents of the physical results of planetary influences manifested on the earth. They are the attendant familiars of certain classes of mystical students, especially those devoted to alchemy and astrology. It is these beings that usually produce the visions in crystals, magic mirrors, or vases of water, and in consequence of this they have often been wrongly termed planetary angels by certain schools of magical research. They are indeed planetary in nature, but they do not belong to the physical planet to whose nature they correspond except by affinity. They pertain to our own orb equally as much as man himself, and can give much information regarding the orb under whose dominion they act. If any deception transpires through them, it is but the reflection of the deception existing in the minds of those who use them. They do not and cannot control mediums by mesmerism or by trance. Their sole influence is manifested in the impressional and clairvoyant phases of mediumship.

II. Disembodied Human Elementaries. This class is made up of the animal souls of depraved, wicked mortals who have sunk beneath the human plane and thus caused

the separation of their divine soul from their conscious individuality. Those who fall so low as this are generally evil magicians and sorceresses, who are far more numerous than civilized society has any conception of. This class are really magnetic vampires who prolong their vicious existence by sapping the life blood of their mediumistic victims. They will personate anything and everything. Their only aim is to completely demoralize the mediums and plunge them into all kinds of depravity. The chief characteristic of the Human Elementary is obsession, and nearly all those who go insane through religious excitement are the victims of elementary obsession. It is needless to add that these vampires are lost to all that is redemptive and good; they have gravitated to the lowest realms of brute animality in nature upon the descending arc, and ultimately they become indrawn within the death whirl of that magnetic orb known as the dark satellite, and are swept to their final doom, extinction.

III. Disembodied shells. These are the magnetic forms of those who have lived, died and been buried upon the earth. They are perfectly lifeless; they hover around the grave which conceals the corpse to which they are bound, and as this decomposes the magnetic shell or phantom also dissolves. They cannot be drawn away from the grave. They cannot, in fact, be made to answer any mediumistic purpose whatsoever, and those who assert, as some Theosophists do, that they can be regvanized into a temporary life and made to simulate the deceased individual, are sadly in error, and know not whereof they speak. The

Buddhistical theory of disembodied shells and their influence upon the mediums of modern spiritualism is only another of the oriental delusions, disseminated to poison the budding spirituality of the West.

IV. The Mesmeric influence of living individuals. Of this potent factor we need not speak, as it is evident that any spirit medium will feel, and to some extent respond to, the mesmeric will of a potent, positive, magnetic mind.

SECTION III.

CHAPTER I.

THE SOUL—ITS NATURE AND ATTRIBUTES.

"The divine spirit is to the soul what the soul is to the body."—*Plutarch*.

First, we must speak of the soul. If it were possible for a duad to exist in which there was a distinction without a difference, we should say that such a combination was a perfect type of "soul" and "spirit." But as such is not in existence, we must try to express both the distinction and the difference by other types, albeit, in regard to soul and spirit, the one is not perceptible without the presence of the other.

The terms, "soul" and "spirit" have become inter-blended in such hopeless confusion, that it seems almost impossible to unravel the tangled skeins of definitions, and present a clear, comprehensive outline of the two and show them as they really are when viewed in the light of spiritual illumination.

The soul is not the spirit, but it is that by which the spirit is known, or, rather, that by which we understand the nature and powers of the spirit. In the first chapter of this work a complete definition of spirit is given, so far as human language can express or define an undefinable

entity. When we come to define the soul, we are compelled to use illustrations that shall follow out the definition there given. We have spoken of the spiritual Ego as an atom of divinity, a scintillating atomic point evolved from the divine soul of the Deity. Now, while this is quite true as regards the Ego, yet, when we desire to define the soul we must request the reader not to confuse the two, but, as a mere matter of mental convenience, consider them as the cause and effect, so to say, of spiritual evolution.

The soul is formless and intangible, and constitutes the attributes of the divine spirit,—therefore we can only conceive and know of the soul by learning the powers or attributes of the spirit. When we have learned them, we shall possess a clear conception of the soul and its real nature. In order to make ourselves better understood, let us illustrate the idea. Take a ray of light. What do we know concerning it? Nothing, except by its action upon something else. This action we term the attributes of light. In themselves the attributes of light are formless, but they may easily be rendered visible, either by their colors when refracted by the prism, or by their effects when concentrated upon material objects. Here we have what may be correctly termed the soul of a ray of light. Another example may be taken as illustrative and expressive of the idea we wish to convey, viz.: the organism of man. Man, as at present constituted, possesses five external senses, viz.: seeing, feeling, hearing, tasting, and smelling. In reality, he has seven senses which may be used externally, but the two higher attributes of the sensuous gamut are still in

embryo so far as the generality of mankind are concerned. The sixth, or "coming race," will evolve the sixth sense; the seventh race, the seventh sense; and then mankind will be physically perfect. But as these two higher senses need not interfere with our illustration, we will only notice man as he is, and be content with five. All our knowledge concerning external phenomena must come, at present, through the mediumship of one or more of these senses. The organs through which the functions of the senses become manifest are visible, but the senses themselves are invisible and formless. We know them only as the attributes of the body; while the mind, which is perfectly and absolutely dependent upon the senses for information, well represents the spiritual Ego in its relation to the soul.

The reader will observe from what is here stated, that the soul itself is, as before said, formless and intangible, and therefore can only be defined as the attribute of spirit. The one cannot exist without the other, but at the same time they cannot be called one and the same, as there is the same difference between the two as there is between a ray of light and its action; and the same distinction as there is between the body and its physical senses. Without the one we can not know the other, and *vice versa*.

A very large percentage of the readers of mystical literature have imagined that the human soul is some kind of a spiritual organism, similar in many respects to the body, and the means whereby the divine spirit manifests itself. But, as shown, this idea is radically erroneous. The spiritual body is the result or outcome of the soul's action, but

is not the soul itself. It is an attribute of the soul, just as the soul is an attribute of the divine Ego, and this divine Ego, in its turn, is a crystallized attribute or expression of Deity. What then is Deity? the reader may ask. All that we are able to answer is, Absolute Potentiality; Pure, formless spirit; Unlimited, unconditioned intelligence. Definition can go no further in this direction.

Having attempted to define the soul as distinct and yet inseparable from the spirit, we will now try to give some idea concerning its attributes, and in this connection it will greatly aid us if we first point out the difference between the soul and the body, and also the correspondence.

The physical body is evolved by a reflex action of the interior soul during the process of its evolving the spiritual organism. The medium between the two is the astral form. It is from the latter that the body receives its form and force. The spiritual organism protects itself, so to say, from the external plane by evolving an astral raiment. This raiment, or astral body, crystallizes a more or less distorted reflection of the spiritual form around itself and thus produces what is known as the human form divine, upon the external plane. This physical organism is constituted and evolved in such order as to render the most perfect expression (in unison) of the physical senses. No one sense is in excess of another, in a perfectly sound human organism; while the different animals generally typify the extreme expression of some one particular sense, as sight, scent, feeling, etc.

This human body, through the mediumship of the brain,

which is the sounding board of the senses, communicates with the external world which is composed of various elements. The result is form, sound, color, etc. Our senses, then, constitute the only source of our external knowledge, and form the basis from which spring our ideas, thoughts and feelings. Our thoughts are thus moulded by the various phenomenal states through which we pass. This state is our external consciousness. It is purely an intellectual state, based upon, and depending, while on earth, upon the continuance of the physical senses. The sum total of human knowledge upon special lines, when tabulated and classified, is reduced to a system, and called science. We are thus able to see and appreciate the relation of the physical senses to the physical body, and grasp their importance to the still remoter mind which utilizes the knowledge so gained. The attributes of the spirit, which we term the soul, bear a perfect correspondence to the physical senses of the body. That is, the soul bears exactly the same relation to the spirit as the physical senses to the human brain. Thus we have the senses which are physical, and we have the senses which are spiritual. The former are simply a reflection of the latter. The senses of the body and the senses of the soul are two halves of the same attribute, the internal and the external. We see the intelligence, the mind, which at the back of the senses utilizes and tabulates the impressions it has received of the outer world, the world which it is itself powerless to penetrate. The mind is something above and beyond the senses, though it is absolutely dependent upon them. It is the same with the soul, and the

spirit. All knowledge from without or within the universe of external life is received by means of the soul, but at the back of this soul there rests the eternal scintillating atom of Deity above and beyond any human conception. There it rests in serenity and peace, tabulating and utilizing all the knowledge and experience which the soul in its various cycles is continually receiving. "As it is below so it is above." This law should ever be remembered. It is man's universal but infallible guide, and anything conflicting therewith can be rejected as erroneous.

The seven senses below correspond to the seven senses above, and the sum total of the results obtained in each case is the same, only upon different planes. These results may be fully expressed by the word PERCEPTION. Absolute perception implies absolute consciousness. Unlimited perception, therefore, is the grand goal toward which the universe of manifested being is eternally marching. It is the climax of evolution. But it is a goal that nothing below Deity can ever attain, because there is always before us the infinite beyond, the awful states of the infinite unknown. Progressive life, therefore, is eternal; thus we have a complete demonstration of the immortality of the spirit, and consequently that of the soul, as the twain—Bride and Bridegroom—are one.

We have now arrived at the last part of our subject, viz.: the method of the soul's enfoldment. Of this we can only speak in general terms. There are certain fundamental laws applicable to all, but, to be successful, something more is requisite. It is necessary for each soul to

follow a system specially adapted to its special state. Each person must find out for himself the special development required of him, unless he can come into contact with others capable of reading his soul's requirements aright, and thus giving him the necessary information.

There is a trinity of laws to be observed : I. Physical harmony in one's surroundings. II. Mental peace and freedom from worldly cares. III. Spiritual purity, and complete isolation from impure currents of thought. Evolve the states from within and the without will take care of itself. These are the methods of the soul's unfoldment. Purity is the great touch-stone, and as Jesus has truly observed, "Blessed are the pure in heart for they shall see God." How many can follow out such a code? "Not one in a million," comes the answer, vibrating across the spiritual spaces of Æther, and the saddening thought that such is indeed the truth in this age compels us to indraw the spiritual forces which the present discourse has expended, and conclude with a few brief words of friendly advice.

To be pure in body, a pure diet must be partaken of and the highest form of food possible to man must constitute his physical sustenance. The fruits of the earth are plenty; they are simple but sufficient.

If we cannot be perfect, then let us be the next thing to it, and be as perfect as our surroundings render possible. Learn to say *I will* and *I will not*, and when you have said it see that your assertion is sacredly maintained.

Let us remember that the material life of man is only one second of his existence, and that it is one of the most

unprofitable things in the world to be selfish. Selfishness is the road to the Hells of the soul world.

And, lastly, if these things are followed with an earnest loving spirit, rest assured that the blossoms of the soul will expand into full-grown flowers, and for the labor and self-denial expended we shall reap the spiritual rewards which will repay us ten thousand fold. Remember, and realize, the words of the wise Proclus:

“Know the Divinity that is within you that you may know the Divine One, of which your soul is a ray.”

CHAPTER II.

MORTALITY AND IMMORTALITY.

“Every soul is immortal by virtue of its community with God.”—*Albertus Magnus.*

In attempting to elucidate the problems of “Mortality and Immortality”—life and death—it must be understood that we are dealing with questions that depend, in a very great measure, upon the construction which is placed on the terms used. It is not our province to enter into the scientific minutia of these problems, nor to present the student with an abstract of learned nonsense concerning the various derivations from which the words are supposed to have reached us. Equally unimportant to our purpose is the sense in which our hoary ancestors may have used them, seeing that such questions must ever remain purely matters

of speculation and opinion, and "when doctors disagree, who shall decide?"

At present we are concerned with the Occult side of the problems, and with laws which are so far removed from the realms of mere opinion as to constitute eternal realities; the manifestations of which can be realized and verified by each individual soul for itself.

Simply and briefly stated, immortality means life—continued life; mortality means death or the extinction of life, and therefore stands as the antithesis of life and immortality. At least, such is the generally accepted sense in which the words are now used. Mortality and immortality in their external relation towards each other stand as polar opposites, and as such they are the alpha and omega of cyclic existence, and represent "the evening and the morning" of every phase of God's infinite creation, upon the outer planes of manifested being, *i. e.*, cosmic evolution. Life and death, then, form the grand spiral axis of time, and its resultants to the human mind are seen in the world of phenomena.

For the sake of convenience we will consider each problem by itself, and then, as a stimulant towards mental reflection, leave their relationship to each other to be thought out by each reader separately.

Mortality, as previously stated, means death and extinction upon the material plane. But when viewed from the higher and more interior standpoint, death simply means change of form and function. There can be no absolute extinction in the strict sense of the term. Atoms are immortal, eternal and indestructible; but a universe or an

organism which is composed of an infinite number of atoms, may be dissolved, destroyed and forever lost, *i. e.*, lost as an organic whole, but not lost as regards its separate atomic parts. The mental being which bound these atoms together loses its force during the process of change or death, consequently death is simply change of polarity. In order to see this, it must be understood that the moons, planets, suns and systems have their own special individuality exactly like animals and men. On the contrary, an atom has no individuality, so far as its external form is concerned, but it possesses a cosmic individuality, an attraction and repulsion specially its own, by virtue of its differentiation from the universal One. It is the complex expression of the myriad atoms which compose the organism or the universe that constitutes its individuality, and this individuality gives expression to a form suitable to the nature, and constitutes the personal or external appearance. These facts must be borne in mind, or the real meaning of this chapter will be misunderstood.

As a general principle of phenomenal expression, it may be said that nature embodies, within some external form, every idea, thought and motive which mankind evolves. The only limit to her possibilities in this direction is the mental and magnetic condition of the race. In fact, every organic form that we see around us is nature's expression of thoughts and ideas. These thoughts and ideas are representative of spiritual qualities which react upon the astral light, and these spiritual qualities emanate from Mind or mental being—either human or divine.

As an illustration of the process of death, and change, let us select two cases, one from the vegetable world, and one from the animal kingdom—a tree and a tiger. The tree dies, decay sets in, and very soon it appears to be gone forever. But this disappearance is only an illusion, for the tree not only exists but exerts a very powerful influence upon the material plane. The tree, so far as its phenomenal outcome is concerned, has only been a means by which the progressive cycle of evolution works upward from the mineral state. It is composed of millions of atoms of life undergoing their various cyclic rounds within the vegetable circuit, and as a natural consequence of this internal spiritual activity the tree possesses a karmic sphere within the astral spaces of its life wave. The astral tree, if we may so call this karmic counterpart, is far more beautiful in its wonderful details, and more perfect in its symmetry and geometrical proportions than the physical organism of earth, and when the material tree no longer exists as a living earthly organism, the arboreal image within nature's wonderful laboratory becomes the means of reflecting the outlines of a still more perfect vegetable organism upon the outward planes of matter. These outlines of astral skeletons of future trees possess the attractive force which draws within them the living germs of the young seedlings growing upon the earth.

The greatest perfection of one tree becomes impressed within the astral light and also the means of developing a more perfect organism of its kind in the next generation. The ideal of the tree becomes externalized in its offspring.

The trained psychic, and those also who naturally possess spiritual lucidity, can see this ethereal vegetation within the astral world, and, therefore, proofs are quickly obtained, should they ever be required, of the two planes of existence. The internal plane is more alive than the external,—but to resume. The physical tree disappears, but does not die as we suppose. When physical death transpires it undergoes a change; the sphere of its activities become translated, removed from the external to the internal, in strict obedience to the higher laws of its internal nature. Thus we see that the tree, having served its purpose on earth, vanishes from external sight, while its ethereal counterpart performs another cycle upon a higher plane. When each has fulfilled its purpose the various evolving atoms which constituted its life form, obeying the interior laws of their cyclic round, seek re-incarnation. They separate, the cycle is complete. The individual tree no longer exists as a tree. But there has been no death in any case,—only a change of form; for the atomic forces of the tree re-appear upon a higher plane in a million varying forms throughout every department of nature.

Having considered death in regard to the tree, let us now examine, in the animal kingdom, the case of a tiger. We have already stated that nature ever strives to externalize ideas and thoughts in some form or other. This statement must be borne in mind. The tiger presents us with a fine illustration of this law of transformation upon the outward planes of existence.

What the tiger is when endowed with physical life we

all know. His chief qualities are selfishness and destructiveness. He is, in fact, a complete expression of cruelty. When death transpires, the astral tiger, like the astral tree, becomes indrawn within the karmic sphere of its astral world, there to perform the higher evolutions of its special round until the life atoms, which constitute it, become "rounded out" and ready to externalize in some higher form. Thus the tiger, like the tree, is one of nature's countless mediums for the expression of mental force, and by the interior laws of its constitution forms a central vortex or focus for the materialization of the purely selfish and destructive elements of humanity. When death removes the physical tiger, the ethereal tiger becomes the sphere of action until the tigerish qualities have run their cycle. But we cannot say that there has been any real extinction, or death hath come upon the tiger, any more than we can say that the caloric of the sunbeam is destroyed because the solar ray is no longer brought to a focus. The eye of the initiate can distinctly see the ferocity of the animal in the inhumanity of the man.

Mortality or death, then, can only exist and be a truth in reference to individual forms. It has no existence when brought face to face with the spiritual qualities and mental force, which created these forms. Change of sphere and change of action are the only realities of death. Ever onward, ever upward, forever and ever more. Eternal progression is the anthem of evolution, and the cycles of action are but intervals of time measured out to the life forces by the pendulum of creation.

The second portion of our subject—"Immortality"—is the polar opposite of death and mortality. Individual forms and characteristics are the only things that change and die, and this death, as we have shown, is not extinction of the life atoms in the literal sense of the term, but simply change of sphere and function. Death is the grand terminus of one cycle of existence, and the commencement of another. Mortality is the harbinger of a still higher state of life, and consequently the forerunner of immortality. There are exceptions to the general rule, though they are few. The most important of these exceptions we shall notice in our next chapter.

There are two distinct phases of immortal life, viz.: conscious immortality, and unconscious immortality. One relates to mind, the other to matter; one to intelligence, the other to substance,

There is only one grade of external life which can be said to inherit immortality in the Occult sense of the term, viz.: eternal conscious life, an immortal individuality, so to say. Not as we know and recognize individuals, but, rather, an individuality consisting of soul qualities, a purely spiritual state which can only be partially expressed by the word identity. All the states below the human plane are only so many radiating lines which converge to a point, and are brought to a focus within the human organism. Therefore, every quality and force upon the planet or within the system of which the organism forms a part must find expression within this uterus of nature. If this were not so, man would not constitute a microcosm or universe in minia-

ture. In the grades below the human state, we do not find complete organisms. They are mere temporary shapes of matter continually dying out of existence to give place to something more perfect, when the forces they were evolved to express are exhausted. They are not souls in the true sense, but refracted attributes of souls. They are qualities and functions in the process of evolution; isolated parts and characteristics of a whole; organs, but not organisms.

Commencing at the very lowest point of animated existence, we shall discover only the most rudimentary expression of the simplest functions of organic life, viz.: a desire to live. As we ascend higher the organs become multiplied, and the desire to live increased. This gradual scale expands right up to man,* where we find a miniature universe, absolute and complete within itself. The central Deific atom, controlling this universe, has traveled all the way from the crude fire rocks of cosmic evolution; conquering every state through which it ascended upon its progressive, toilsome journey; at each state evolving from within a complete attribute corresponding to the state, by virtue of which it polarized and bound the atoms of life and annexed them as a portion of its spiritual empire, thereby forming the means for their progression also. Until, at last, the Deific atom sits upon the spiritual throne as king of the microcosm, capable of thinking, creating and evolving from within itself the glorious states of the angel.

It is, therefore, an Occult truth to declare that all things below man are mortal, and all above immortal. Man, alone,

*We mean the perfect human soul.

of all God's marvellous creations, contains within himself the forces of life and death, of mortality and immortality. Man, then, contains "the promise and potency of life" and constitutes, upon the spiritual plane, what Tyndall's protoplasm does upon the physical, viz.: the possibilities of infinite progression.

To attain unto immortality it is necessary, as we have shown, for the central life atom to conquer every state below the human, and then to become externalized upon earth as an individual human being, to undergo the trials and become subjected to the responsibilities of a conscious, reasoning, individual struggle for life. The nature and quality of the soul, combined with the polarity of the organism, will launch the individual into the exact conditions and circumstances that are best adapted to arouse all the latent qualities within,—both animal and human. It is not a previous karma that determines an individual's condition in life, but it is the nature and quality of the soul conflicting or harmonizing with external conditions. This turmoil of life, this ceaseless human warfare, is just as necessary for the soul's final development as are the earlier struggles through the states below. Man possesses the possibilities of immortal life in such a potent degree as to nearly always succeed. There are, however, a few solitary exceptions.*

When man has passed through the travail of human life he then meets the struggle of his karma in the realm of spirit. Here he may even sink forever, because he does not actually possess immortality, only the promise or pos-

*To be explained in our next chapter.

sibility of it, until the four realms of the astral world are passed and he enters the sixth state of the soul world, where he becomes re-united with his soul mate, his missing half. Until this union is complete there is and can be no actual immortality. Previous to this he is but a part of himself, and has control only of half of his spiritual nature. It is the union of the two that forms the absolute one. "And they twain shall be one flesh," saith the old Jewish Scripture: "as it is above, so it is below."

From the foregoing it will be seen that it is the re-union of the twin souls in the realm of spirit that confers upon man the state of angelhood. He is human no longer,—he is then Divine, and as a Deific being he possesses the attributes of eternal progression and immortal life.

CHAPTER III.

THE DARK SATELLITE.

When we look about us with the physical senses, nature seems to be in continual warfare with herself. In fact, it seems utterly impossible to find anything not in deadly conflict with something else, either visible or invisible. Observing this, mankind has unconsciously, from time immemorial, formulated the idea of two great powers, viz., "good" and "evil." From this idea the grand dogma of theology—"God" and the "Devil"—sprang into existence, and became the chief corner stone of every sacerdotalism which the world has witnessed. And while there is some

basic truth in this idea, as in every popular conception, since mankind as a whole cannot formulate any idea that is wholly and absolutely false in every detail, yet there is also much that is utterly false in it, owing to the fact that man, while existing upon the material plane, cannot grasp the divine idea of Absolute Truth, nor realize the logical absurdity of more than one Absolute. He, therefore, utterly fails to comprehend how that which is relative evil can be harmonized into absolute good. Accordingly, to the majority of mankind this mighty problem of good and evil is still unsolved, and but few, very few indeed, even of the profoundly learned students of Occult lore in the past, arrived at a true conception of the subject.

Countless legends and allegories have been evolved, during the lapse of the ages, to embody the facts and the processes connected with this arcane mystery, but the metaphysics of these legends have never been revealed to the uninitiated. Especially has this been the case in regard to the Dark Satellite. However, the time has now come when certain facts in regard to this orb of evil are for the first time given out to the world "*pro bono publico*."

In the first place, certain misconceptions in regard to the dark orb need to be corrected. Many earnest students have thought it to be "The Lost Orb" of the Grecian mysteries, hence similar to the Egyptian conception of the spiritual "fall." But there is, in fact, no connection between the two. The lost orb, in its cosmological aspect, will be found noticed in the second part of this work. In its spiritual aspect it applies to the fallen human soul, not

the lost soul. Herein consists the difference between the two orbs, the lost and the dark.

Another misconception has regarded the Moon—our Earth's visible satellite—as identical with the dark orb. Many Theosophists assert, in a very mysterious manner, that the Moon is not only the eighth sphere, or the orb of death and dissolution, but that it is “the dust bin of the universe.”* This conception is radically false as regards the Moon, although it approaches the realms of truth in some respects regarding the nature of the mysterious dark satellite itself.

With these brief introductory remarks it now remains to point out how to form a perfectly correct conception of what this satellite is, and its fearful importance at the present crisis of the world's history.

When the student brings before his mind the teachings of the preceding chapters, and the conclusions they lead up to, considering them as a whole, it will require but a brief and careful application of the laws of correspondences to enable him to gain a perfectly accurate idea of this hitherto concealed region and portion of the Earth's constitution.

By referring to the “Hermetic Constitution of Man” as elucidated in chapter VI of the present work, let the student review the seven divisions of man, then, bearing in mind the fact that the planet which man inhabits is also an individual, possessing a seven-fold constitution corresponding in

*Dr. Wyld, formerly president of the London T. S., fully exposed the absurdity of this mysterious Theosophical Secret in the columns of “Light” when the great “Kiddle Mystery” and Koot Hoomi's identity caused so much anxiety to loyal theosophists.

every respect to the constitution of man, let him strictly apply the Hermetic law for himself,

“As it is below, so it is above,
As on the earth, so in the sky.”

He will then know exactly how to go to work to comprehend the subject. But as the ordinary student, living wholly upon the external plane, is not in a position to verify his conceptions, he must content himself for the present to accept the revelations which will be made upon the authority of those who do know, and have verified.

In chapter VI., “Hermetic Constitution of Man,” occurs a description of the animal soul, as it is called. Now that magnetic sphere of our planet which exactly corresponds to the animal soul of man, is what is Occultly termed “the Dark Satellite.” Therefore, in order to comprehend this dusky sphere, its nature and functions, it is absolutely necessary to understand the nature and functions of the animal soul of man, together with its relations to the other six divisions, and also, to clearly grasp man’s relation to the planet of which he forms, as it were, an atomic part towards an organic whole.

It will then be seen that this dark, magnetic orb constitutes the grand center or focus of the Earth’s animal force; in other words, it is the realm of the undeveloped good in nature, whose terrible motto is embraced in the word SELF.

During the “Golden” and “Silver” periods of our Earth’s evolution, this dark satellite was in the aphelion portion of its orbit and its influence was scarcely felt; or

else, its influence was seen and recognized only in its true relation of animal force and undeveloped good. As a factor of evil it was imperceptible. But during the Copper and Iron ages the orb in question gradually approached the Earth, and its dark shadows became more and more bewildering and potent until the year 1881, when it passed its grand perihelion point. It is now slowly but surely receding, and although the clouds are not lifted from the mental horizon; and though the fact that the fearful conflict which occurred at the perihelion and the confusion and chaos seem more widespread and error more rampant than ever before in the world's history, yet it is past its darkest culminating point. As it is often darkest just before break of day, so even now the dawn of a brighter morn is at hand, when the faithful, resolute truth-seeker shall be able to solve for himself this awful problem of good and evil, of light and shadow. Therefore, sustained by the knowledge of the ultimate victory of order and equilibrium over chaos and opposing forces, even though enveloped in the darkness of battle and involved in the vortices of the defeated legions of error, let us turn our attention more closely to the satellite itself, which has been such a disturbing factor to our planet's mental equilibrium, and consider it with special reference to the implications of responsibility forced upon every soul seeking light and immortality.

In the first place, this orb possesses a complete organization of its own, and is governed by well defined laws, the nature of which may be known only too well by patiently observing the merciless instincts of the lower animal nature

as manifested in man, where the moral consciousness is absolutely wanting. Throughout the whole sphere are numerous races of spiritual beings, many of them possessing the highest forms of cunning and intelligence possible to the animal plane. It is these beings, who are neither elementals nor elementaries, who are the producers of the greatest portion of the suffering and misery which afflicts humanity. They are the active Occult agents of that potent fraternity within the spiritual world which has its external expression and correspondence in the brotherhood known upon Earth as the "Black Magi."* These two fraternities, viz.: the spiritual rulers and potentialities of the dark satellite upon the astral plane, and the schools of Black magic upon the physical plane, constitute the two halves of the planet's evil desire.

From within the dark center of the astral realms of the former the spirit of lies, murder, fraud and religious imposture is first formulated, and then projected to the latter fraternity as the means of its continued existence. From these centers it is re-formulated to suit the spirit and temper of the times, and then its psychological influence is projected into the mental whirl of the race, where its silent, subtle influx poisons the dimensional spaces which constitute the magnetic planes of human life. From thence the unseen Occult current penetrates the innermost recesses of the human mind, and possesses the soul to such an extent that deep down in the heart of man, no matter how pure and disinterested he may appear, there lurks the slimy rep-

*Also known to the initiates as "the Inversive Brethren."

tile of selfishness, yea, even when he least suspects it. It is this grim monster—self—that each aspirant to Occult truth seeks to conquer. When this Goliath of the soul is struck dead by the smooth white pebble of the spirit, slung with the neophyte's will, the grand ordeal is over, the crown of immortality won. "To the victor belong the spoils."

We have pointed out the fact that it is the dark satellite from whence proceeds the spirit of lies, murder and frauds. This was well known to the initiates of the greater Hermetic mysteries, for we find the idea very clearly defined in the mystical language of the ancients, as the following extract from one of the supposed lost magical works of Hermes Trismegistus will show. Speaking of the magical rulers of the dark satellite as they sit in council, creating delusion, we read :

"So they called forth a form
From the deep dark abyss
To embody their evil desire."
"Obedient it came
From the realms of the dead,
Arrayed in its magic attire."
"As it passed o'er the earth
The fair flowers fell dead,
From its breath of poisonous fire."

Indeed, so thoroughly has this poisonous fire of self-interest permeated the world, that the fair flowers of disinterestedness have become an almost entirely extinct species, and should the real state of unselfish unworldliness of the true mystic become known, he is either regarded with pity as *non compos mentis*, or else looked upon with suspicion as

acting from motives more subtle than govern the ordinary mortal.

The manner in which this dark magnetic energy is projected from the satellite to the earth is wholly inversive, and the rulers and magical hierophants make use of this inversive force to distort and corrupt Truth in every form wherein it struggles to become manifest upon the earth. The powers and influences attributed to certain races of the astrals, by the authors of "The Perfect Way," belong in reality to the rulers and principalities of the dark satellite, who mercilessly distort every arcane truth into theological dogma of partial error, causing it to assume to the human mind the delusive form of the externals of truth and logic. But the delusive form is, after all, only a very flimsy sophistry when subjected to the keen searching eye of the soul. Consequently it is always those who are half informed of nature's mysteries—the half-initiated, so to say—who fall into the snare. Herein is seen the Occult truth in the proverb, "A little learning is a dangerous thing."

Just as the dark satellite was at its perihelion, these inversive brethren achieved the greatest apparent theological and metaphysical success in the re-launching forth throughout the world of the doctrines of "Re-incarnation," "Karma," and "Disembodied Shells," as formulated and taught by the decaying priesthoods of the dreamy Orient. Viewed in its true light, this gigantic movement of the inversive brethren was aimed as a death blow to the rapidly spreading spiritualism of the Occident; since, wherever accepted, these doctrines, as taught and interpreted by the Buddhist cult,

destroy at once all belief in the possibility of spirit communication between disembodied souls and the external humanity. Such a movement, however, is doomed to ultimate failure, as there are certain absolute truths connected with spiritualism, notwithstanding the ignorance of its expounders, its many errors and gross impostures. These truths can neither be suppressed by inversive magic, nor smothered by an oriental theory. They are too patent to the candid mind, and the re-action against the speculative mentality of the East, which is sure sooner or later to set in from the Western matter-of-fact mind, will tear the grim mask from these would-be brethren of the snow-clad Himalayas, and show to the world who are the denizens of the shadow, and who the children of light.

At this point the question naturally arises, "of what personal or selfish benefit is the propagation of error to the inhabitants of the dark satellite." The answer is simply this, it furnishes them with the means of prolonging their external existence while on earth, and supplies them with an additional lease of life in the world to come, as will be made manifest from the Hermetic laws of death given below. According to these laws, death is not what is known as physical dissolution, but is a failure on the part of the human being to polarize the atoms which constitute the soul and to realize immortality. It is, therefore, a falling from the human to the animal plane, where conscious existence may be prolonged indefinitely by means of dark magical arts.

“The Laws of Death:” From Hermes.*

I. “As it is below, so it is above; as on the earth, so in the sky.

II. “There are two states of being: one is mortal; the other, immortal.

III. “That which is mortal is dissolvable, and dissolvable bodies pass away like a mist in the morning.

IV. “An immortal body is an essence which is eternal and incorruptible.

V. “But the twain, the mortal and the immortal, cannot exist together forever, but each returneth to the place from whence it came.

VI. “The mortal body is sensible, but the immortal is reasonable.

VII. “The former contains nothing that is perfect, the latter nothing that is imperfect; for the one is the essence of the spirit, the other the essence of matter, and man, the microcosm, holds the balance of the twain.

VIII. “And there is a fierce warfare for the victory, between the upper and lower, as they both desire to obtain the body as their prize; for the state of man is envied by the lower and glorified as a noble state by the higher.

IX. “Now if the man inclines toward the lower nature which is mortal, he thereby aids the lower imperfect powers to oppose the higher which is immortal, and must suffer the pains of slavery for his disobedience to the work-man his

*We do not profess to give a literal translation of the exact words of the original, but merely an accurate rendering of the real ideas, which is all that the reader requires.

maker. But if he inclines to the higher, then he is truly wise and blest.

X. "Should man, after being attracted by the vanities of the world and then obtaining a knowledge of the things that are, return to the vanities of the world, he will be punished with torments and fire in the darkest states of disembodied souls.

XI. "Should a man after knowing the things that are, become rebellious of restraint to that part which is immortal, and return to the vanities of the world, the higher essence will straightway depart from him, and he will become the slave of the lower essence which will seize upon him and drive him to all sorts of wicked arts and evil ways.

XII. "When man has thus impiously disobeyed his Creator and turned his face away from that which is immortal, behold he is then disinherited from his birthright, and is no longer counted among the children of God, because he has become an evil, perverse thing, possessing only those things which are mortal, and he is punished with death.

XIII. "And so death is meted out to all those who rebel against their Creator impiously, because they know the things that are. But to those foolish souls who are ignorant, and who have not knowingly rejected their Creator, behold they are purified after much suffering and are sent to the world again."

The teachings involved in the above laws are so clear, so simple, and we may also add so divinely just, that to attempt in any way to explain or annotate them would only be to sow the first seeds of error and misunderstanding.

We will, therefore, leave them with the reader as they are, pure and free from the mental bias of any mortal being.

In a previous chapter we have shown that all realms of life above the human are immortal, and that those below this plane are the reverse, or, that they only possess the possibilities of immortality in a rudimentary form. That man, alone, possesses the elements of both life and death. The laws of life have also been fully elucidated, and the soul which even only imperfectly obeys them will, "after it has been purified by much suffering," ultimately reap the reward of eternal conscious existence. Consequently, the great majority of those souls who are really human beings, will inherit immortality as the natural consequence of their humanity. But there are exceptions, which though few in number, comparatively, as previously stated, require special notice. These exceptions may, for the sake of convenience, be divided into three distinct classes. The first and most numerous class consists of imperfectly organized, sensitive, weak-natured individuals, with little or no mental bias, who possess strong mediumistic magnetisms. Individuals of this class, though perfectly human to begin with, soon lose the actual control of the external organism, and in consequence the body becomes the obedient instrument for any and every class of disembodied earth bound spirits, or, what is still worse, it may become the slave of some vicious elementary. In this case there was no real or true individuality, therefore, no one can assert truthfully that he was actually acquainted with the true personage; for the real soul had departed probably in the very early infancy

of the organism's physical existence, how, when, or where, none but the trained seer can tell, as in every individual case the astral causes that produced the soul's abortion will differ widely.

The second class are those who fall victims to premeditated obsession, and are by no means so numerous as the former. In this case the organism is generally very fine, so far as the magnetic temperament is concerned, but the soul is utterly wanting in spiritual volition or will. That is to say, the magnetic polarity is of such a nature that the spiritual will of the soul is almost powerless to act upon it. The absence of this essential element of human life may be the result of mental conditions of the mother during pregnancy, or of a mental coma, so to say, of both parents at the moment of conception. This mental coma externalizes itself in the offspring as a lack of vim, nerve and fire. Hence we often see this condition manifested in the children of kings, noblemen, and those of great wealth, who have the means to pander to and gratify a fashionable, sentimental lassitude. In addition to this lack of spiritual volition, the magnetic constitution is always strongly mediumistic and the individual, if left quite free from the control of others, would be naturally good, highly sensitive, and in the true sense of spiritual parlance, "a spirit medium,"—inspirational, physical, or clairvoyant, according to his peculiar magnetic grade. This is the reason why they often fall the victim of premeditated obsession. When obsession transpires it is generally found that some potent external mind, that of an evil sorceress, or black magician,

(according to the sex,) requires the organism for the purpose of prolonging their own personal existence. When a suitable mediumistic body is found, they bring the whole of their powerful magnetic will to bear upon the almost will-less brain of their victims, and slowly but surely eject the rightful occupant, and then, by virtue of their Occult powers and magic arts, inhabit the organism themselves, while the near friends and relatives of the victim are often surprised at the remarkable change which they notice has taken place, in temperament and disposition, but alas! they seldom or never suspect the terrible truth which such change implies, nor can they possibly be brought to fully understand that the individual moving among them as usual has nothing whatever in common with their silently departed friend.

The third and last, also the least in number, of these classes includes those who are born into the world under strangely conflicting conditions. Possessing all the essential elements of manhood, they also possess a powerful current of the most potent and concentrated form of selfishness and pride. In addition to this undesirable acquisition they express the highest form of intellectuality combined with a powerful will and mediumistic temperament. These dominating conditions predispose them to the study of psychology and Occultism, hence they fall an easy prey to the members of the Black magi and their inversive astral Brethren. Their selfishness, combined with their unbounded ambition and desire for power, precipitate them headlong into the most frightful practices, where, surrounded

by the infernal rites of their diabolical seducers, they become the helpless slaves of the very powers they sought to control. Henceforward they are lost. As the Hermetic law states, "They are punished with death," and they know it, and consequently are compelled, for their own safety, to remain faithful to the order which entrapped them. Their only motto is self, their only desire is to live, and this they will do at any cost. For their own single lives they would sacrifice the balance of God's creation, if such a thing were possible, simply because death to them is death in reality.

In the first and second classes of so-called lost souls, the true individual, as we have shown, does not become lost, he is "the foolish," ignorant soul, "sent to the world again."* He simply loses his physical organism. This personality, along with the animal and astral portion of it, becomes a lifeless shadow at death, and slowly disintegrates within the magnetic spaces of the astral light. It is a misty form, incapable of personating its original owner, or of being "galvanized into temporary life." While the counterfeiting, obsessing forces, after running the cycle of the magnetic existence within the electro-vital spaces of the planet, become attached to the eighth sphere, the Dark Satellite or orb of death. This attraction is brought into force by vir-

*Not sent to the world again by means of a re-incarnation in matter upon the outward planes of life, but by a sympathetic union with some kindred soul on earth, whose experiences they can experience, whose sorrows they can feel, and whose joys they can share. The writer has beheld numerous cases of this kind, where the soul of some unfortunate, mediumistic organism was sympathetically attached to the organism of a living individual, as a means of progress, and of completing this round of external experiences.

tue of their affinity with the realms of elemental being. They have sunk beneath the plane of humanity, and consequently are no longer human, and when once they become enclosed within the fatal magnetic whirl of death, they lose the polarity over the feeble atoms which constitute their only being, and gradually dissolve, atom by atom, like the poisonous miasmatic mists before the rising sun. While the Deific Atoms themselves, which these lost personalities failed to realize, imperishable as ever, enter upon a new cycle of involution and evolution, thus slowly building up new individualities for themselves. Not on this planet the scene of their failure and suffering, but on a higher plane, in worlds more ethereal than ours.

CHAPTER IV.

THE TRIUMPH OF THE SOUL — ADEPTSHIP.

Having considered the failure of what might be termed the human-animal soul, in the preceding chapter, we now come to the triumph of the human soul over the forces of matter, known as adeptship. This subject furnishes a fitting terminus to the first part of our mystical studies, in which we have included, though briefly, every important section of Occult science embraced within "the lesser mysteries" of nature.

By the triumph of the human soul over the forces of matter termed adeptship, we do not refer to the attaining of immortality, since, as previously stated, the vast majority of

mankind inherit immortality as the result of their humanity, although this is not completely assured until they have passed through the sixth state of the soul world. But we refer to those rare embodied human beings, so organized and circumstanced as to be able to evolve the sixth and seventh states, or, in other words, to attain to the powers and blessings of their immortality while yet outwardly upon the human plane of embodied existence.

The literary world has been flooded of late with descriptions and explanations of adeptship. Definitions have even been attempted of the various degrees and grades of this exalted state, but so far the generality of such would-be expounders of states higher than themselves have (with one or two exceptions) failed most completely; for the very simple reason that no human being can describe the nature and condition of a higher spiritual state of life than that to which his own spiritual nature has attained. Only two individuals, therefore, can really describe adeptship. One is the adept himself, the other is his accepted neophyte, his future successor, who has passed the third initiation, and is thence-forward in perfect magnetic rapport with the master to whose state he is to succeed when that master ascends unto a still higher sphere of spiritual life and powers.

To those real seekers of esoteric knowledge who aspire to know Truth, irrespective of the claims of any literary or learned worldly authority, we offer the following elucidation of adeptship as coming from one who has actually passed through the various realms and states of spiritual existence necessary for the acquisition of the knowledge put forth, and

which is, therefore, the result of personal experiences within the world of spirit. And should the writer be blindly charged with contradicting all the previous teachings of the modern Theosophical authorities upon the subject, it only remains to point out the fact that very few (if any) of them are entitled to explain the lofty state they would set forth, and that their descriptions are mostly inference and surmise rather than conscious knowledge.*

In order to present the subject as clearly as possible to the student, we will consider first, the various grades of adeptship, second, the nature and functions of adeptship, and third, how adeptship is attainable.

I.—The Various Grades of Adeptship.

In the first place, there are three distinct grades of this exalted state, each grade containing within itself three separate states or degrees of life and power, so that in the whole there are nine states of Wisdom. These principle grades may be designated, in general terms, as the natural, the spiritual and the celestial states of the soul's progressive evolutions. The first—the most external state—relates to the world of physical phenomena, and deals exclusively with the elemental spheres of the planet, and the astro-magnetic currents which control them. The powers of the adept of this grade extend from the elemental zones of matter in the world of effects, up to the astro-magnetic spheres in the realm of cause. "Beyond this astral world

*The author refers only to a portion of the literature published upon this subject during the past ten years by Buddhistical Theosophists.

they become powerless. Hence their highest achievements are within the realms of external magical phenomena."

The second grade, which constitutes the interior or spiritual state of the first, relates to the realm of spirit and deals exclusively with the spiritual and ethereal forces of the planet. The adepts of this grade are the translated souls of those who have graduated through the various degrees of the first. As such they fulfill the duties of master or teacher to those who are still graduating in the outer degrees of spiritual life. Their power extends from the magnetic zones of the astral world up to the ethereal and spiritual spheres of dis-embodied humanity. Beyond these states of spiritual life they cannot penetrate, hence their highest achievements are within the spheres of dis-embodied existence. Occupying as they do the interior degree of life, they are enabled to combat the hells, on the one hand, and to sustain the heavens, on the other. These spiritual adepts cannot descend to earth (as we understand the term) and manifest their power externally, without the aid of a properly trained instrument whose odyllic sphere they can temporarily occupy. Their chief means of communication with the external world are the adepts of the exterior grade, through whom they transmit such portions of spiritual truth as the world hath need of.

The third grade constitutes the internal or celestial state of the second, and is the highest degree of spiritual life that the embodied human mind can comprehend, and relates to the higher states of purified souls. It is above and beyond what we know as the human. It is angelic and

celestial in nature. Of its Deific powers and potentialities we cannot speak. They are beyond the grasp of external life.

At this point, it is of the utmost importance that the student should clearly grasp the relation of these three grades to each other, in order to form a correct idea of the nature and functions of adeptship, and also in order to understand in what consists the means of its attainment.

The first grade and the three degrees included within it, embrace all the possibilities of humanity under the external conditions of the present cycle; for, beyond the limited possibilities of the "Life Wave" not even the adept—heir elect of the angels though he be—can transcend. The various astral spaces which mark off the limits of these human possibilities, constitute the boundary line of nature drawn by the finger of Deity between the two worlds of human life—the natural and the spiritual. When the external life mission of an adept of the first grade is fulfilled, a process analogous to physical dissolution transpires; the physical atoms which constitute the organism are liberated and the exalted soul enters upon a higher state of evolution and life, and becomes the spiritual man or an adept of the second grade. The second grade is thus a continuation of the first, upon a higher and more interior plane, and the scene of the soul's activity is transferred from the astral and magnetic spheres to the realm of spirit. This state holds the grand key of life and death, wherein all the greater mysteries of external life are concealed. It also stands midway between the man and the angel, and thus presents to us the equipoise between the human and the divine.

From the lowest grade of the human being on the external planes of matter up to the highest grade, or the perfect man, there are seven states; so also in the realm of spiritual humanity, there are seven states from the perfect man up to the angel. The vast importance of this grade of life, or spiritual adeptship, is also manifest from the fact that it is upon the boundaries of the sixth and seventh state of this grade that the two halves of the divine soul become permanently and eternally united. The twin souls, male and female, then constitute the complete whole of the divine Ego. This mystical union is "the marriage of the Lamb" of Saint John, wherein the man becomes the angel—the human becomes divine—and enters upon the unknown cycles of Deific life. He is the grand angelic hierophant of celestial mysteries, the nature, power, and functions of which are too transcendent for the comprehension of the embodied mortal.

II.—The Nature and Functions of Adeptship.

In passing to this branch of our subject we shall deal only with the first grade, or adeptship of the external degree; since before it is possible for the student to fully comprehend the powers of the second he must himself attain unto the first. Therefore, to avoid any misconception, let it be distinctly understood that the whole of what now follows pertains exclusively to that state of adeptship whose members live, move, and have their being and launch forth their powers, either upon the external planes of physical

life, or else within the spheres of the astral world immediately interior to it.

Since the adept is the perfect man, it is evidently necessary to comprehend what is the nature of his perfection—in what it consists. We have already fully explained, that in the Occult sense of the term, man is a composite being possessing a seven-fold constitution, and seven cyclic states of existence, that is to say, progressive states of evolution upon the physical plane. The perfect man, therefore, is he who evolves in full his composite being and attains unto the seven states while yet existing in external physical conditions. While on the other hand, the ordinary human being is compelled to attain whatever he lacks of perfection within the purgatorial states of purification of the soul world. Ignorance and selfishness, or else the jarring discords produced by the combination of the two, force the great majority of mankind out of the central line of march mapped out by progressive evolution. At the present time mankind has evolved but five physical senses. The perfect composite man, however, possesses not only seven physical senses, but also seven soul senses, related to each other as follows:

Physical Senses.

1. Touch.
2. Taste.
3. Smell.
4. Sight.
5. Hearing.
6. Intuition.
7. Thought transference.

Soul Senses.

1. The power to psychometrize.
2. The power to absorb and enjoy the finer essence of the life wave.
3. The power to distinguish the spiritual aromas of nature.
4. The lucid state called clairvoyance.
5. The ability to perceive the ethereal vibrations termed clairaudience.
6. The capacity to receive true inspiration.
7. The power to converse with spiritual intelligences at will.

When the human soul has attained unto these seven states, his divine right to rule follows as a natural sequence. The powers of the will increase as the attributes of the soul expand, and therefore it is perfectly useless to preach so much about cultivating the will, since that is accomplished by evolving the soul qualities or senses. The magical powers of the adept which enable him to partially control the elements and to produce various kinds of physical phenomena at will, are not the outcome of that terrific will force, so pleasing as a sentiment to many drawing-room occultists, but they are the mild expressions of a firm but gentle soul in the process of evolving forms in the spiritual imagery of thought. There is nothing "tremendous," nothing of the "fearful intensity" about it, for the slightest tremor of the purified soul when consciously placed *en rapport* with the astral light will produce surprising results, and the higher the plane from which the embodied adept projects his thought desire the more extensive and potential the phenomena in the sublunary world of effects.

Such, then, is adeptship; such are the glorious possibilities attainable by the human race when the spiritual attributes of their being are allowed to grow and expand in the sunny atmosphere of a pure and unselfish life. It is a state that may well be regarded as the climax of our Earth's possibilities upon her outward plane. A victory that the human race may justly feel proud of, is the grand triumph of the Soul over the forces of matter.

III.—How Adeptship is attainable.

We will now proceed to explain, as far as permissible, "the *modus operandi*" by which adeptship is actually attained. But it will be first necessary to consider who may and who may not possess the necessary qualifications, since the adept is, of a truth, like the poet, "born and not made." The adept is born a king of his kind. He is a spiritual and mental giant of his race, and cannot be made without possessing these royal qualities in a very highly developed state from his birth. External life is too short and antagonistic forces too great, during the present cycle, for the adept to be manufactured out of the rudimentary forces and embryonic soul qualities of the average mortal. It has been asserted by one who claims the honor of adeptship, that "the adept is the rare efflorescence of an age." This is, however, only figuratively correct, as in real truth there are several such flowers in each race during the course of a single generation. Each family plant of mankind ultimately produces the rare flower of its line, and then becomes exhausted for that cycle. "It has run to seed."

Not all of these rare flowers of the royal line may attain adeptship, since they often exhaust their forces in other directions for the good of humanity, but such souls alone possess the possibilities, or, in other words, the primary conditions.

When, therefore, these primary conditions exist, the first course to be pursued is to devote as much time as possible to the study of spiritual subjects and to master each and

every branch of Occultism obtainable in the outside world. Simultaneously with this study must be carried on the training of the body in regard to matters of diet, and the sexual relations. In other words, the human soul must be wholly evolved up out of the animal soul, *i. e.*, the sphere of undeveloped good in man's constitution must be developed. The animal forces and appetites, instead of being conquered and chained like a wild beast as taught by oriental mystics, must be gradually developed and transformed or evolved into the human. The problem of good and evil must be solved in the individual case. And right here consists the vital point of failure or success, defeat or triumph. As we have labored over and over again to impress upon the student that man is a composite being and that perfection consists in harmonious evolution, it ought by this time to be self-evident to any candid mind that those fearful practices in the East, of asceticism, celibacy, self-mutilations, etc., simply starve and chain the animal into subjection, instead of developing it into a useful, obedient and most highly important factor of the perfect man's seven-fold nature.

In regard to the question of diet, the first aim should be to remove gradually and yet as rapidly as possible the desire for animal food. In the flesh of animals the particles of vegetable matter have been completely polarized toward the animal soul, hence when taken into the human system they tend at once to build up and fortify that very portion which we wish to transform and eliminate. Fish, however, are sufficiently removed from the human to be

allowed to the beginner, yet, as he progresses, vegetables, grains, and, lastly, fruits, will furnish the requisite amount of physical nourishment.

Upon the question of the sex relation and its various mysteries we have treated elsewhere,* and will only add a few words which seem demanded by the fearful danger arising from the illusive doctrines now freely circulated by the "inversive magi." Love, pure and divine, is the grand keynote according to which all the harmonies of the Infinite Universe are tuned. Love is life and immortality, while the teachings and practice which insidiously or openly produce a contempt for sex and love, all tend toward the dark satellite and death, in its awful and occult sense; for just in proportion as love is displaced, self rushes in to fill the vacuum. Therefore, to ignorantly follow any occult training which unbalances or crushes, instead of harmoniously developing the seven-fold nature, ends as disastrously in self, as selfishness does to start with.

The ascetic, whether ignorant or selfish, who starts out to attain magical powers for himself, and who enters upon a cold, rigid use of the will to crush and annihilate his animal passions, may succeed in these regards, but he will find out too late that his powers over the elements and forces of nature have been purchased at the awful expense of the destruction of the feminine portion of his own soul by gradual absorption into himself of the being upon whose development in harmony with his own depends his immortality. He, therefore, can never realize that union with the

*See the Mysteries of Sex, Chapter IV.

twin soul which constitutes the divine Ego. He can only know self. Thenceforward he denies there is aught in the universe beyond his state except Nirvana to which he is drifting, which is practically a condition of annihilation, but which he fondly pictures in as vague and pleasing terms as possible, as "absorption into the Infinite." He denies point blank (since they no longer exist for him) the angelic and celestial states, and devotes himself to a systematic dissemination of the dogmas of karma and re-incarnation, which in their essence are the most subtle and enervating forms of fatality conceivable by the human mind, since they sap the soul of all true inspiration toward the higher self and perfect life. These subtle doctrines not only continually prompt man to leave undone many things until his next incarnation, but they leave mankind generally in that helpless apathetic condition exactly suited to render them an easy prey for the inversive magi, who exist upon their vitality.

We will now give a few directions for the evolution of the soul senses or qualities. In the first place some special time in the morning and evening should be set apart for the evolution of the spiritual sight. Whether it be by gazing into a crystal magic mirror, or magnetic disc, matters not, since the outcome (if the quality exists) will be the same, viz.: spiritual lucidity. The spiritual sense of touch, or the powers of psychometry, should be evolved by (as often as possible) placing any object that comes handy, such as rocks, shells, letters, etc., to the forehead. If no particular perception transpires, try the sensorium or that part of the

brain situated between the crown and the forehead. If this effort should fail, try the solar plexus and note the impressions received, then test these as to their correctness or otherwise. Remember that many efforts may be required to arouse the dormant sense into action, therefore, do not be discouraged at repeated failures. The sense of spiritual hearing or clairaudience will follow the senses of sight and touch as a natural sequence. When these senses are evolved the primary difficulties are over and that one who will thenceforward act as master and teacher will make himself known. How, when or where we cannot say, but there will be no mistakes, no fear of deception by the Black magi, the truth will be realized within, it will not require one single shadow of external phenomena to convince that soul which is fully prepared for the master's reception, neither will the student have long to wait in expectation. "At the very hour when the soul is ready behold its guide will appear."

The student will fully realize by this time that the soul powers above mentioned possess nothing in common with the so-called spiritual gifts evolved during the development of spirit mediumship. The medium is under the partial or absolute control of some foreign mind, but the neophyte, in the course of his development, evolves powers which are the free, clear, conscious outcome of his own divine nature. Consequently, when training our spiritual nature we should isolate ourselves from contact with the world as much as possible, therefore, a life among the wild mountain solitudes is especially potent in this respect, as it brings us at once in direct contact with nature as she really is, the senses of

the soul become stimulated and quickened, the physical organism is removed from the contaminating pollution of city life, and is thus protected from the unseen snares and temptations of the world. And as the external mind, when alone, soon begins to explore the craggy mountain sides and examine their fauna and flora — so the soul, when removed from the chaining magnetism of large masses of men, soon begins to soar upwards towards its source on high, returning from each spiritual flight with some occult treasure for its owner, though he at first may not realize fully the precious jewels which he is accumulating.

As there may be many roads which will ultimately lead us to the same mountain top,* so there are many systems of occult training. But the one which will have the widest application has been presented. The end in view of every system is the same, viz.: to first evolve conscious lucidity, the rest will then follow. When once the aspirant becomes the accepted neophyte, whether he personally sees him or internally realizes the master makes no difference, his future progress depends upon his strict obedience to the commands received, unselfish motives, and a pure life.

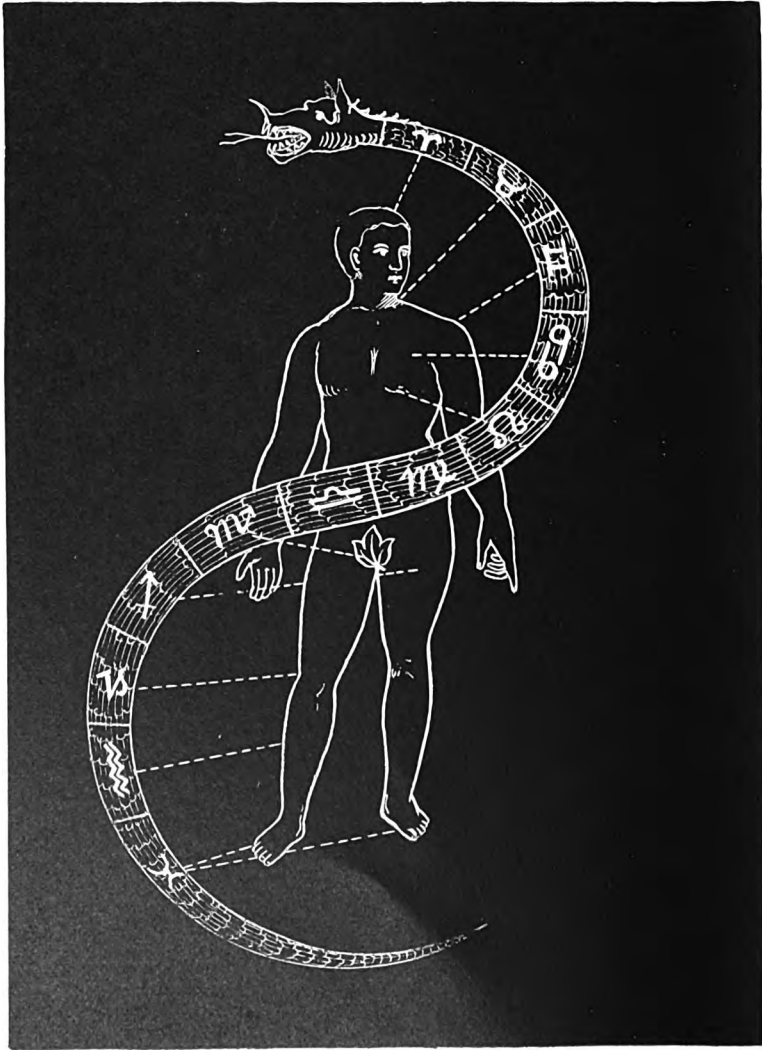
With these remarks we bring the present course of occult study to a close. We have written during the past twelve months probably as much as the ordinary human mind will be able to realize, and we feel thankful that our task has been brought to a successful termination. At

*To persons of negative temperaments, Yoga training will produce the desired results. But this system is more suitable for eastern organisms than Western. There is, however, a mine of Occult lore in the "Yoga Philosophy."

every step we have had to fight against the fierce, cruel legionaries of the Black Magi, whose terrible secrets we have been the means of revealing to the world. These inversive brethren pose before the world to-day as the harbingers of light and oriental wisdom, but beneath this external delusive glamor we can see the bloodthirsty forms of the shadow. Our task has been accomplished rather with the point of the sword than through the instrumentality of the pen. The mediumistic upholders and supporters of oriental magic, dogma and delusion have also done their best to destroy our work, but it lives, and will survive long enough to crush them with its glittering force, for *omnia vincit veritas* constitutes the motive force behind it. Charges of fraud, and accusations of Black magic, have been systematically tried without avail, and nothing now remains for them but calumny and slander, but whatever these inversive opponents of truth may see fit to bring forth in the future in order to stem the swelling tide of Occult knowledge and spiritual progress, rest assured they will ultimately fail, and the terrible agonies of their conscious defeat will discount a thousand times the benefits of an apparently temporary gain. Here we close this part of our work, casting our labors as bread upon the mental currents of life, and wait with patience, for it will be after many days ere the results will be known. In the meantime we shall rest with the certain knowledge that whatever is, is good, undeveloped though it be.

N. B.—Throughout the preceding chapters the author has repeatedly directed his criticism against Buddhistical

Theosophy. In so doing he desires his readers to always bear in mind that he does not include any true Theosophist, nor any really earnest seeker after the hidden light of Occult lore, be they theosophists, Jews of the orthodox faith, or Christians. In using the terms Buddhistical Theosophy, Modern Theosophy, etc., he only means the hidden disseminators and public worshippers of that peculiar phase of Buddhism wrongly called esoteric, which makes Re-incarnation and Karma an absolute dogma of faith, and the corner stone of Occult philosophy, as intimated by the real external founder of the T. S. in the columns of "*The Path*," in an article professing to "explain" certain very inconvenient passages in "*Isis Unveiled*."



PART II.

THE SCIENCE OF THE STARS.

INTRODUCTION.

In commencing this brief elucidation of the Astro-logos of the Ancients it is necessary, perhaps, to inform the reader that the system about to be elaborated is purely astro-masonic and constitutes that special branch of the primeval "Wisdom religion" which made the ancient Occult schools of Egypt and Chaldea so justly famous for their Esoteric learning.

Astrology *per se* is a combination of two sciences, viz.: astronomy and correspondences. These two are related to each other as hand and glove; the former deals with suns, moons, planets and stars, and strictly confines its researches to a knowledge of their size, distance and motion, while the latter deals with the spiritual and physical influences of the same bodies,—first upon each other, then upon the earth, and lastly upon the organism of man. Astronomy is the external lifeless glove; correspondences the living hand within.

It was from the mystical land of Chaldea that our Egyptian ancestors derived their knowledge of Astronomy

and Astrology. This knowledge was, fortunately, transplanted into good soil and flourished for untold ages under the fostering care of her mighty priesthood and colossal sacerdotalism.

From the fertile valley of the Nile, long ages before Abraham and his herdsmen wandered over the desert of Arabia, this sublime science of the starry heavens, with its priestly devotees, was carried by tidal emigration over the Caucasus, across the arid steppes of Asia, through the wild mountain passes of Afghanistan and Thibet to the burning plains of Hindustan, and from thence was spread by India's dusky sons among the Mongol and Tartar races of the still remoter East.

Knowledge, we are told, travels westward, and, so far as Europe and America are concerned, this is true in the present cycle. But the time once was when this mental and intellectual current was reversed, and knowledge traveled eastward.

From the magical schools of the lost Atlantis the sacred stream of learning flowed towards the rising sun into the regions of Central Africa, and from thence to the coast, up the Persian gulf to Chaldea, then from the banks of the sacred Euphrates and the plains of Shinar the stream flowed backward (as though weary and seeking rest) toward its native home in the Western seas, only to be detained upon its journey and to find a temporary resting place in the wondrous valley of the Nile,—when, after changing its personal appearance somewhat and adopting the dress of its gifted patrons, it was again projected onward by the rest-

less impulse of Egyptian enterprise, along the shores of the Mediterranean and Black seas to the Caucasus, and thence eastward, as before mentioned, to the dreamy skies of India.

When we come to think of the awful vastness and inconceivable beauty of the glittering worlds which stud, like jewels, the dark canopy of our midnight skies, undoubtedly we must admit that the contemplation of the shining heavens, with its myriad galaxies of starry systems and stretch of fathomless eternities, forms a sublime study for the thinking astronomical mind. There, alone, can he see something of the boundless affinity of the universe. But to the Occult student of Urania's blazing firmament the shining constellations, with their cabalistic names and weird mythological histories; the glittering suns of these far off astral systems, and the shining planets which belong to the same solar family as ourselves, possess a deeper interest. Everything around us, save it, is in a state of transition. Besides the fleeting changes which the return of the seasons bring, the landscape around us is every year changing its aspect. In fact, all around us is change. There is nothing but one eternal change of form. But the gorgeous creations in the sky are still there, undimmed in brightness, unchanged in grandeur; performing, with unflagging pace and unvarying precision, their daily, their annual, and their mighty cyclic rounds. Upon the same heavens, just as we see them now, bespangled with the same planets and with the same familiar stars, gazed the first parents of our race, when they began and also when they ended their pil-

grimage upon this mundane sphere. The same constellations, Arcturus, Orion, and the Pleiades, sang together with the morning stars when the fiery foundations of our earth were laid, and they rolled in the fabled darkness over Calvary when the gentle Nazarine was slain. They are truly the only objects which all nations have witnessed, and all people admired. They are truly the only objects in the universe which have remained unpolluted by the finger of man. They presided at the Horoscope of our birth; they will sing the funeral requiem when we die, and cast their pale radiance over the cold, silent tombs beneath which we are ultimately destined to repose.

Before the aspirant can become the astrologer he must make himself familiar with the general principles of astronomy,* and learn how to trace the external symbols of physical life, which are the phenomenal results, back into the stellar worlds of cause. The whole mystery of this system, therefore, may be designated in general terms as the science of cause and effect.

From the foregoing remarks it will be seen that the reader must not expect the revelation of some divine, mysterious secret that will instantly convey the power of reading the past, realizing the influences of the present, and foreseeing the momentous events within the womb of the future; on the contrary, he must expect nothing but a clear and concise statement of nature's immutable laws, which

*The text book of Astrology by A. J. Pierce, and Wilson's Dictionary of Astrology should also be closely studied. Both works may be obtained of Messrs. A. H. Roffe & Co., Boston, Mass.

require both study and application to master. He will, however, find in this series of lessons a complete exposition of the Occult principles of nature, in so far as they mold and guide the physical destiny of embodied humanity. But the principles involved and the ultimates evolved as the natural outcome of cause and effect, can only be mastered and understood by devoting time and unprejudiced thought; first in learning the theory, and then in reducing that theory to practice. Astrology does not imply fatality. On the contrary, probably two thirds of man's so called misfortunes are the result of his benighted ignorance. Man, when ignorant of the laws of nature which control his existence and destiny, is somewhat like a lifeless log floating with the stream. It may be that the various currents of the river will carry him safely to the river's mouth, and launch him uninjured upon the great Ocean of Eternity. But it is far more likely that the winding course of the river of life will land him into a mud bank of trouble where he may stick fast for the remainder of his days; or, liberated by some stronger current, may again take his chances, either of future safety or of floating into some whirlpool of destruction. But when man understands the laws of his being, he is then safe on board a strong boat. He sees the whirlpools and mud banks of life ahead, and skillfully by the use of his steering apparatus (the will) avoids collision. But it often happens that with all his knowledge and skill he can not successfully battle against the mighty currents that oppose his way, simply because there are, in these days, too many lifeless logs of human lumber that are constantly

throwing themselves with the swell of the current athwart his path. But it must be at once apparent to the student how infinitely superior the one is to the other, and how enormous the chances of success are upon the side of the one who hath attained unto wisdom—who by study knows himself.

The heavenly bodies urge, predispose and influence to a great extent, but they do not compel. When we are ignorant of their power, we decide our actions to the best of our worldly knowledge, and we think we have free will in the matter, but, if we could only see the influences at work moulding our actions, we should see that we were obeying the stellar powers with slave-like servility, not always wisely, indeed, but blindly and too well. Under such a state of bondage the planetary influence would, indeed, be fatality. Knowledge alone is the great liberator of human suffering, and social inharmony. Our delivery from pain, our freedom from bondage, in other words, our free will, increases exactly in proportion to the extent of our knowledge. It is the Wise Man who rules his stars, and the fool who blindly obeys them. Consequently this Chaldean science of the stars, in order to be practically utilized, must be thoroughly realized; but when realized it will repay the student a hundred-fold for the time and labor bestowed. It will give him a tangible foundation whereon he may safely stand amid the wild and conflicting opinions of unbalanced mystics. In it he will find the key of the sacred sanctuary wherewith he may eventually unlock the doors of the temple and penetrate the mystic veil of Isis, there to behold the lovely

form of the Goddess and to read the glowing verities of nature inscribed upon the imperishable scrolls of time, and, if he have the will to seek further and deeper, the truths of eternity itself.

Astrology, in its purity, though forming a system of divination, is totally unconnected with either fortune-telling or sensitive, irresponsible mediumship. It is a divine science of correspondences, in the study and application of which the intellect and intuition become blended in a natural, harmonious manner. They commence to vibrate in unison. When this union becomes complete, the ignorant man becomes the prophetic sage.

Therefore, we would earnestly request the student of the system herein about to be taught, thoroughly to master each principle and detail laid down; commit them to memory so as to be able instantly to recall and repeat them when necessary. Study well the Occult principles of the science before attempting to master the external mathematical formula, and never lose sight of the fact that no one principle is of itself absolute, but to become potent requires the active coöperation of the other forces. If these oppose with their influences, instead of assisting, then it at once becomes a question of power against power; if they equal each other, the influence of both becomes nil, and the effects, instead of evolving into the realm of external life, become crystallized within the realm of force, and die within the womb of nature. And, lastly, remember that this ancient system of the hoary sages, who first discovered the starry truths of the Chaldean lore, constitutes the basic principle from which

all doctrines, Occult theories, and sacerdotal systems have radiated. Every religion under the sun has an astrological foundation, and every science the human mind is capable of elaborating, springs from, returns to, and ultimately becomes lost within the starry realms of Urania.

In conclusion, therefore, we hope that our efforts to instruct the student in these sublime mysteries will assist him to store up a supply of precious food which will enable him to receive mental pleasure and spiritual profit, thus proving a blessing as well to the body as the soul.

CHAPTER I.

"So God created man in his own image, in his own image created he him."—*Genesis*, Chap I.

Man is a microcosm, a universe within himself, and as such he is a perfect epitome of the infinite Universe, the Macrocosm. The Chaldean sages, therefore, when constructing their mighty system of sidereal astrology, held to this idea throughout the whole of their philosophy. In order to penetrate the mysteries of God, they first sought out the mysteries of man, and then formulated a complete science of correspondences. The Human organism, so complex in its wonderful mechanism and so beautifully harmonious in all its parts, became their architectural design upon which they constructed the Grand Man of the starry heavens. The twelve signs of the celestial zodiac were divided into sections of the human frame, so that the entire zodiacal belt was symbolized as a man bent round in the form of a circle, the soles of the feet placed against the back of the head. Each of the twelve signs contains 30° (degrees of space) the whole making the 360° of a circle. This 360° is the symbol of completion. When the 3 and 6 are added together they make 9, thus $3+6=9$, which is the highest unit we possess, and as such is held to be the sacred number of Deity. It is a triune trinity — 3×3 .

The mystical symbolism relating to the 12 signs of the zodiac and the human organism holds an important position in our system. In this connection they form the body of a

musical instrument as it were, while the sun, moon and planets constitute the strings. Our bodies then, when astrologically considered, are merely sounding boards for the celestial notes, struck by the starry musicians during the performance of their celestial opera, "The Music of the Spheres." Figure 1 shows what part of the human frame is ruled by each sign. It will be noticed that the sun and moon, through the mediumship of their signs, Leo (Ω) and Cancer (♋), govern the two principal organs, viz.: the heart and stomach. When these are in an harmonious condition within the body the whole system is healthy: this is also correspondingly true regarding the Grand Man of the skies, or, in other words, the natal horoscope.

More depends upon the position, aspect and power of the sun and moon at birth than upon all the planets of our solar system combined. For this reason, the sun and moon are, to us, the transmitters of the stellar forces. They act in the capacity of astral mediums and cast their gathered or reflected potencies into our magnetic atmosphere, harmoniously or discordantly, according as they are aspected by the malefic or benefic rays of the major planets. The only difference between the two being that one is electric in its action, hence positive; the other is magnetic and negative. In themselves alone they are neither fortunate nor unfortunate. If these facts are remembered, we cannot go very far wrong in our astral studies.

Man has five positive points of projection and four positive centers of energy, thus making up the mystical nine, symbol of Deity. In addition to these, he has one great

receptive center which completes the number of the Ten Sephiroth. The head, hands and feet are the five points of projection from which streams of vital force are constantly radiating. These five are symbolized by the five pointed star and the five sided figure. This quintile, the Grecian Hygeia, was the Pythagorean symbol of health, and when these five points radiate their forces in straight lines from their various centers, the result is perfect health.

The positive centers of energy within the odylic sphere are the brain, the spleen, the heart and the generative organs, while the great center of reception is the Solar Plexus.

When trouble or anxiety of mind crosses our path the first place where we feel its influence is that part of the body called the pit of the stomach. This sensitive region is within the solar plexus. How many times do forebodings of coming trouble impress themselves upon this delicate center? As a rule, when we are in trouble we have no appetite; this calls forth inharmony in the various secretions of the body. When sickness and its disagreeable correlations take possession of the organism, keep this mighty center protected, and you have the true secret of absolutely perfect physical health, providing you possess, to begin with, an organism whose mental and physical forces are evenly balanced.

The solar plexus is our grand contacting point whereby we are placed *en rapport* with all things external to us. Therefore, we can see that the true psychical basis of physical health rests with this center; for it is taken for granted

that man is by lawful superiority the natural ruler of those powers which live, move and have their being within his own magnetic dominions. To possess true psychological power which shall be subject to the imperial will and thus be able to assume perfect control of the odylic sphere; to concentrate all our loyal forces, at a moment's notice, upon any particular section of this magnetic kingdom, and thus instantly subdue any revolt of the reactionary powers—it is absolutely imperative that our physical bodies be kept free and uncramped by any article of dress which restrains us from developing our true natural forms. Mental and magnetic liberty depends, to an extent hitherto undreamed of, upon the perfect freedom of the physical organism. Therefore, that which cramps, binds and warps the body out of its natural proportions, is fatal to any real spiritual progress; because it correspondingly inharmonizes the action of the odylic sphere. For this reason alone, India, Chaldea and Egypt adopted the loose flowing robe; for this reason alone, is the dress of all priesthoods loose and ample — to give them the very fullest measure of magnetic power. Corsets and small pinching shoes have done more to destroy the true spirituality of the present generation than all the other causes of ignorance combined.

Anything to be truly beautiful must be truly natural. It is our utterly false idea of so-called female beauty that is doing an inconceivable amount of spiritual mischief at the present day. If our fairer sex could only see one degree further than the limits of a depraved, artificial fashion they would soon realize that small waists, pinched up with corsets,

make them look more like wasps than intelligent human beings, and that small, pinched feet, with their cramped, ill formed toes are as much of a real deformity as a shrivelled hand or crooked back, the only difference being that the latter are apparent to the external eye, and the former concealed by dress and a pair of dainty shoes. Upon the plane of reality, our true selves, the deformity is there and is as much the result of ignorant superstition as the maimed limbs of Hindu fanatics who place themselves beneath the wheels of the car of Jagannatha. Therefore let us impress upon each student the absolute necessity of perfect freedom. Remember that a cramped waist means an almost useless solar plexus, and a useless solar plexus means spiritual incapacity; spiritual incapacity means bondage to the forces of nature, and this slavery means becoming the helpless medium of nature, upon which the discordant rays of the planetary forces can act and re-act uncontrolled. It is for this latter reason alone that this apparent digression has been made; because the greatest value of astrological science consists in controlling the stellar powers, or rather, let us say, evading their malefic influences. A few more words then upon this important subject, and we are done with it, for "*verbum sat Sapienti*." The physician, the priest and the scientist are equally loud in their assertions that they are perfectly unbiased and open to reason, and they are equally prejudiced and dogmatic should any one be so foolish as to accept their invitation, and attempt to reason with them. We are sorry to say that the fair sex are somewhat similar in regard to their tight lacing. They

will, almost without exception, assert that they, individually, do not pinch themselves, but they will readily admit that others do. It is really surprising how blindly foolish we can be when we ourselves are concerned. They little dream that the constant use of corsets retards their natural development, and, though they may have become used to them so that they do not hurt, but on the contrary feel comfortable, yet in real truth they are held in a grip of iron, and are magnetically ruined. One glance at the form around the solar plexus of a female who wears corsets, and one who has never worn them, ought to convince the most sceptical.

When we regard the astral structure of man and closely examine his magnetic organism, we see that he forms a beautiful oval or egg shaped figure; the narrow end being the feet, the broad end being the brain. This oval form constitutes the magnetic atmosphere, or, in other words, the odyllic sphere of the person, and consists of seven concentric rays of force, each of which has a direct affinity with the seven creative principles of nature, and therefore corresponds in color to the seven prismatic rays of the solar spectrum. Each zone or ring exercises a peculiar power of its own, and is pure or impure according to its state of luminosity. When mediumistic clairvoyants assert that such and such a particular color denotes a pure and benevolent person or one who is depraved and sinful, they assert that which is untrue, for each color has a special purity of its own; purity and impurity depending entirely upon the brightness of its tint. For this reason the animal passions

when exercised, dull and becloud the soul sphere, while the exercise of the spiritual faculties illuminate. To better understand these facts, see Fig. II. The brain center is represented by a sun, the feet by a crescent moon, and the three secondary centers of force by stars. The ingenious student can easily make this figure complete by mentally inserting within the oval odylic sphere, the seven prismatic rings, etc.

From these seven colors are formed every conceivable shade and tint in the infinite variety of combinations, found in the infinite variety of human beings; each and all depending upon the ever changing positions of the stars, and also upon the corresponding magnetic states of our atmosphere at their respective moments of birth. The color and magnetic polarity of this odylic sphere are fixed, quick as lightning's flash, at the first moment of our separate material existence. This true moment is, generally, when the umbilical cord is severed, and the child exists as a separate being, independent of its mother. Until that time the body is polarized by the soul force of its parent, and the planets can only influence it by reflex action from the mother's organism. But when the tie is severed, the lungs become inflated with the magnetic atmosphere, charged with the stellar influx, and in an instant the whole organism thrills with the vibrations of celestial power. These vibrations produce, in each of the concentric rings of the sphere, the exact tint and shade of color corresponding to the harmonious or discordant rays of the heavens at the time.

These vibrations, once in action, retain their special

polarity for the whole tenor of earthly existence. They form the key note of the musical instrument which is ever sounding forth the harmony or discord of its material destiny. This key note is either high or low according to the particular influences which may be operating upon it at the time. At one time the life forces may be so low that the note will be too faint for the most sensitive clairaudient to detect; at other times the throbbing pulsations of life will be so strong with physical vitality that it will swell into the highest octave, and launch forth such potent health giving vibrations as to affect other bodies near it, and draw therefrom responsive vibrations, thus giving life and health to others, in harmony with but weaker than itself. But should the bodies with which it comes in contact be naturally antagonistic to it, in temperament and magnetic polarity, then, instead of responsive harmony, their contact will produce fierce jarring commotions of discord to the detriment of both, the weaker being the greater sufferer; *—hence the student will see what a fearful mistake so called “Christian Scientists” and metaphysical healers make, unless they truly understand the Occult principles of nature. It is utterly impossible for antagonistic natures to

*The action and inter-action of planetary influx upon the human being after birth is determined upon the same lines, viz., that when a planet, by its progressive motion reaches a point on the sphere where it forms an inharmonious angle with the angular vibrations set in motion at birth, magnetic discord is produced: this magnetic storm, so to say, awakens and sets in motion the cosmic and other elementals corresponding in their nature to the primary cause, and external misfortune and trouble are the material results, and *vice versa* should the planets form benefic rays, etc.—This is the true secret of planetary influence so far as what is termed good and bad luck. It is magnetic harmony or discord.

benefit each other mentally, no matter how good or pure they, as individuals, may be. To attempt to do this is like trying to make oil and water harmonize; this is the true secret of the mental healer's lack of success with certain individuals.

For example, any person born under and controlled by the Martial electricity, which corresponds to the element of fire, will prove antagonistic by nature to anybody and everybody who is governed by the Saturnine principle. They will not blend and mingle. The most gentle and loving spirit that it is possible for the healer to exercise under such circumstances will recoil from the odyllic sphere of the other like a thunderbolt, and the mental physician will feel this recoil and want of success, right in the center of the solar plexus. The science of the stars alone contains the real secrets of the healing art divine.

CHAPTER II.

"And the Lord set a mark upon Cain lest anyone finding him should kill him."—*Genesis*, Chap. IV.

At this stage it is necessary to explain several matters of great importance in forming a true conception of astral law. The reader must not suppose that the planets are the primary causes of the fortunes and misfortunes which fall to the lot of mankind generally. This is by no means the case; for the primary cause has its origin within the soul sphere of our parents. The sexual relationship between

man and woman has its laws, its harmonies and discords. It is man's duty to investigate and know these laws, especially so when we bear in mind the fact that there is neither morality nor sentiment in the cold inflexible justice of nature. "Unto every violation of the law there is meted out a penalty." If the attributes of a thief are conceived, a thief will ultimately be born into the world. It matters not what the circumstances or position in life may be, that individual so conceived will be a thief in his heart, and will commit thefts upon some plane or other. Remember, there is no real difference, except in magnitude, between the man who legally by some commercial sharp practice steals a railroad, and the one who, to support his position in life and before the world, lives above his income to the detriment of his creditors; or the poor devil who, under the influence of criminal temptations, robs a bank or steals your watch. All three, when viewed in their true light, are natural born thieves, and each equally deserving, if justice were impartial, of the same term of penance in the house of correction. The false glamor and artificial conventionalities of modern society, however, praise and bow down in adoration to the gifted railroad thief; they pity and condole as unfortunate the man who, by living above his honest income, terminates his career in bankruptcy, but they, with neither pity nor mercy, hurry off to the jail and the treadmill the poor wretch who steals a watch or robs a bank of a few paltry dollars, when, as a rule, it is this one who is most deserving of our sympathy. Ignorance and a neglected childhood may have intensified the evil influences

of his conception and birth to an inconceivable extent, and he might, if the world would only let him, become a better and wiser man. It is equally in accordance with the same immutable laws that every species of crime is born into the world. When inflamed passions and cruel thoughts are latent within us, and remain uncontrolled by the higher self during the conjugal union, we must not be surprised if a child with a similar nature is conceived. When such is the case there is no benevolent God to graciously interfere and prevent a criminal from being launched upon society.

Man has the privilege and possesses the possibilities of choosing the good, and preventing the conception of evil. Therefore if he, either from choice or ignorance, prefers to risk all the natural consequences, Mother Nature, who is no respecter of persons, will write murderer across the brow of the unborn infant in characters as indelible as the mark she inflicted upon Cain.

When the embryonic potentialities of a human soul are launched forth into the matrix they remain there, slowly evolving their organic powers, and are imprisoned within the womb until their magnetic, as well as their physical, period of gestation is completed. Nor is it possible for a child to be born and live until the astral influx corresponds exactly to the external polarity of the soul. Only when the heavens are harmonious can that which we term good become manifest upon the earth. Under the opposite condition of the heavens, evil, so called by comparison, becomes externalized.

From the foregoing it will be seen that we are, to a very

great extent, what the ignorance or wisdom of our ancestors have made us. As the world progresses, mankind obtains more knowledge. Thus do the rising generations become wiser than their parents. This mental evolution moves forward until the intellectuality of the race becomes exhausted; then, for a time, mankind remains stationary, and at length declines from the summit of its genius to relapse into an ignorant barbarism; when, having regained a supply of latent mental force, the race once more advances ultimately to attain unto a still greater perfection than before. Thus do intellectual forces correspond in their apparent motion to the motions of the planets, becoming alternately direct, swift, stationary and retrograde. Men, like plants, have their times of germination, growth, maturity and decay, and races are no exception to this universal law of change. They move in greater cycles only. Their climax of civilization corresponds to the flowering season of the vegetable kingdom; then they run to seed and decay. But in the same racial soil is treasured up the precious seed from the flowers, which, lying dormant, awaits the necessary magnetic and spiritual conditions for its glorious unfoldment.

The stars and planets are the magnetic instruments of the seven creative principles. They influence externally, by their attractive sympathies and repulsive antipathies, the cosmic life forces and physical organisms of precisely the same objects, which, in the realm of spirit, are controlled by their celestial progenitors. By this we mean that the various physical orbs called planets, stars, etc., act as so

many magnetic centers. They are magnetic by solar induction. The sun itself is not magnetic, but positively electric. This mighty electric force acts upon the planets precisely the same as an electric current acts upon the piece of soft iron. When a piece of iron is charged with electricity it becomes at once a magnet, its power depending first upon its mass and secondly upon the strength or intensity of the electric current. Shut off the current and the iron ceases to be a magnet. Remove the sun from our system and the planets will immediately lose their peculiar psychical influence. Modern science, we know, would contradict this assertion, but Occult science proclaims it to be an absolute fact.

The sum total of those powers which we term "planetary influences," is contained within the potentiality of the Solar Ray. But when so united, as a primal cosmic force, the action of this solar ray upon the human organism and its material destiny is neither harmonious nor discordant, fortunate nor unfortunate. To become potent in special directions it is necessary for this solar force to become refracted and resolved into its active attributes. This is precisely what the major planets do. There are six of them, each of which absorbs a single attribute or principle; each one according to its peculiar nature and absorbing affinity. While the solar orb itself retains but one active energy whose potency is embraced within the orange ray of the spectrum,* these planetary bodies, having become mag-

*This influence, of course, relates only to the special action of the seven active principles, and does not refer to the solar light reflected by each body,

netically charged with their own special energy, are powerful radiators of the same attribute which they have received from their solar parent. These energies possess a distinctive motion, color and potency, each peculiar to itself, which, when externalized upon man's internal nature, produce a marked contrast in his mental and physical characteristics, thus*:

The Planet Saturn १

Absorbs that attribute or energy whose action expresses itself as coldness, and thus produces a nature which is slow and meditative, solitary and reserved, melancholy and repentant. This force corresponds to the blue ray of the spectrum.

The Planet Jupiter 2

Absorbs a totally different energy from the Saturnine and radiates an influence at once jovial. A happy medium between the fast and the slow, the meditative and the thoughtless, the isolated hermit and the one too easy of access. The influence is cheerful, generous, benevolent, and sheds light and love upon all material surroundings. This force corresponds to the purple or indigo ray of the spectrum.

The Planet Mars 3

Absorbs an energy which is the polar opposite of the Saturnine and emitted by the sun itself. Five planets, besides the sun and moon (our earth), absorb the seven rays. The other planets react upon higher planes. That is to say, they radiate one of the same forces upon a higher octave.

*See foot note at the end of the chapter.

urnine, and therefore radiates an influence which is sharp, energetic, thoughtless, intrepid and fierce. It is destitute of either fear or timidity. An influence which is free with everything and everybody. Briefly stated, the force of the planet Mars is fiery, imperious, combative in the first degree, bloodthirsty and unrelenting. This energy corresponds to the red ray of the spectrum.

The Sun ☉

Retains and radiates the principle which is at once life-giving and dignified. Just as Jupiter is a compound or happy medium between the energies exerted by Saturn and Mars, so the Sun sends forth an influence which is the happy medium between Jupiter and Mars. It is affable but majestic; proud, but gracious; and blends firmness with kindness, ambition with paternal consideration, combativeness with self-respect, and liberality with discretion. As before stated, this influence corresponds to the orange ray of the spectrum.

The Planet Venus ♀

Absorbs an energy which is totally different from any of the preceding, and radiates "the love element" of nature. This influence is warm and impulsive interiorly, but externally cool and moist, consequently pliable and receptive, clinging and feminine. It is the energy which ever yields to a nature more positive than its own with loving submission; hence the myths of the friendships between Mars and Venus. This energy corresponds to the yellow ray.

The Planet Mercury ☿

Absorbs an energy which, in a general sense, appears to be a compound of all the other planets of the spectrum put together; hence he has been well designated as "the messenger of the gods." The specific action which this orb radiates is purely intellectual and scientific. It is quick and active, intuitional, enterprising, careless, volatile, bright, changeable, and what we call smart. This influence is extremely inventive, and is the originator of all cunning schemes and devices. It is what men term bright and witty. It is that which makes the live man of commerce, and constitutes the leading influence embodied within that sharp, clever and chameleon-like individual who makes a fortune in the real estate office. This energy corresponds to the violet ray of the solar spectrum.

The Moon ☾

The planet upon which we live, move, and have our being absorbs an energy which we, as inhabitants, cannot by nature fully understand or appreciate, because we only receive this energy as an astral influx by the reflective action of our earth's satellite, the Moon. This influence, so far as we, the planet's offspring, are concerned, is neither good nor evil; because it is part and parcel of ourselves. What the influence may be upon the inhabitants of other worlds we cannot say. Therefore, when speaking astrologically, we credit the Moon's reflective power and speak of that body as containing our earth's attribute of the solar ray which corresponds to the green ray of the spectrum.

The above are the seven active principles of nature, but the ingenious student will notice that two of the major planets have not so far been noticed; we refer of course to Uranus ♅ and Neptune ♆. Our previous foot-note explains this omission, and it is only necessary in this place to add thereto the fact that each of the seven principles enumerated have three planes of action; the spiritual, the astral and the physical. After the seven notes of the magnetic gamut have been sounded, the next note must be upon a higher octave and form a repetition of the first. The first scale being known and its effects understood, it is not necessary for the Occult initiate of these astral powers to wait for the years of observation necessary to others in order to tabulate a newly discovered planet. By the laws of correspondences he knows at once what that planet's action upon the human organism will be. There is still another planet, more remote from our sun than Neptune, but its action on our organism at present is nil; because the present races have not yet attained to that special state of spiritual and mental development that will admit of its influence becoming manifest. Neither will such a planet become visible to this earth's inhabitants until there is sufficient mental force of the requisite grade to enable its existence to become apparent.

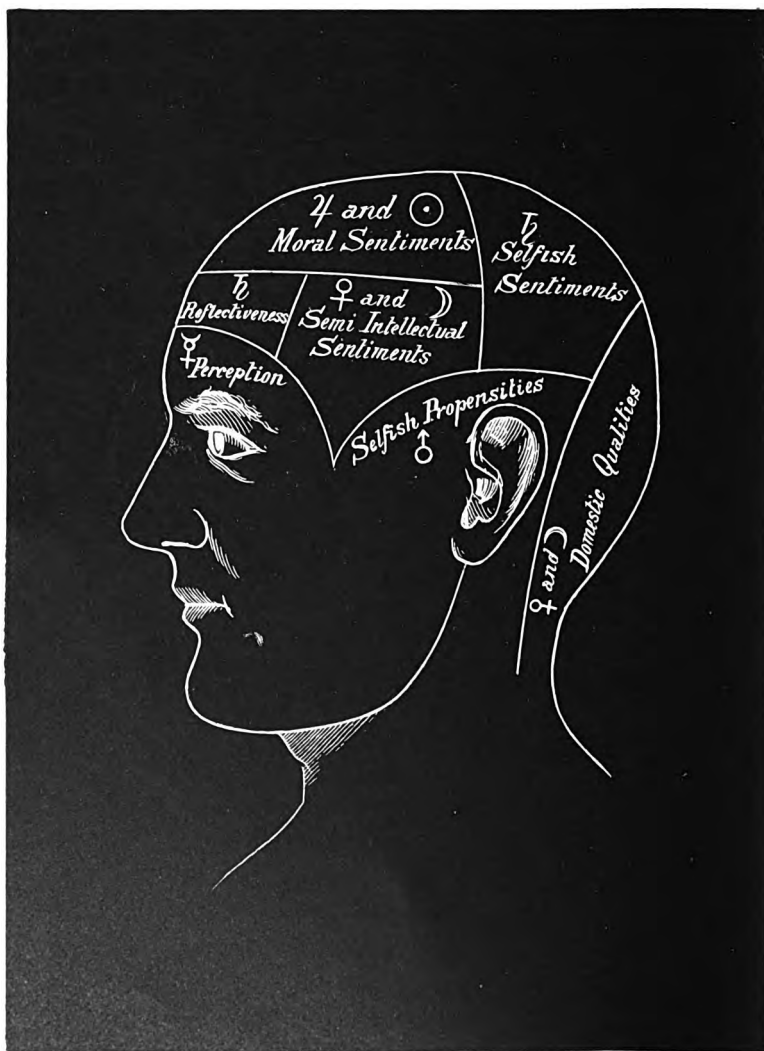
Such are the sublime facts of nature's immutable law, that have made the science of astrology true for all time and in all ages. When Uranus and Neptune were shining in their distant heavens undiscovered, mankind was, as a body, impervious to their action. Their organism did not.

vibrate in unison with their higher state of action. Thus we see as man evolves higher powers, more ethereal orbs appear in the celestial hierarchies of the starry heavens for the purpose of controlling and directing him.

The action and inter-action of the planetary influences operate in the following order: ♃, ♄, ♅, ☉, ☿ (earth) ♀, ♁. These are the seven primaries. Then comes Uranus, forming the eighth, or octave expression of the first, viz.: Mercury, and thus do we find, after long years of research and laborious investigation, that this planet rules the higher organs of the brain. Neptune, consequently, represents Venus upon a higher plane. The Earth, whose influence is shown by the Moon, comes next in rotation. When the tenth planet is discovered, its action upon our earth's inhabitants will be neutral in itself. Its harmonies and discords will depend upon its angular position in respect to the other bodies. Its chief influence will be in the control of our spiritual life forces. Its position, aspect, etc., with respect to the luminariés, will determine our capacity for inhaling the finer ethereal essences of the atmosphere. From this it will be perceived that the influence of the tenth planet will be wholly spiritual; hence it can only exert its influence upon the spiritual organisms of a more spiritual race.*

*This chapter contains a brief outline, so to speak, of the interior action of the planets. We shall deal with each orb more fully and in detail from their general standpoint in future lessons, and as a concluding suggestion we would ask the student to think and reason out very closely what we have herein stated by the light of the law of correspondence, the sum and substance of which was formulated for our use by the thrice illumined Hermes Trismegistus, who said:

"As it is above, so it is below,
As on the earth, so in the sky."



ASTRO-PHRENOLOGICAL CHART, SHOWING THE GENERAL PLANETARY INFLUENCE UPON THE HUMAN BRAIN.

CHAPTER III.

Having briefly explained, in the previous chapter, the origin, nature and power of planetary influence, so far as the planets themselves are concerned, it now becomes our duty to illustrate somewhat the principles laid down, and point out the laws or *modus operandi* by which these influences act and re-act upon the brain of man and, through the brain, control the whole organism. In order to do this we shall have to digress a little.

Phrenological research has now established beyond dispute certain broad general principles regarding cranial development. But the great mistake which the devotees of this branch of Anthropology make, is that they allow their enthusiasm to carry them beyond the safe line of demonstrated facts. They are constantly trying to prove that by the aid of phrenology they can ascertain the details of man's character; whereas the very utmost that can be expected as scientifically accurate, is a delineation of the general characteristics.

Phrenology merely points out those relations established by nature between given developments and conditions of the brain and corresponding manifestations of mind. Its simple but comprehensive tenet is this: "Every faculty of the mind is manifested by means of a particular portion of the brain, called its organ. the size of which, other things being equal, is proportionate to its power of function." It

is the latter portion of this definition that contains the whole mystery of the apparent contradictions with which the phrenologist has to deal. The "other things" are never, in any two cases, equal; hence the exact action of the brain organs cannot be scientifically demonstrated. As soon as phrenology attempts to define with exactness a person's true character or the powers of the cranial organs, from a simple knowledge of the size of these organs, it becomes a complete failure. The potency, or otherwise, of any organ or group of organs depends not nearly so much upon their relative size as upon their sensitiveness, or, in other words, upon the state of their etherealization; and this magnetic condition depends solely upon the position and power of that planet which has chief rule over those particular organs. Decisive proof of this assertion as regards the size of the organs may be obtained by each student for himself by carefully noting the heads of individuals. Even among our own personal acquaintances we shall find that it is not an absolute fact that those who possess the largest heads have the most brains, but often the very reverse. In fact, we shall find that the majority of men distinguished in science, politics and literature are those who possess comparatively small but well balanced heads, combined with a fine, highly sensitive organism, while the ordinary citizen or farmer, who is utterly incapable of forming any opinion worth listening to beyond the value of his whiskey, his hogs or his cattle, is possessed of a large head filled, not with intellectual brains, but with coarse animalized "brain stuff" which is utterly

incapable of manifesting its powers upon the higher mental planes of our nature.

The old and now much abused Chaldean sages were thoroughly acquainted with these facts, and in order to teach these principles to their youth they elaborated beautiful imagery in the form of fables and allegories. They gave the nature and power of each group of organs in the human brain to the character of that planet which they knew controlled its activities, and then worked out the facts so elaborated into a series of mythical histories of gods and divine personages who incarnated themselves for the benefit of man. Thus Mars took the character of Vulcan, the god of war; Venus and her innocent companion Cupid were assigned the character of Love and the sympathetic tendencies of the human heart, while the benevolent Jupiter assumed the position of Father, the kindly, generous parent, good alike to all his offspring, and so on with the others.

From this the student will perceive that when they taught their children that their gods had existed in human bodies they did not mean to convey the idea of Divine incarnation as we understand the doctrine, but that a portion of the divinity — a refracted ray — had become centered in man, and expressed itself in some special form; thus, a great warrior who brought honor and riches to his tribe or country, through his brilliant victories, was properly considered a son of Mars, because his nature expressed the Martial spirit in what was considered its highest and most potent form. A key to this beautiful Chaldean system

will be found in the Astro Phrenological chart on page 18. The seven principles therein shown are, of course, only general, and indicate those groups of organs over which the planets indicated are most powerful. To descend more into details:

The Planet Saturn ♄

governs the activities of the reflective, meditative and the purely selfish sentiments, such as comparison, causality, covetousness, acquisitiveness and secrecy.

The Planet Jupiter ♃

governs those activities which, in their expression, show to us the truly noble and generous side of human nature, such as benevolence, veneration, spirituality and hope.

The Planet Mars ♂

has chief rule of those activities which generally express themselves as selfishly aggressive. Properly they are the passions which reveal to us the animal which resides in an active or semi-passive state, within each human soul, upon the material plane of external life. They are known as alimentiveness, destructiveness, combativeness, and the sexual propensities. To these may be added vitativeness and construction.

The Sun ☉

Has the chief control of those organs whose activities express themselves in man's higher nature as the "Lord"

of material creation. They comprise the commanding and dignified elements within us, such as firmness, conscientiousness, pride, approbateness, and self-esteem.

The Planet Venus ♀

Governs those faculties whose activities express themselves as friendship, mirthfulness and conjugality. It also governs the organs of inhabitiveness and those which tend to form agreeable society.

The Planet Mercury ♂

In addition to being the general messenger of the gods, rules those faculties whose activities are purely intellectual and mechanical, such as eventuality, individuality, size, form, weight, color, order, calculation and language.

The Moon ☾

Governs those organs whose activities are termed the semi-intellectual qualities. They are very desirable expressions of character, viz., time, tune, ideality and sublimity. She has also some influence over the domestic qualities.

Each of the foregoing groups of organs is to a very great extent controlled by the planet under which it is mentioned, but not wholly so, because every body has an influence in a minor degree over each and all. But generally speaking, each group will manifest an intense or sluggish action in the brain, according as its controlling orb is powerful or otherwise in the individual's horoscope at birth, with this difference in its action; if the planet in

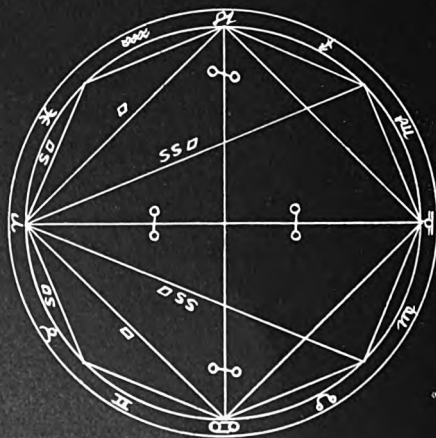
question be powerful but evilly aspected then those organs will express the vicious side of the person's nature. For example, the planet Mercury so situated the intellect will be bright, witty and powerful, but all the energies, under proper conditions, will be devoted to fraud, or at any rate, to very questionable purposes; everything depending upon the plane that the person occupies. As before stated, there is no difference between the criminal who breaks the legal code of laws, and the one who upon a higher plane obeys the written letter of the law, but tramples upon the true principles of human justice. The wealthy gambler upon the stock exchange, is no better in reality than the gambling card sharper. But if the planet is dignified and aspected by benefic rays, then the whole of the above will be reversed, and all that is noble, honorable and manly will be the result.

Having mentioned aspects, it now becomes our duty briefly to explain their nature. This we shall do in outline, at present, deferring all details until later in the course.

From what we have already stated, our student will perceive that sympathy and antipathy are the great laws by which the planets affect the human organism. These two forces, or rather let us say the dual action of this one force, constitutes the two modes of motion by which every cosmic principle expresses itself, and the two actions, that is, the action and the re-action, are true polar opposites, of which sufficient has already been stated. Upon the physical plane their effects are correlated as harmony and discord.

That nothing, apart from Deity, which has a manifested

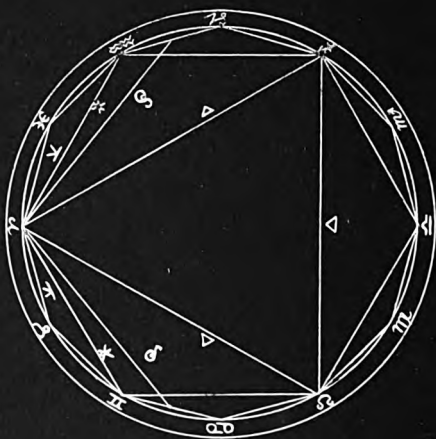
Fig. 1



The Angular Aspects of Malefic Rays

- SS a Semi Square or 45°
- O The Square or 90°
- SSO a Sesquiquadrature or 135°
- 8 The Opposition or 180°

Fig. II



The Angular Aspects of Benefic Rays

- v a Semi Sextile or 30°
- * The Sextile or 60°
- φ The Quintile or 72°
- Δ The Trine or 120°

existence can exist without form is a self evident fact, which scarcely requires proof. Therefore the powers of harmony and discord possess forms which are peculiar to themselves. These forms in Astrological science are angular, and are denominated aspects. The more perfect or complete the angle is, the greater the power its influence exerts upon matter. The symbol of discord is a square, and every inharmonious, angular ray constitutes a portion of the square or the angle of 90° . The symbol of harmony is a triangle, and every benefic angular ray constitutes a portion of the trine or angle of 120° ,—thus we have a geometric expression of good and evil.



The student will observe that the discordant rays of magnetic force strike each other crossways from opposing angles, thus $+$. This conflict produces a violent commotion. There is a fight, as it were, in the current between two powers, while the contrary result is produced in the action of the benefic rays of magnetic force. They impinge upon each other thus, $\wedge$ like the two forks of a river, and then with their united force flow onward harmoniously. The whole of these angular aspects are illustrated in the diagrams I and II, which accompany this lesson. Explanation

is unnecessary, except that each aspect can be formed from any point of the celestial zodiac, both direct and converse.

We see, therefore, that when the combinations of stellar force flow in straight lines and cut through each other from cross angles, the resultant upon the physical plane is that state which we term discordant and evil. But when the rays of force flow in straight but convergent angles from or towards each other, then the opposite effects are naturally produced, and harmony, love and prosperity reign.

The student cannot pay too much attention to these Occult facts of nature's law, because they are true upon every plane of manifested existence.

CHAPTER IV.

The next great subject which requires the student's thoughtful attention is the four Triplicities.* These trigons correspond to the four ancient elements, and are therefore Fiery, Earthy, Airy and Watery. Each triplicity or "trigon" contains three zodiacal signs, $4 \times 3 = 12$, the number of the signs of the sphere. The Fiery trigon embraces the signs Aries (φ), Leo (Ω), and Sagittarius ($\downarrow$). The Earthy trigon embraces the signs Taurus ($\mathbin{\text{♉}}$), Virgo ($\mathbin{\text{♍}}$), and Capricorn ($\mathbin{\text{♑}}$). The Airy trigon embraces the signs Gemini ($\mathbin{\text{♊}}$), Libra ($\mathbin{\text{♎}}$), and Aquarius ($\mathbin{\text{♒}}$). The Watery trigon embraces the signs Cancer ($\mathbin{\text{♋}}$), Scorpio ($\mathbin{\text{♏}}$), and Pisces ($\mathbin{\text{♓}}$).

In practical astrology these triplicities are of very great

*See Article "Triplicity," page 399, Wilson's Dict. of Astrology.

importance, as they shed their potent influence upon the ascendant at the birth of every living being or thing, and impress their peculiar nature upon the temperament of the native. The philosophical principles concealed beneath these so-called ancient elements, are worthy of a far more detailed elucidation than the space of this chapter will admit.

Probably one of the greatest mistakes made by the modern uninitiated astrologer in regard to the actual influence of these triplicities, is that they omit to take into consideration the ascent and descent of the spiritual etherealization of material forces.

Magnetic and electric forces vary in their spirituality like everything else in the universe. That which is superior, by virtue of its higher or more interior emanation, will demonstrate its superiority upon every plane of its manifestation. For example: Aries (φ) is the first and highest representative of the fiery trigon, and those born with this sign rising upon the ascendant of their horoscope will always move upon a higher plane, mentally and spiritually, than those born under Leo or Sagittarius. But, externally, those people born under Aries will show their superiority from a purely intellectual point of view. Their nature will be chiefly fiery and mental, consequently quick in action, and prompt in decision.

Leo (Ω), the next to Aries, is the second representative of the fiery trigon, and persons born with this sign rising will always move upon the sensitive and emotional planes. Their nature will be chiefly fiery and sensitive, conse-

quently hasty and impulsive. They will act without thinking, upon the spur of the moment, when under the dominating influence of their susceptible, emotional natures. In this we see the difference between Aries, which rules the head, and Leo, which represents the heart. Leo persons, when roused to a pitch of passional fury, are absolutely insane in their wild and erratic actions. Like the lion, they are completely blinded by an intense degree of excitement. On the contrary, an Aries person, though susceptible of an equal degree of furious temper, never becomes blind with excitement. Even in his most outrageous conduct, an impartial observer will not fail to see that "there is method in his madness."

Sagittarius is the last and lowest, that is to say, the most external emanation of the fiery triplicity, and illustrates the law of contradictions to perfection. For this reason, those born under this sign live and move, when mentally and spiritually considered, upon the lowest plane of the fiery emanation. Whereas externally and in the eyes of the world they seem to move in the very highest. Their natures are warm, sympathetic and active, consequently they are generous and benevolent, ambitious and truly jovial. They do as the world does; they progress not of their own internal volition, but by the gentle attraction of the social tide of their surroundings. In everything they are external. They are great admirers of all out-door sports, recreations and pastimes, and as such they are totally incapable of grasping any form of the higher mental and metaphysical studies. They are, therefore, considered

by the masses and the world sound reasoners, logical, and possessed of sound common sense, and externally they do indeed possess all these desirable qualities.

When viewed from their line of descent the student will perceive that in Aries we have the fiery imperial brain, which moulds, guides and acts for itself, independent of the opinions of others. Such extreme natures, when unmodified by other influences, are either despots, cranks or fanatics, according to their peculiar bent and station in life. In Leo we see the emotions and sensitive feelings of the heart, which follow impulsively the lead of some mental genius, and form the enthusiastic followers and admirers of those who depart from the beaten path of custom or proclaim some new truth or system of philosophy which finds a responsive throb within them. But they require the thinking brain to direct them; they cannot strike out upon a new path for themselves; they must have some giant mind to support them. In Sagittarius we see the genial, sympathetic, courteous neutrality which represents the externally true gentleman. Those who are simply waiting to be led in any direction that the strongest mental force desires to carry them. They love the world and its varied delights, and are consequently contented and willing to let others do the thinking for them.

The whole of these remarks are to be considered in a general sense only, and in speaking of any given sign it is, of course, presupposed that the position and aspect of the sun, moon and planets do not contradict the general tendencies of the sign upon the ascendant. Further, what we

have thus far stated in reference to the fiery trigon will also apply to the other triplicities. It is, therefore, quite unnecessary to go over the same ground with each trigon, as the above illustration will suffice to explain the varying powers of each sign, according to the peculiar plane of its manifestation, as Earthy, Airy and Watery. The student has only to bear in mind, when forming his opinion, that his premises and his conclusion must occupy the same plane. Thus the fiery trigon manifests itself in the combative, aggressive, imperious, commanding and courageous planes of action. The earthy trigon manifests itself in the patient, laborious, plodding, obedient and inert planes of action. The airy trigon manifests itself in the aspiring, philosophical, musical, artistic and volatile planes of action. The watery trigon manifests itself in the dreamy, romantic, changeable, timid and submissive planes of action.

As before stated, the student must understand that these remarks are general and not particular in their application; for instance, we do not mean to assert that because a person is born under a watery sign rising upon the ascendant that that person will be dreamy and romantic, or impractical and submissive. This will depend entirely upon the actual position of the planets and their aspects to the sun and moon at the time of birth. But what we do mean to assert is this, that the person then born will possess deep down and latent the qualities of the watery trigon, and that under proper conditions and circumstances it will rise dominantly to the surface and thus manifest the true internal characteristics of the person's nature, while the same conditions and cir-

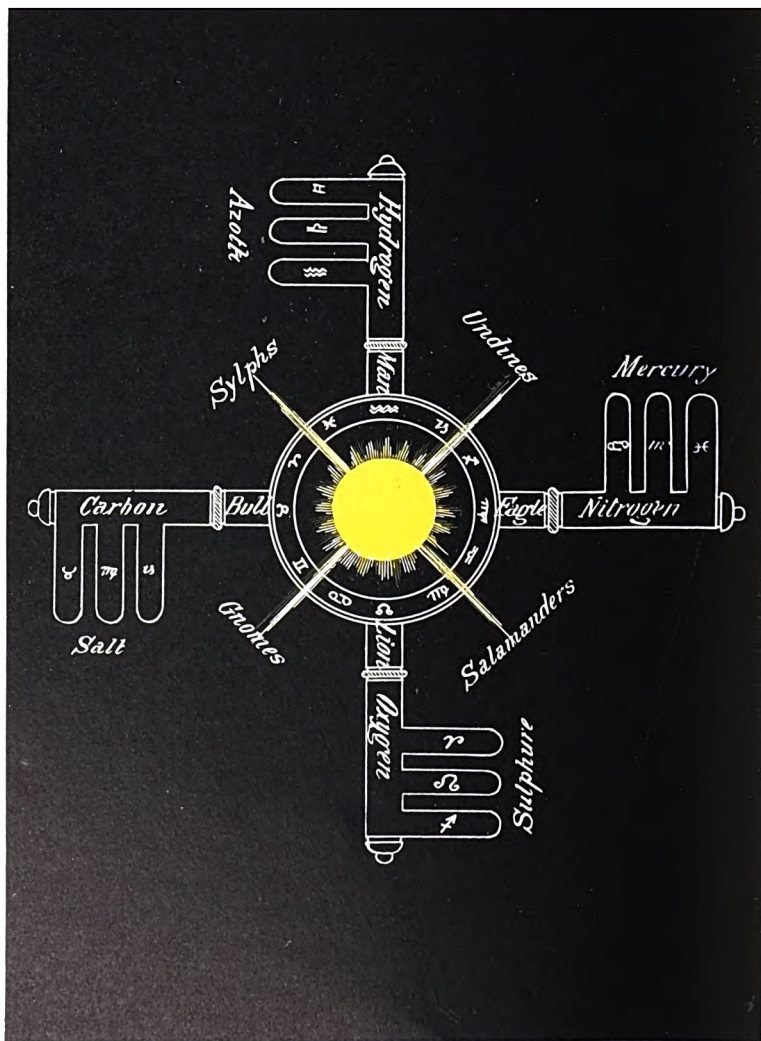
cumstances brought to bear upon one born under the fiery trigon would operate in exactly the reverse direction. Thus we see how and why two different individuals, under the same identical conditions, will differ diametrically in their course of action. Every day adds fresh proof of this.

We must now turn our attention to the purely esoteric aspect of the four triplicities, and view them from their Hermetic and Occult standpoint. The four ancient elements have been symbolized from time immemorial, as The Man, The Bull, The Eagle, and The Lion. Astrologically these are Aquarius (♒) "the water bearer," symbolical of the Man; Taurus, the sign of the Bull; Leo, represented by the lion; and lastly Scorpio, anciently symbolized by the Eagle. In this change of symbols the thoughtful student will find much that is well worthy of his careful consideration, for "hereby hangs a tale." In the esoteric planisphere of the twelve signs Adam Kadmon, the primordial man, pure, and in perfect accord with the Father, occupied that point of the planisphere now designated by the sign Libra, which signifies the point of equilibrium in the sphere. This esoteric point is where day and night, winter and summer, light and darkness, good and evil are one. Adam Kadmon represents the ideal man, and the very fact that we can form an ideal conception is the absolute proof that we possess the possibilities of attaining unto the ideal and realizing our conception, not perhaps upon this plane, but certainly when we are translated to the higher. The modern English name for this point of the sphere, "The Balance," which means justice, is a fitting one. Justice is

that which discriminates upon the external plane between good and evil, and metes out rewards and punishments. Life, Light and Truth are the same, and consist of spiritual reflection. They are spiritual rays,* and when these rays become refracted by passing through the prism of matter, truth becomes illusion, life becomes limited by assuming the appearance of death. The spiritually beautiful and eternally true have no existence in the world where all is change, strife, discord and death, therefore we see that the divine spiritual ray of good, when it becomes refracted, presents all the forms and colors of evil, the former only is real and eternal, the latter but an appearance assumed by the fleeting transformations of matter.

This celestial point in Libra is represented by Enoch in the mysteries of the Jewish Temple, the man who walked with God "and was not." This theological idea was plagiarized by the early fathers of the Christian Church when they elaborated their Christian mysteries. They make Libra symbolical of their day of judgment, when celestial "justice" will be meted out to all "both the quick and the dead." This is the point of the planisphere occupied by their divine man. The Cabalistical Adam Kadmon, the Enoch of Judaism, becomes the Emmanuel of the new dispensation. Jesus is the sacrifice required by the divine justice of God's anger (?) for the awful errors of a sinful world of his own creation and management. And Judas,

*The reader should obtain "First Lessons in Reality," and study well the principles therein laid down. It is a valuable work, by S. S. Grimke, and published at \$1.00.



THE GRAND ASTROLOGICAL KEY OF ALCHEMICAL SCIENCE.

who as a disciple of the son of God was able to soar heavenward upon the wings of an Eagle (the inward aspirations) falls into temptation, betrays his master into the hands of his murderers. Thence comes the fall, the divine Eagle of the celestial heavens becomes the lowly reptile, the treacherous, poisonous scorpion whose sting is concealed in the most unsuspected part of the body, viz.: the tail.

The above remarks will be found useful to the student as guide posts in his study of the Esoteric translation of signs into principles. We will only add that the fall, from the Eagle of the heavens to the scorpion of the desert, has a still more interior application which applies to the theological fall of man, and scientifically explains the Biblical allegory of Adam and Eve. When the mystic key of the starry heavens is turned with a wise hand, the garden of Eden is no longer an impossible place, tolerated only as a myth, but it is a divine reality, and the four rivers which, we are told, branch from one head which rises in the midst of the garden, can all be located and their virtues known.

CHAPTER V.

By nature the Zodiac is divided into equal arcs of Light and Darkness, Winter and Summer, which in the technical terms of the science are termed the northern and the southern signs. When the earth, in her annual orbit round the sun, enters the sign Libra, about the 21st of March, the sun appears to enter the first degree of Aries,

which is called the vernal equinox, and following the opposition point of our earth's journey through space, our sun apparently moves forward through the signs until (about the 21st of June) the first point of the tropical sign Cancer is reached, and the greatest noon-day altitude is attained in the northern hemisphere, and the lowest in the southern. On or about the 21st of September, the sun appears to enter the first degree of Libra, which completes the solar passage through the six northern signs, and the arc of light is over. The following six signs, Libra, Scorpio, Sagittarius, Capricorn, Aquarius and Pisces constitute the southern arc, termed the arc of darkness. Our chief reason for drawing the student's attention to this peculiar division of the zodiac is, that it is this division that forms the ground work upon which is based every theological system the world has ever seen. Further, it is the division still observed in all standard works upon Astrological science. But so far as the real and practical application of the science is concerned, such a division is perfectly unmeaning, and students are advised to pay no attention thereto. The only division the zodiac receives in Chaldean astrology* is that which takes into consideration the increase and decrease of the great cosmic life center of all animated nature, viz., the sun. The zodiac is, therefore, divided into two parts, viz., from Capricorn to Cancer. When the sun crosses the line of the winter solstice, about the 21st of December, the life forces of the northern hemisphere are at the lowest ebb. It is at this point that God gives the nations the promise of

*Except the four triplicities.

future deliverance. All the crucified saviours the world over were born about the 25th of December. In those temperate latitudes where snow and ice are unknown winter is the rainy season, and the people have their bow of promise in the heavens that God will not entirely destroy the world with water.

From the time of the winter solstice the days increase in length, the sluggish life forces of matter begin to expand, and all things increase in vitality until the 21st of June, when Sol enters the sign Cancer. This is the highest point of declination north of the equator. It is also the highest point of intensity (in our hemisphere) of the cosmic life forces. For a time these forces remain stationary, then reaction slowly sets in, the trees begin to change their tints, fruits begin to ripen, and the days grow shorter as the Life Wave recedes.

If a complete census of the whole population of the northern hemisphere could be taken, and the actual duration of life of the people ascertained, we should find a startling contrast between those born from December to June, and those born between July and the end of November. We should find that the longest lived were born in March, April and May, that is to say, a very great majority would be found to have their natal day in these months. While on the contrary, a majority of the short lived population would be found to be born during the months of August, September and October. This is only true on general principles, and does not apply to any one individual horoscope: in fact the remarks in reference to the four triplicities will

also apply here. The increase and decrease of the solar light simply governs the vitalizing capacity of the race, and not the individual. Remember this.

Before concluding this general outline of the psychological principles upon which the true astro-masonic science is founded, we must draw the reader's attention to its alchemical aspect, and point out the relation astrology bears to this mystical science of the ancient chemists.

Alchemy is generally supposed to mean the act of transforming the base metal into gold, and as such it has found more devotees for the prospective wealth which it appeared to offer, than for the spiritual truth it might contain. But like everything else connected with the Occult, "none can obtain the good unless he merits it," and those who obtain the control of any force by evil means must pay a fearful price for it in this world, and a terrible penalty in the next. Therefore those who do not study the sacred art for its own sake, will find nothing but disappointment.

The seven planets represent the seven metals of the ancients. Thus, Saturn is symbolized by lead; Jupiter by tin; Mars rules over iron; Sol, gold; Venus, copper; Mercury is represented by mercury, and the Moon is symbolized by silver. In this alchemical arrangement we must note the position assigned to the solar orb. It is at least significant.

Saturn, lead.
Jupiter, tin.
Mars, iron.

The Sun,
Gold.

copper, Venus.
mercury, Mercury.
silver, Moon.

The precious metal then contains the potencies or prin-

ciples of the other six, consequently each one of the metals above enumerated contains some essential principle that the alchemist requires in the transmuting process; for gold cannot be produced unless the elements of which it is composed are present. Not only must they be present, but they must be mixed in their exact proportion, and then subjected to the purifying resolvent influence of the universal solvent of nature, "the water of Pythia." This water, we need scarcely add, is the astral light; hence it is that each must make the philosopher's stone for himself; it cannot be purchased for dollars and cents, nor monopolized by syndicates, corporations or improvement (?) companies. Some individuals are, from their peculiar organization and temperament, endowed with the power of generating and using the magical forces of the astral light with little or no exertion upon their part, and could, if they only possessed the knowledge, produce phenomenal effects with more ease in three months training, than others less magically constituted could in a life time. In fact, there is the same predisposition required to make the successful Occultist as there is in any of the arts and sciences. There is much error in circulation upon this point that requires sweeping away with the brush of truth, especially in regard to Alchemy, which many view in the light of mere chemical formula for gold making. To illustrate this, let us take the art known as music: one person is born who possesses a natural genius for harmony, not only so, but he also possesses the fine, sensitive touch and mechanical skill to produce harmony; this latter is equally as important as the

former. Another is born possessing a natural love for music, but that is all. Now, as long as he lives he will have a great love for music, and be delighted to listen to it, but will never be able to produce the music himself, because he is totally incapable of mastering the details and mechanical fingering that is so requisite in the skillful musician. Probably the reader is or has been acquainted with many such individuals. It is the same with Occultism. The former represents the natural born magician, the latter the average lover and student of occult science. The former can obtain his knowledge direct from the great store-house of nature, the latter only from a long study of the writings of others. But there is also a third class to be considered in viewing the ranks of the occult, viz., those who occupy a midway plane between the two above quoted. It is for this middle class alone that this work was prepared.

The celebrated alchemist, Paracelsus, speaking of the astrological aspect of his science, says in *Paragranum I.*: "If I have manna in my constitution I can attract manna from heaven. Melissa is not only in the garden, but also in the air and in heaven. Saturn is not only in the sky, but also deep in the ocean and earth. What is Venus but the Artemisia that grows in your garden, and what is iron but the planet Mars; that is to say, Venus and Artemisia are both products of the same essence, while Mars and iron are manifestations of the same cause. What is the human body but a constellation* of the same powers that formed the stars in the sky? He who knows Mars knows the qual-

* Paracelsus means a circle of constellations, *i. e.* a microcosm.

ities of iron, and he who knows what iron is knows the attributes of Mars. What would become of your heart if there were no sun in the universe? What would be the use of your "*vasa spermatica*" * if there were no Venus? To grasp the invisible elements, to attract them by their material correspondences, to control, purify and transmute them by the ever moving powers of the living spirit, this is true alchemy."

The student will not fail to understand the true nature of alchemical science when he compares the above extract from Paracelsus with the previous teaching given in this and other chapters. The man who is dominated by the Martial element and knows it, and then devotes his commercial energies to the realms of Mars, by trading and speculating solely in iron and its products; the Saturnine individual controlled by the earthly trigon, who consciously invests his money, time and abilities in coal mining and trading in lime, clay, bricks and stone — these men, I say, are a long way ahead of those who devote their time and their money to studying and experimenting with the musty old formulas of "Sandivogius," so far as the true alchemy of nature is concerned, because they have obeyed the commands of true science upon the physical plane. They are using the spiritual and magnetic affinities implanted by mother nature within them, to successfully attract to them their natural correspondences on earth, and then, by the aid of commerce, transforming such base products into the shining yellow gold. Salt, sulphur, mercury and azoth exist in the

* The astral germs of subjective life forms : it is the latent "to be."

human body as well as in the bowels of the earth (the one implies the other), and so does the coveted elixir which resolves all things into their original elements and confers perpetual youth. "He that hath ears to hear, let him hear."

The symbolical diagram upon page 203 expresses, hieroglyphically, all that the science of alchemy can teach. The twelve signs of the zodiac are divided into their various triplicities, and it will be noticed that each trigon has three planes of manifestation shown by the three wards of the stellar key. These elements are again shown, represented by their chemical equivalents, Carbon, Nitrogen, Oxygen and Hydrogen; and, lastly, the various quadrants represent the realms of elemental life which live and move and have their being within the four great astral triplicities of the old Chaldean Astrology.

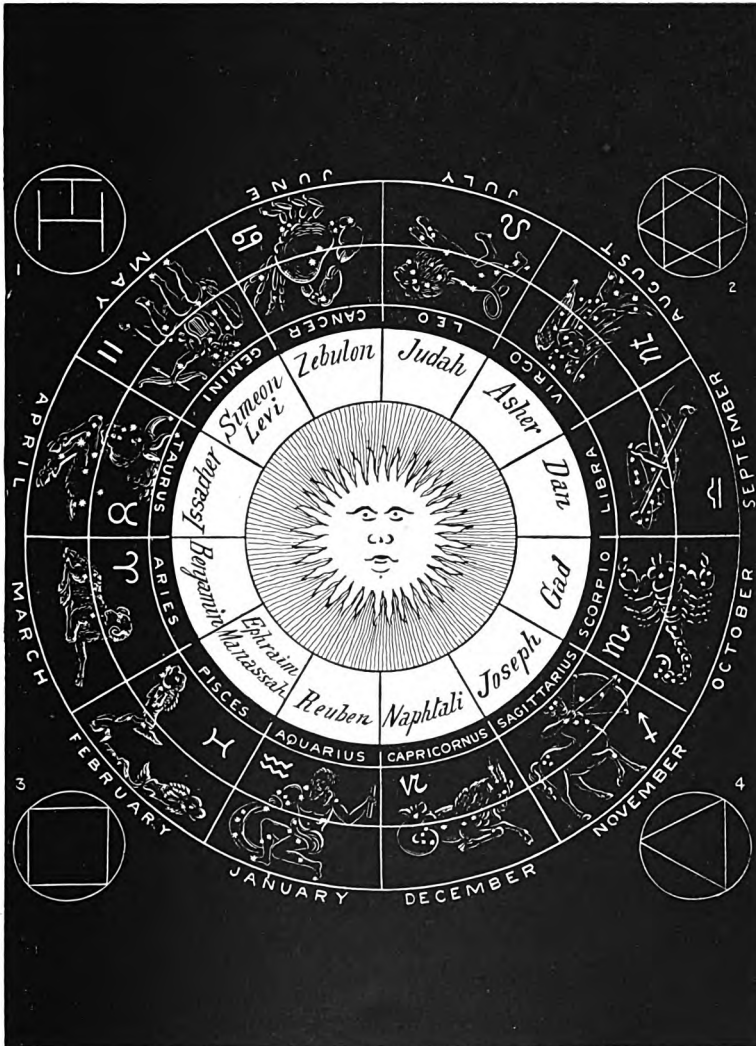
CHAPTER VI.

THE NATURE AND INFLUENCE OF THE TWELVE SIGNS.

The poet Manilius, so celebrated in the days of Augustus Cæsar, in setting forth the astrology of the Romans gives the following beautiful description of the twelve signs and constellations:

"Now constellations, Muse! and signs rehearse;
In order let them sparkle in thy verse;
First Aries, glorious in his golden wool,
Looks back, and wonders at the mighty Bull,
Whose hind parts first appear, he bending lies,

MAN'S ASTRAL ORGANISM.



ASTRO-KABBALISTICAL PLANISPHERE OF THE SIGNS AND
CONSTELLATIONS OF THE ZODIAC.

With threatening head, and calls the Twins to rise;
 They clasp for fear, and mutually embrace,
 And next the Twins with an unsteady pace
 Bright Cancer rolls; then Leo shakes his mane
 And following Virgo calms his rage again.
 Then day and night are weighed in Libra's scales,
 Equal awhile, at last the night prevails;
 And longer grown the heavier scale inclines,
 And draws bright Scorpio from the winter signs.
 Him Centaur* follows with an aiming eye,
 His bow full drawn and ready to let fly;
 Next narrow horns, the twisted Capert† shows,
 And from Aquarius' urn a flood o'er flows.
 Near their lov'd waves cold Pisces takes their seat,
 With Aries join, and make the round complete."

Everything in nature, though constituting a trinity in itself, possesses a fourfold application when viewed from the external plane. At least we find this fourfoldness a truth so far as "the things of Earth" are concerned and, therefore, by the laws of correspondences, the same application must hold good in regard to the celestial objects in the heavens. The Hermetic rule is very precise upon this point, viz.: "As on the earth, so in the sky." Therefore, we will describe the fourfold aspect of the stars as fully as the limits of the present work will allow. Before attempting this, however, it is perhaps necessary to remind the general reader that it is well known to students of Occult literature that behind the external personalities of the twelve sons of Jacob were concealed the various powers of the twelve constellations of the Zodiac. Until quite recently

* "Centaur," the constellation of Jupiter, *i. e.*, Sagittarius.

† "Narrow-horns, the twisted Caper," refers to Capricorn, the goat.

their correct tabulation has been carefully concealed. In fact, the Kabbalistical and esoteric aspect of this science — what Paracelsus calls the “spiritual astrology” * — has never yet been committed to writing, except under the dense veil of extremely vague allegorical symbols, because this knowledge formed a portion of “the greater mysteries,” and as such was necessarily confined to the exceptionally favored few. It must in justice be added that these favored few thoroughly merited all the knowledge they obtained. Time, however, which regulates all things, very harmoniously arranges the supply of spiritual truth in exact proportion to the real demand. So that a real, earnest demand having arisen for light upon the spiritual side of nature, we begin to see the bright rays of truth springing up upon the mental horizon of the western race. The recipients of Occult knowledge who have been so long waiting in various quarters for the times to become ripe, are now distributing their hoarded treasures, with delighted hands, to the daily increasing number of seekers after truth.

For the sake of convenience we shall divide the study of the planets and constellations of the Zodiac into four separate parts, to be designated as “Symbolical,” “Kabbalistical,” “Intellectual” and “Physical.” These four planes are entirely separate from each other, and must not be confounded in the student’s mind. The Symbolical

* Probably the nearest approach to this spiritual astrology of Paracelsus that has yet been issued from the press is the remarkable work by H. Melville, entitled “Veritas. A Revelation of the Mysteries.” Every interested student of the science of the stars should obtain and study this work. It is published in London, England.

aspect applies to their purely mystical significance, and the various forms and aspects which they assumed in the ingenious imaginations of our early ancestors who, after viewing the forms and forces of nature as manifested upon earth, were ever seeking to find their spiritual correspondence "in the sky."

The Kabbalistical aspect applies to their more recondite nature, and to the various occult forces in nature to which they gave a celestial expression. In this important aspect lies concealed, also, the grand mysteries of the Jewish Temple, the arcane science of the wise King Solomon, and last but not least the Theosophy of later Judaism, the external form of which is now known as Christianity.

The Intellectual aspect applies solely to the mental plane of humanity, and has reference to the intellectual calibre of the mind. There is often a radical difference between the physical and intellectual natures of the same organism, therefore the student must be careful not to confound these two aspects of the Man.

The Physical aspect applies only to the gross external plane, the passional and material side of humanity. It shows us the intellectual human animal, as it were, and therefore is only applicable to those who are living wholly upon that particular plane.

Aries (♈) the Ram.

The sign Aries, in its Symbolical aspect, represents the sacrifice. The flocks and herds bring forth their young during the portion of the year that the sun occupies this

sign. In addition to the sacrifice, the Ram also symbolizes the spring and the commencement of a New Year when life, light and love are to be bestowed upon the sons of earth in consequence of the sun having once more gained the victory over the realms of winter and death. The symbol of the slain Lamb upon the equinoctial cross, is another type of Aries.

Kabbalistically, the sign Aries represents the head and brains of the grand man of the cosmos. It is the acting, thinking principle in nature called sometimes instinct, and again intelligence. Upon the esoteric planisphere, this sign is occupied by Benjamin, of whom Jacob, in his blessing to the twelve sons, says "Benjamin shall rave as a wolf, in the morning he shall devour the prey, and at night divide the spoils." Above all other animals the wolf is sacred to the planet Mars, and the sign Aries is under the special and peculiar control of this fiery planet. Mars is the most fiery of all the planets, and Aries is the first constellation of the fiery triplicity. The correspondence is significant. The Hebrews concealed this reference to the planetary nature of Mars by combining the wolf and the ram. "The wolf in sheep's clothing" reveals to us the evil action of Mars when malefically posited in his own sign, the Ram. The Kabbalistical gem of this sign is the amethyst, and those born with Aries rising upon the ascendant of their horoscope, possess in this stone a powerful magnetic talisman. Aries is the first and highest emanation of the fiery triplicity, and is in the constellation of the planet Mars.

Upon the Intellectual Plane, Aries signifies the martial spirit of destructiveness and aggression. It rules the head: "Out of his mouth went a two edged sword." It is the active will under the guidance of the executive forces of the brain, and those dominated by this influx are imperious, dauntless and energetic in the first degree. They will never really submit to the control of others.

Upon the Physical Plane, Aries produces a spare but strong body, of medium height, long face, and bushy eye brows, rather long neck, powerful chest, complexion rather swarthy; disposition courageous, ambitious, intrepid and despotic; the temper is fiery and passionate. Generally speaking, this sign gives a very quarrelsome, irritable, pugnacious person. His diseases are those of the head, small pox, measles and fevers. Of plants, this sign governs broom, holly, thistle, dock, fern, garlic, hemp, mustard, nettles, onions, poppies, radish, rhubarb and peppers. Of stones, Aries rules firestone, brimstone, ochre and all common red stones.

Taurus (♉) the Bull.

The sign Taurus, in its Symbolical aspect, represents the powers of fecundity, and also the procreative forces in all departments of nature. Its genius was symbolized as Aphrodite, who was generally represented as wearing the two horns upon her head in imitation of the Bull. Many mythologists have been deceived by this symbol, and have taken it to represent a figure of the crescent moon upon the head of Isis, whereas it was the planet Venus which the

ancients intended to symbolize, because she rules the constellation of the Bull by her sympathetic forces. Apis, the sacred Bull of the Egyptians, is another conception of Taurus. And as the sun passed through this sign during their plowing month, we also find this sign used as the symbol of husbandry.

Kabbalistically, the sign Taurus represents the ears, neck and throat of the grand old man of the skies, hence this sign is the silent, patient, listening principle of humanity, and also the governor of the lymphatic system of the organism. Taurus, on the esoteric planisphere, is occupied by Issachar, which means hireling or servant. The patriarch, in his paternal blessing to Issachar, refers to the obedient, laborious nature of this sign, as follows: "Issachar is a strong ass, couching down between two burdens." This is pre-eminently the earthly Taurine nature, as the ass and the ox are equally remarkable for their endurance as beasts of burden. The Kabbalistical gem of this sign is the agate, and therefore this stone constitutes a natural talisman for those born with Taurus on their ascendant. Taurus is the highest emanation of the earthy trigon, and is the constellation of the planet Venus.

Upon the Intellectual Plane, Taurus signifies the quickening, germinating powers of silent thought and represents that which is pleasant and good, consequently those dominated by this influx are able to choose and assimilate that which is good. They are slow to form opinions, are careful, plodding and self-reliant and patiently await the

realization of results. The chief mental characteristics are industry and application.

Upon the Physical Plane, Taurus gives a middle stature with strong, well-knit body, and short, thick, bull-like neck, broad forehead and dark hair, a dull complexion and rather large mouth. In disposition the negatives of the earthy trigon are sullen and reserved. They make firm friends, and unrelenting foes. Slow to anger, they are, like the bull, violent and furious when aroused. Of plants, this sign rules beets, plantain, colts-foot, columbine, daisies, dandelion, gourds, myrtle, flax, larkspur, lilies, moss and spinach. Of stones, Taurus governs white coral, alabaster and all common white stones that are opaque.

Gemini (II) the Twins.

The sign Gemini, in its Symbolical aspect, symbolizes unity, and the strength of united action, also the truths of matehood. The two bright stars, Castor and Pollux, represent the twin souls. The Greek myth of Castor and Pollux, avenging the rape of Helen, is only a repetition of the biblical story of Simeon and Levi slaughtering the men of Shechem for the outrage committed upon their sister Dinah by the son of Hamor.

Kabbalistically, the sign Gemini represents the hands and arms of the grand man of the universe, and therefore expresses the projecting and executive forces of humanity in all mechanical departments. Upon the esoteric planisphere, the sign is occupied by Simeon and Levi. "They are brethren," says Jacob, "and instruments of cruelty are

in their habitations,"—which refers in a very unmistakable manner to the fearfully potent powers of projection that lie concealed within the magnetic constitution of all those who are dominated by this sign. The mystical symbol of the twins conceals the doctrine of soul-mates and other important truths connected therewith. The mystical gem of this sign is the beryl, which means crystal, and consequently forms the talismanic stone for those born under the influence of this potential sign. Gemini is the first and highest emanation of the airy trigon, and is the constellation of the planet Mercury.

Upon the Intellectual Plane, Gemini signifies the union of reason with intuition, and those dominated by its influx express the highest mental state of embodied humanity. They are volatile free, philosophical and generous. Their magnetic spheres are specially susceptible to the influence of inspirational currents. By nature they are restless and exceedingly energetic. They possess an excess of mental force which impels them headlong into the most gigantic enterprises. Their chief characteristics are intuitional and mental activity, consequently they are nervous and restless.

Upon the Physical Plane, Gemini gives a tall, straight body, a sanguine complexion, dark hair, hazel or grey eyes, sharp sight and a quick, active walk. They possess a restless but gentlemanly appearance. In disposition the natives of the airy trigon are volatile and fickle. They are scientific and possess a great passion for all kinds of knowledge; are inconstant, and rarely study one subject very long; are speculative, and possess large imaginations. Of plants, this

sign rules privet, dog-grass, meadow-sweet, madder, woodbine, tansy, vervain and yarrow. Of stones, Gemini governs the garnet and all striped stones.

Cancer (♋) The Crab.

The sign Cancer symbolizes tenacity to life. The crab, in order to move forward, is compelled to walk backwards, which illustrates the sun's apparent motion when in this sign, where it commences to move backwards toward the equator again. It also represents the fruitful, sustaining essence of the life forces, hence we see the symbol of the crab occupying a prominent position upon the breast of the statue of ISIS, the universal mother and sustainer of all.

Kabbalistically, the sign Cancér signifies the vital organs of the grand man of the starry heavens, and therefore represents the breathing and digestive functions of the human family, and also indicates the magnetic control of this constellation over the spiritual, ethereal and vital essences and the capacity of those specially dominated by this nature to receive and assimilate the inspirational currents. Hence Cancer governs the powers of inspiration and respiration of the grand man. The sign Cancer upon the esoteric planisphere, is occupied by Zebulon, of whom his patriarchal father declares, "Zebulon shall dwell at the haven of the sea, and he shall be for an haven of ships," astrologically intimating the home of the crab, which is upon the sea shore. It also expresses the varied powers of cohesion, and the paradoxical truths found in all contradictions. The mystical gem of the sign is the emerald.

The stone constitutes a powerful talisman for all natives of Cancer, which is the highest emanation of the watery trigon, and is the constellation of the Moon.

Upon the Intellectual Plane, Cancer signifies the equilibrium of spiritual and material life forces. Those dominated by its influx express the highest form of the reflective powers; they are timid and retiring; are truly passive, and constitute natural mediums. Cancer possesses but little of the intuitional qualities. That which appears to be intuition is direct inspiration. To the external eye, the natives of the watery trigon appear to be slothful, whereas they are incessant workers upon the higher, or mental plane. This sign expresses to us the conservation of forces. Its chief attributes are sensitiveness and reflection.

Upon the Physical Plane, Cancer gives a medium stature, the upper part larger than the lower, a small, round face, pale or delicate complexion, brown hair and small, pensive grey eyes; disposition effeminate, timid and thoughtful; temper mild; conversation agreeable and pleasant. Of plants, this sign rules cucumbers, squashes, melons and all water vegetation such as rushes, water lilies, etc. Of stones, Cancer governs chalk, selenite, and all soft, white stones.

Leo (♌) The Lion.

The sign Leo symbolizes strength, courage and fire. The hottest portion of the year, in the northern hemisphere, is when the sun is passing through this sign. It is the

solar Lion of the mysteries that ripens, with his own internal heat, the fruits brought forth from the earth by the moisture of Isis.

Kabbalistically, the sign Leo signifies the heart of the grand man, and represents the life center of the fluidic circulatory system of humanity. It is also the fire vortex of physical life. Hence those born under this influx are noted for the superior strength of their physical constitution, and also for their wonderful recuperative powers after being exhausted by sickness. The sign Leo upon the esoteric planisphere, is occupied by Judah, of whom his dying parent says, "Judah is a lion's whelp, from the prey my son thou art gone up. He stooped down, he couched as a lion." This sign reveals to us the mysteries of the ancient sacrifice, and the laws of compensation. The mystical gem of Leo is the ruby, and it forms a most potent disease-resisting talisman for all governed by the Leonine influx. Leo is the second emanation of the fiery triplicity, and is the constellation of the sun.

Upon the Intellectual Plane, Leo signifies the sympathies of the heart. Those dominated by its influx are generous even to excess with their friends. By nature they are deeply sympathetic, and possess that peculiar grade of magnetic force which enables them to arouse into action the latent sympathies in others. As orators their earnest, impulsive, pathetic style makes them an irresistible success. An exceedingly fine specimen of Leonine oratory is given in Genesis, 44th ch. This simple, eloquent appeal of Judah to Joseph probably stands unequalled, for its sublime

tenderness. The natives of Leo are impulsive and passionate, honest and faithful. Their mental forces are ever striving to attain unto some higher state, hence their ideas are always in excess of their means, large, majestic and grand.

Upon the Physical Plane, Leo gives a large, fair, stature, broad shoulders, large, prominent eyes, oval face, ruddy complexion and light hair, generally golden. This is for the first twenty degrees of the sign. The last ten degrees give the same but a much smaller person. Disposition, high spirited, resolute, haughty and ambitious. Of plants; this sign rules, anise, camomile, cowslip, daffodil, dill, eglantine, eye-bright, fennel, St. John's wort, lavender, yellow lily, poppy, marigold, garden mint, mistletoe, parsley and pimpernel. Of stones, Leo governs the hyacinth and chrysolite, and all soft yellow minerals such as ochre.

Virgo (♍) the Virgin.

The sign Virgo symbolizes chastity, and forms the central idea of a great number of myths. The Sun-God is always born at midnight, on the 25th of December, at which time the constellation of Virgo is seen shining above the horizon in the east. Hence originated the primitive idea of the Son of God being born of a Virgin. When the sun passes through this sign the harvest is ready for the reaper, hence Virgo is symbolized as the gleaning maid with two ears of wheat in her hand.

Kabbalistically, the sign Virgo signifies the solar plexus of the grand archetypal man, and therefore represents the assimilating and distributing functions of the human organ-

ism. Consequently we find that those born under this influence possess fine discriminating powers as to the choice of food best adapted to their particular organic requirements. This constellation, as governing the bowels of humanity, is highly important since the intestines comprise a very vital section of the digestive organism and vital fluids. Upon the esoteric planisphere, Virgo is occupied by Asher. "Out of Asher, his bread shall be fat," says Jacob, "and he shall yield royal dainties." Thus typifying the riches of the harvest. This sign expresses the fulfillment of the creative design, hence the mysteries of maternity are concealed under this symbol. It also reveals to us the significance of the sacrament of the Lord's Supper. The mystical gem of Virgo is the jasper, a stone possessing very important virtues. It should be worn by all natives born under this sign. Virgo is the second emanation of the earthy trigon, and is the constellation of Mercury.

Upon the Intellectual Plane, the sign Virgo signifies the realization of hopes. Those dominated by this influx are calm, confident and contented; they are reflective and studious, and extremely fond of reading. Consequently they become the mental repositories of much external wisdom and learning. Their chief attributes are hope and contentment. These desirable qualities, combined with the mental penetration of Mercury, which this sign contains, all conduce to make the native of Virgo pre-eminently fitted for the close application of scientific study. They possess large, well balanced brains and very superior intellectual abilities and

make clever statesman, when thrown into the vortex of political life.

Upon the Physical Plane, Virgo gives a medium stature, very neat and compact, dark sanguine complexion, and dark hair; disposition, ingenious, studious and inclined to be witty; rather even temper, but more excitable than Taurine persons. As orators, Virgo persons are fluent, plain, practical and very interesting. Of planets, this sign rules endive, millet, privet, succory, wood-bine, skullcap, valerian, wheat, barley, oats and rye. Of stones, the various kinds of flint.

CHAPTER VII.

Libra (♎) The Balance.

This constellation, in its Symbolical aspect, typifies justice. Most of our readers doubtless have seen the goddess of justice represented as a female, blind-folded, holding in her hand a pair of scales. This conception is purely astrological, and refers to the celestial Libra of the heavens. The sun enters this sign about the 21st of September, when, (as the poet Manilius says)

“Day and night are weighed in Libra’s scales,
Equal awhile, at last the night prevails.”

Kabbalistically, the sign Libra signifies the reins and loins of the grand celestial man, and therefore represents the central conservatory or store house of the re-productive

fluids. It is also the magnetic vortex of pro-creative strength. This constellation also represents, in its most interior aspect, the equinoctial point of the arc in the ascending and descending cycle of the life atom. Therefore, this sign contains the unification of the cosmic forces as the grand central point of equilibrium of the sphere. Libra upon the esoteric planisphere, is occupied by Dan. The patriarch, in his blessing, thus refers to his celestial nature: "Dan shall judge his people as one of the tribes of Israel." Libra represents the interior equilibrium of nature's forces, and contains the mystery of the divine at-one-ment of the ancient initiations. Upon the universal chart, this sign becomes Enoch, the perfect man. Its mystical gem is the diamond. As a magnetic talisman, this stone acts as a repulsive force, and combines with the magnetic sphere of those born under its influence to repel the emanations from foreign bodies, either of persons or things. Libra is the second emanation of the airy triplicity, and is the constellation of Venus.

Upon the Intellectual Plane, Libra signifies external perception, balanced by intuition, the union of which becomes externalized as reason and fore-sight. Therefore those dominated by this influence constitute the rationalistic school of the world's body of thinkers. Theoretically, they are strong supporters of such conceptions as universal brotherhood, universal equality and the rights of man. But practically, they seldom (unless it pays) reduce their pet theories to actual practice. The natives of Libra, though possessing a finely balanced mental and magnetic organism,

are seldom elevated into very prominent positions. This is because they are too even, both mentally and physically, to become the popular leaders of any radical or sensational party. It is one of the attributes of Libra, to infuse a natural instinct within all born under her influence to accept and adopt the golden mean, or, as it has been termed, "the happy medium." Hence they generally command respect from both sides on questions of debate.

Upon the Physical Plane, Libra generally produces, when rising at birth, a tall, slender form, of perfect proportions; brown hair, blue, sparkling eyes, and a fine, clear complexion. The disposition is noble, amiable, high-minded and good. It is perhaps as well to note the fact that this sign often produces dark brown and black hair and in females, very handsome features. Of plants, this sign rules water-cress, white rose, strawberry, primrose, vines, violet, heartsease, balm, lemon-thyme and pansy. Of stones, Libra governs white marble, spar and all white quartz.

Scorpio (♏) The Scorpion.

The sign Scorpio, in its symbolical aspect, symbolizes death and deceit. It is the allegorical serpent of matter mentioned in Genesis as tempting Eve. Hence the so-called fall of man from Libra, the point of equilibrium, to degradation and death by the deceit of Scorpio. No wonder the primitive mind, when elaborating this symbol, tried to express a spirit of retaliation, as Mackey says, in speaking of these ancient races,

"And as an act of vengeance on your part,
You placed within the sun a scorpion's heart."

Thus alluding to the brilliant star Antares.

Kabbalistically, the sign Scorpio typifies the generative organs of the grand man, and consequently represents the sexual or pro-creative system of humanity. It is the emblem of generation and life, therefore the natives of Scorpio excel in the fruitfulness of the seminal fluids, and this creates a corresponding increase of desire. A distinct reference to the fruitfulness of this sign will be found in Genesis, chap. xxx., wherein Leah, when she beheld the birth of Zilpah's son, exclaimed, "a troop cometh." (See verses 10 and 11.) Scorpio upon the esoteric planisphere, is occupied by Gad, of whom the dying Jacob says, "Gad, a troop shall overcome him, but he shall overcome at the last;" intimating the fall of man from a state of innocence and purity, through the multitude of sensual delights, and his final victory over the realms of matter as a spiritual entity. This sign represents the physical plane of the attributes of pro-creation. It contains the mystery of sex, and the secrets of the ancient phallic rites. The mystical gem of Scorpio is the topaz, the natural talisman of those born under this influence. Scorpio is the second emanation of the watery trigon, and is the constellation of Mars.

Upon the Intellectual Plane, the sign Scorpio signifies the generation of ideas; hence those dominated by this influx possess an inexhaustible resource of ideas and suggestions. Their active evolutionary minds are ever busy with some new conception, and their brains are literally crammed

full of inventive imageries. They possess keen perception, fine intuitional powers, and a very positive will. Hence they excel as medical practitioners, chemists and surgeons. In the various departments of the surgical art, natives of this sign possess no equal. In addition to this mechanical ability, they are endowed with a powerful, fruitful, magnetic life force which they sympathetically transmit to their patients. This is why they become such successful physicians. The sexual desire is naturally very strong, hence they are liable to excess in this direction.

Upon the Physical Plane, this sign gives a strong and rather corpulent body, medium stature, dark or ruddy complexion, dark hair, features often resembling the eagle; disposition active, resentful, proud, reserved, thoughtful and also selfish. Of plants, this sign rules black-thorn, charlock, heather, horehound, bean, bramble, leek, woad and wormwood. Of stones, the lode stone, blood stone and vermillion.

Sagittarius (♐) the Archer.

This constellation, in its symbolical aspect, represents a dual nature, as it symbolizes retribution and also the hunting sports. We find it depicted as a Centaur, with the bow and arrow drawn to its head ready for shooting. Hence it was frequently used to designate the autumnal sports—the chase, etc. The Centaur was also a symbol of authority and worldly wisdom. Mackey, speaking of this sign, said.

“The starry Centaur still bends the bow
To show his sense of what you did below.”

Kabbalistically, the sign Sagittarius signifies the thighs of the grand universal man. It, therefore, represents the muscular foundation of the seat of locomotion in humanity. It is the emblem of stability, foundation and physical power. This sign also represents the centers of physical, external, authority and command. Sagittarius, upon the esoteric planisphere, is occupied by Joseph. "His bow abode in strength," says the patriarch, "and the arms of his hands were made strong." It also represents the powers of "Church and state," and the necessity of legalized codes, civil, military and religious. It indicates to us the organizing powers of humanity, and the absolute necessity of "the powers that be" in certain states of development. We see in Joseph, the Egyptian ruler and law-giver, a true type of real authority. The mystical gem of this influx is the carbuncle, which is a talisman of great virtue to its proper natives. Sagittarius is the lowest emanation of the fiery trigon and is the constellation of Jove, the planet Jupiter.

Upon the Intellectual Plane, Sagittarius represents the organizing power of the mind; hence this influence indicates the external powers of command, discipline and obedience to the ruling authority of material institutions. Persons of this nature are loyal and patriotic and law abiding. Such natives are generous and free; energetic and combative; hasty in temperament; ambitious of position and power; also charitable to the afflicted and oppressed. They possess strong conservative qualities, and their chief mental

characteristics are prompt decision, self control and the ability to command others.

Upon the Physical Plane, this sign usually produces a well formed person, rather above medium height, sanguine complexion, oval face, high forehead, bright brown hair, fine clear eyes — in short, handsome. In disposition, the native is quick, energetic, fond of out door sports and recreations; hasty tempered, jovial, free and benevolent. Of plants, this sign rules agrimony, wood betony, feather-few and mallows. Of stones, Sagittarius governs the turquois, and all the stones mixed with red and green.

Capricorn (♐) the Goat.

This sign, in its symbolical aspect, typifies sin. The scapegoat of the Israelites, and the universal offering of a kid or young goat as an atoning sacrifice for sin, are significant. The different qualities of the sheep and the goat, from a symbolical standpoint, are used by St. John in his mystical Apocalypse. The Redeemer of mankind, or Sun God, is always born at midnight directly Sol enters this sign, which is the winter solstice. "The young child" is born in the stable and laid in the manger of the goat, in order that he may conquer the remaining signs of winter or death, and thus save mankind from destruction.

Kabbalistically, the sign Capricorn signifies the knees of the grand macrocosm and represents the first principle in the trinity of locomotion, viz.: the joints; bending, pliable and movable. It is the emblem of material servitude, and as such is worthy of notice. Capricorn, upon the

esoteric planisphere, is occupied by Naphtali, whom Jacob says, "is a hind let loose, he giveth goodly words." Here we have two very distinct references: the first, to the symbol a hind or young deer, *i. e.* a goat with horns, (goats and deer are equally significant of the earthly, mountainous nature, and are fond of high hills); the second, is the Christmas proclamation, he giveth goodly words, "Peace on earth, good will toward man." This sign represents "regeneration," or re-birth, and reveals the necessity of "new dispensations." The mystical gem of this constellation is the onyx, sometimes called "chalcedony." Capricorn is the lowest emanation of the earthy trigon, and is the constellation of the planet Saturn.

Upon the Intellectual Plane, Capricorn signifies external form, and those dominated by its influx are among the very lowest in the scale of true spirituality. The brain of this influence is ever on the alert to seize and take advantage of circumstances. The sign gives a purely scheming mentality; the intellectual nature is directed purely to the attainment of selfish ends; the penetrating power of the mind is great. The natives are quick as lightning to see in others the weak points that they may work to their own advantage. They are indisposed to do any real hard work unless they see some great benefit therefrom in the immediate future. It is a very undesirable influence.

Upon the Physical Plane, Capricorn generally gives a medium stature, slender, often ill proportioned; plain looking, energetic in their own interests, and indolent in the employ of others. Frequently these natives have a long

sharp chin and slender nose, with small piercing eyes. They are almost always narrow chested. In disposition they are crafty, subtle, reserved and often melancholy. At the same time natives of Saturn are often miserly. Of plants, this sign rules hemlock, henbane, deadly nightshade and black poppy. Of stones, Capricorn governs coal and all black or ash colored minerals.

Aquarius (♒) the Water-Bearer.

This sign symbolizes judgment. This constellation forms the starry original of the urn of Minos, from which flow wrath and condemnation or blessings and reward, according to the works done in the body, irrespective of theological faith. The earlier baptismal urns of the primitive Christians, and the elaborate stone fonts of the later churches, are relics of this great astral religion.

Kabbalistically, the sign Aquarius signifies the legs of the grand archetypal man, and therefore represents the locomotive functions of the human organism. It is the natural emblem of the changeable, movable and migratory forces of the body. The Water-bearer, upon the esoteric planisphere, is occupied by Reuben. "The excellency of dignity and the excellency of power," says Jacob, "unstable as water thou shalt not excel" A simple but magnificent astrological description of this sign, which, from time immemorial, has been symbolized by two wavy lines ♒, like the ripples of running water. This sign signifies consecration, and not only contains the rites and mysteries of consecration, but will reveal to the student the potency of all sacred

and dedicated works. The mystical gem of this sign is the sky blue sapphire (not the dark or opaque sapphire). Aquarius is the lowest emanation of the airy trigon, and the constellation of Uranus.

Upon the Intellectual Plane, Aquarius represents popular science, and consequently the truth of material phenomena. Those dominated by its influx constitute the school of inductive philosophy—the grand basis of all exoteric science. They represent the intellectual and scientific spirit of their age and generation, and cannot advance one step beyond those classes of facts which are demonstrable to the senses. Elegant in form, they are brilliant in intellect.

Upon the Physical Plane, Aquarius gives medium stature, plump, well-set and robust; good, clear, sanguine complexion; sandy or dark flaxen hair; very prepossessing appearance; disposition elegant, amiable, good natured, witty and very artistic; fond of refined society. Of plants, this sign rules spikenard, frankincense and myrrh. Of stones, Aquarius governs black pearl and obsidian.

Pisces (♊) the Fishes.

This sign symbolizes the flood, chiefly because when Sol passes through this sign the rainy season commences, clearing away the snows of winter, the melting torrents of which flood the valleys and low lands. This sign is also the terminus of Apollo's journey through the twelve signs.

“Near their loved waves cold Pisces keep their seat,
With Aries join, and make the round complete.”

Kabbalistically, the sign Pisces signifies the feet of the grand cosmic man, and therefore represents the basis or foundation of all external things as well as the mechanical forces of humanity. It is the natural emblem of patient servitude and obedience. This sign upon the esoteric planisphere is occupied by Ephraim and Manasseh, the two sons of Joseph, who received their portion in Israel as the two feet of the grand, archetypal man. It signifies confirmation, also baptism by water. It also indicates to us the divine purpose of the great cycle of necessity: commencing with the disruptive, flashing, dominating fire of Aries, and terminating with its polar opposite, water, the symbol of universal equilibrium. The mystical gem of Pisces is the chrysolite (white and glittering). Pisces is the last emanation of the watery trigon, and is the constellation of Neptune.

Upon the Intellectual Plane, Pisces represents mental indifference. It is the polar opposite of the head. Those dominated by its influx express a peculiar indifference to those things which generally interest others. They take all things as they come, and pay no serious attention to any. They live and die in accordance with St. Paul's advice, being "all things to all men."

Upon the Physical Plane, this sign gives a short, fleshy body, brown hair, pale complexion, moist, watery eyes (fishy looking); disposition negative, timid, listless and harmless. Their nature is peaceable, but their actions are influenced by their surroundings and friends. Of plants, this sign rules all sea weeds, also ferns and mosses that

grow in water. Of stones, it governs coral, rock, pumice and gravel or sand.

The Occult Application of the Twelve Signs.

The four triplicities symbolize the four cardinal points of the universe. To us, on our present external and physical plane, they signify the four opposite points of space as represented in the compass and cross (hence the sacredness of the cross as a symbol in all times and ages) and the four Occult elements, Fire, Earth, Air and Water. They each correspond to a particular quarter of the heavens. Thus the Fiery Trigon corresponds to the positive-azoth, and is expressed in the glowing, flaming, eastern horizon at sun-rise, the beginning of the day. Similarly, primary molten fire was the beginning, or first condition, of the present order of things on our globe, and stands for that principle of heat termed caloric, which sustains the animal, vital life force of all animate beings upon the face of the planets.

Upon the Intellectual Plane, Fire represents zeal, animal courage, daring, and, in fact, all that pertains to action and activity. While on the higher plane—the esoteric—Fire implies the interior apprehension of the meaning and significance of action as displayed in the trinity and expressed by the fire of three terms—Aries, Leo and Sagittarius: Aries, the intellect; Leo, the emotions; Sagittarius, the offspring of the intellect and emotions,—the external result or consummation of the two, that point which

is neither the one nor the other, but where the two are one.

The Earthly Triplicity stands for the frozen, inert north as a symbol of frigidness — hardening — crystallization — death. It is concerned with all of phenomena that is most external and palpable to the external senses — the solids, metals, fabrics, etc.

Upon the Intellectual Plane, it is concerned with the relations of solids to each other, from which is especially evolved form, proportion, sound, etc. The same may be said of the metals dug up from the bowels of the earth, of the commerce, arts and industries resulting therefrom. Esoterically, the earthy trigon denotes the comprehension of the spiritual qualities evolved from the earthy activities, or, rather, that one spiritual quality of three-fold formation expressed in three mystical terms γ , μ , ν . Taurus, servitude or spirit of patient work; Virgo, formation and re-formation; Capricorn, the result of the union of Taurus and Virgo, which leads either to the higher plane in the spiral of existence, or to the lower plane on the downward course to darker realms of being, more earthy, hardened and dead.

The Airy Triplicity represents the west, the scene of the setting sun, which signifies the dying of the day, of sense and of matter, which is only the promise of another day — an advance to a higher plane. This brighter day is denoted by the airy trigon, and is concerned upon the external plane with the priestly, political and social relations of human life. That is to say, it represents the higher qualities of

these relations. It is, therefore, symbolized by the invisible element, air — the great medium of motion. Its esoteric significance is comprised in the arcana of the one true science. After first having a knowledge of the twins (Π) external, the internal science attains unto the adjustment and equilibrium or balance ($\triangle$) of the two, so that they exactly blend in the divine equipoise of harmony and wisdom; thus realizing only the rippling waves (〰) of peaceful results instead of the down-pouring floods and cataclysms, both social and physical, which otherwise result from the unbalanced scales ($\triangle$), when external and internal antagonize as two hostile and absolutely separate and dual forces, instead of balancing as two modes of one and the same eternal motion — the one life of the universe.

The Watery Triplicity, symbolical of the south, is the exact opposite of the earthy north. It is the frozen, melted; the hardened, liquified; the renewal of the crystal into other forms; and the resurrection of death unto life. The watery trigon signifies the constant effort in nature to adjust opposites and contradictories; to bring about chemical changes and affinities, as especially seen in fluids, and as so perfectly symbolized in that great distinguishing feature of water, viz., to seek its own level. On the external planes of human life, the watery trigon denotes love, ($\overline{\circ}$) sex, (♂) and offspring ($\times$), the external results of the union of the two (love and sex). On the more esoteric planes, Cancer symbolizes tenacity to life, hence the desire for immortality which, combined with a knowledge of the mysteries of sex (♂) or generation and regeneration, leads the immortal

soul to the termination of its earthly pilgrimage and material incarnations, in the union with its missing half or Pisces which is symbolized, upon the celestial equator (equilibrium), as the two fishes bound together by the cord (of love). Having regained this equator and passed from the lower arc of matter, the soul enters once more upon the spiritual path of eternal conscious life.

The reader will now perceive that the four great trigons are but the different series of attributes within the human soul or microcosm, and further that the twelve constellations of the zodiac reveal the mystical signification of Adam Kadmon, the archetypal man of the starry planisphere. Thus Aries rules the head, brain and the fiery will. Taurus, the neck and throat, the ears, the listening requisites of obedient servitude. Gemini, the hands and arms, or projective and executive powers. Cancer, the breast, bosom and lungs, which signify life and love. Leo, the heart and its varied emotions. Virgo, the bowels, and navel or maternal, compassionate and formative qualities. Libra, the loins or physical strength, the power of balancing the mental faculties. Scorpio, the generative organs and the procreative attributes. Sagittarius, the hips and thighs, the seat or foundation of volitional force, the migratory instincts, etc. Capricorn, the knees, tokens of humble submission to the higher powers. Aquarius, the legs and ankles or active powers of movement and locomotion. And, lastly, Pisces, the feet, the foundation of the whole frame, which should ever be capable of finding and sustaining its own

MAN'S PLANETARY ORGANISM.



THE UNION OF THE SOUL AND STARS.

level unaided, lest the grand human temple fall to the ground. Thus we begin with fire, and terminate with water. These constitute the two poles of the human magnet.

Note.—To obtain the celestial application of the above, the points must be reversed: north becomes south; east the west, and so on.

CHAPTER VIII.

THE NATURE AND INFLUENCE OF THE PLANETS.

Before describing the nature and influence of the planets as known to the initiates of Hermetic philosophy, it is necessary to point out to the reader the difference between the nature of a planet and a constellation. The twelve signs constitute the innate, latent possibilities of the organism, and as such represent the constitution as a whole. In this light we have considered them in the two previous chapters. While on the other hand, the planets constitute the active forces which arouse these latent possibilities. In this duplex action of sign and planet, both natures come into play and produce the various results of external life. Man, the microcosm, is merely the sounding board, so to say, the re-acting point for their ethereal and magnetic vibrations. Further, while the twelve signs represent the human organism as a form containing latent possibilities, the sun, moon and planets represent the spirit, soul and senses of that organism. Man consists of body, soul and

spirit.* As at present manifested, he has five physical senses.† The constellations are the body; the moon is the soul; the sun, the spirit; and the five planets, Saturn, Jupiter, Mars, Venus and Mercury, represent and express the five physical senses. It is in this light that the reader must consider the various natures of the planetary influx, described in this and the succeeding chapters. A great many students of the mystical science fall into serious error through failing to grasp this relation of the stars and planets.

It must also be borne in mind that, when considering the actual influences at work in a given horoscope, those signs only which contain one or more planets will be the dominant forces within the constitution, mental, physical, or both, according to the plane occupied by the person. To ascertain the particular plane a person occupies, is a very difficult matter with most. It can only be gauged and understood by those who possess the interior senses of the soul in such an advanced state as to be capable of spiritual perception, either of sight or feeling. Therefore, the perfect astrologer is the perfect man. There are, however, many degrees of perfection, and the reader, as well as the writer, must feel thankful for the degree which he may already possess, and set to work in real earnest to attain a still greater degree of spiritual perfection.

*For a detailed description of the constitution of man, see Part I.

†We have already pointed out (in Part I of this work) the fact that man in reality possesses seven senses. The reader will find them tabulated under the head of Adeptship. We will only add that the two planets, Uranus and Neptune, correspond to those two higher senses which, at present, are still latent within the great majority of mankind.

The Sun. (☉)

The symbolical aspect of the glorious orb of day undoubtedly first occupied the attention, veneration and worship of the primitive races of mankind. Every thing in nature depends absolutely upon the presence and kindly support of the shining sun, for its existence and life. The literal interpretation of the Hebrew name for the sun, Ashahed, is "The all bountiful fire," which is perfectly in harmony with the solar orb.

It is utterly impossible in the brief space at our command to give even the remotest conception of the innumerable ramifications connected with the various mythologies which typify the sun. We will, therefore, only add that Osiris of Egypt, Chrishna of India, Belus of Chaldea, and Ormazd of the Persians are merely different personifications of the sun.

Kabbalistically, the sun represents the central spiritual source of all. It is the divine Ego of the grand man, and therefore signifies the spiritual potentialities of creative power. It is the great I AM of all things, both spiritual and temporal, and is, in itself, the grand conservatory of Life, Light and Love. Upon the esoteric planisphere, the sun becomes the great archangel Michael, who defeats Satan and tramples upon the head of the serpent of matter, and thenceforward guards the way of life and immortality with the flaming swords of solar power. In this sense the sun represents the positive, aggressive, controlling forces of the cosmos. The forces of the sun are electric.

Astrologically considered, the sun constitutes the central life principle of all physical things. His influx determines the absolute measure of physical vitality within each human organism. When the solar ray is not vitiated by the discordant configurations of malefic stars, the individual then born will enjoy a sound constitution; more especially so, if the sun at the moment of birth is between the ascendant and meridian, or, in other words, during the increase of diurnal sunshine, which is from sun rise to noon.

Upon the Intellectual Plane, the sun governs the higher group of the selfish sentiments and lower group of the moral qualities; the former represented by firmness and self esteem, and the latter by hope and conscientiousness. Those dominated by this influx are the natural born leaders of mankind. By their high-minded presence, they proclaim their "right divine to govern." They are proud and ambitious, yet magnanimous and noble. Hating all mean, petty and sordid actions, they express the very highest form of true dignified manhood.

Upon the Physical Plane, the position of the sun in the horoscope is one of vital importance, for on this, in a male natus, hangs the vital thread of life. If evil rays concentrate thereon the life will be of short duration, unless counteracting aspects intervene.

When the sun is afflicted at birth, his influence upon the native through life will be malefic. When this is so, even minor evil directions to the sun and moon combined will bring about destruction of life; the nature of which will be similar to that of the afflicting planets.

(Make a note of this.) For prosperity and success in life, then, it is essential that the luminaries be well aspected and favorably situated in the celestial figure. When the sun and moon are afflicted at birth, depend upon it, that person will have a very hard struggle against an adverse fate all the days of his life, and it will not require the powers of an inspired prophet to fore-tell his general destiny. "From evil, discord and suffering are born."

The Sun, rising at birth, confers courage, pride, ambition and, to a certain extent, good fortune. But if afflicted by Saturn the native will suffer much in health, and be correspondingly unfortunate. If afflicted by Mars the native will be cruel, rash and quarrelsome. Such a one will have little respect for the feelings of others, unless Jupiter or Venus cast beneficent rays. Generally speaking, the Sun when rising at birth gives a person of strong frame, good forehead, large eyes, sharp sight, tawny or brown hair. If well aspected and dignified, the disposition is noble, generous and proud, yet humane and courteous; a truly faithful friend and generous foe. He is profuse in his manner, and loves magnificence. If evilly aspected and ill dignified, then the native is mean, proud and tyrannical to those under his authority, but a submissive sycophant to his superiors; shallow minded and thoroughly unfeeling.

The Moon. (☾)

The symbolical aspect of Luna, like that of the Sun, cannot be detailed. From time immemorial the fair goddess of night has been venerated and worshiped as the universal

mother, the feminine fructifying principle of all things. In the poetical conception of the Hebrews, the moon was called Ash-nem or Shenim, the state of slumber and change. Without a complete knowledge of astrological science, the weird truths concealed beneath the veil of Isis can never be properly understood. Astrology alone is the true key to the fundamental principles of Occultism. The secret of the tides, the mysteries of gestation, and the alternate periods of sterility and fruitfulness caused by the ebb and flow of the magnetic life currents throughout every department of nature, are discoverable only by a comprehension of the divine goddess of our midnight skies. This knowledge was the sublime attainment of the sages, "who," says Bulwer Lytton, "first discovered the starry truths that shone upon the great shemaia of the Chaldean lore." Chandra of the Hindoos, Isis of the Egyptians, Diana of the Greeks, and others, are all the moon.

Kabbalistically, the Moon represents the soul of the grand man. It is therefore the celestial virgin of the world in its mystical application, the emblem of the Anima Mundi. Upon the esoteric planisphere, Luna becomes transformed into the Angel Gabriel. Upon the universal chart, we see her expressed as the divine Isis, the woman clothed with the sun. As Isis, she represents the grand initiatrix of the soul into the sublime mysteries of the spirit. The Moon, also, represents the moulding, formative attributes of the astral light. She, also, stands as the representative of matter. Hence, in her dual character, she reveals to us her forces which are purely magnetic, and as such they stand

as the polar opposite of those of the Sun which are electric. In their relation to each other, they are man and woman.

Astrologically considered, volumes might be written regarding this orb. When we consider her proximity to our earth and her affinity with it, as well as the rapidity of her motion, we cannot help granting to her the highest position as an active agent in every branch of judicial astrology. Her influence is purely negative, however, and, in herself alone, or when void of the configurations of the sun and planets, she is neither fortunate nor unfortunate. But when configured with other orbs, her influx becomes exceedingly potent, as she receives and transmits to us the intensified influence of those stars aspecting her. The Moon, therefore, may be called the great astrological medium of the skies.

Upon the Intellectual Plane, Luna governs the physical senses, and to a great extent the animal passions also. She controls the lower forms of the domestic qualities, and lower group of intellectual faculties. Those dominated by her influx are changeable in their nature, submissive and very inoffensive. Magnetically, their odyllic sphere is purely mediumistic; hence they become inactive and dreamy. Generally, Luna natives may be said to be rather indifferent characters, lacking anything and everything that may be called strong and decisive. They are given to roaming about, or constantly moving their residence from one place to another.

Upon the Physical Plane, the influence of the Moon is convertible in its nature, being harmonious or discordant

according to her relative position to the sun and major planets. If the moon be dignified at birth, she renders the native more refined, engaging and courteous than he otherwise would be. Should she also be well aspected, such a position will confer refined, artistic tastes, easy disposition and good abilities. On the contrary, should the moon be ill dignified or evilly aspected, the native then born will be a shallow-minded, evil character, prone to dissipation, slothful and void of proper business foresight, consequently improvident. If the horoscope be a strong one in other respects, and points out sterling ability, then these aspects will tend rather towards making the person diplomatic. These aspects are also a strong indication, when unassisted by benevolent rays, of ultimate insanity. Very great consideration is necessary upon these conflicting points. In addition to the indifferent disposition above mentioned, the Moon when rising, usually produces a medium-sized body, fair or pale complexion, round face and grey eyes; the forehead wide but not high; temperament phlegmatic.

The Planet Mercury (♿)

In its symbolical aspect, the planet Mercury was most prominent as "the messenger of the gods." A thousand myths have been elaborated regarding "the fleet-footed Mercury." In the fertile imaginations of the early Greeks, the spirit of Mercury was ever on the alert to manifest its powers. His actions though sometimes mischievous, were often beneficial. It seems that the central idea of these ancients was to typify or express in external form the rest-

less activities of the mercurial mind; hence wings were placed upon his head and feet.

Kabbalistically, the planet Mercury signifies perception, and therefore represents the power of sight within the grand body of the celestial man. It is the active power of self-consciousness within humanity, and the ability to see, perceive and reason. Upon the esoteric planisphere, Mercury becomes transformed into the angelic Raphael, the genius of wisdom and art. We therefore see that the esoteric forces of this orb are those which tend to elevate mankind from the animal planes to those of the human.

Astrologically considered, the influx of Mercury is mental and restless. No system of mere human invention would have dedicated to an almost invisible star—the least and most insignificant of all primary planets—the government of man's intellectual nature. Any fanciful system would have attributed such an important group of mental qualities to the Sun, or to the lordly Jupiter. The experience of the ancients, however, showed them that neither the Sun nor Jupiter possessed any such influence, and it is upon the experience of ages that the truths of astrology are founded, and the rules made for their application.

The qualities of Mercury may be well expressed by the American phrase, "get up and get;" for energy, intellect and impudence constitute the chief characteristics of the purely Mercurial native. There is nothing too hot or too heavy for his ingenuity, nor is there anything too great for his fertile brain to accomplish. The United States, as a whole, are ruled by Gemini, the constellation of Mercury,

and the restless energy, commercial enterprise and scheming abilities of the typical American are well expressed by the singular influence of his patron star.

Upon the Intellectual Plane, however, the planet Mercury is truly the genius of wisdom, and governs the whole of those mental qualities denominated perceptive. The oratorical powers are likewise ruled by this planet. Those dominated by its influx are ingenious, inventive, witty, sarcastic, scientific and possess remarkable penetrative power. They are profound investigators of all those sciences that aid in the promotion of commerce.

Upon the Physical Plane, Mercury rules the brain and tongue. When strongly placed at birth, the person will possess a vivid imagination and retentive memory, and also be noted for mental capacity and power of persuasion. Such a position, if configured with the Moon, will give an unwearying fancy and strongly incline the mind towards the curious and Occult side of nature. Should Mercury be ill dignified and void of the good aspects of other orbs, and at the same time be afflicted by Mars, he will produce a liar and an unprincipled, shuffling nature, incapable of attaining or appreciating the higher mental and moral standard. If strong or well aspected and below the horizon, he inclines the native to mystical and Occult studies, but if above the horizon and dignified, he confers a more external influence and produces orators, statesmen and teachers. One of the chief attributes of this planet, when well placed above the horizon, is that of literary ability. All such natives possess genuine talent in this direction. It may, therefore, be

safely said that Mercury confers the ideal when below, and the practical when above the ascendant at birth. Physically, Mercury gives a medium stature, strong but slender frame, exceedingly active, sharp piercing eyes, thin lips, well cut features and confident look. The complexion depends upon the Race.

The Planet Venus. (♀)

In her mythological and symbolical aspect, the planet Venus has been venerated the wide world over in her dual character of Love and Wisdom. The bright star of the morning, proud Lucifer, was the harbinger and genius of wisdom, and, truly, none of the stars of heaven can compare with the brilliance and glory of Venus when she shines as the herald of day. As the goddess of Love she is equally prominent. The ancient Greeks also represented her as Aphrodite, wearing the horns of her sacred Bull, Taurus.

Kabbalistically, the planet Venus signifies the Love element within the soul of the grand archetypal man, and therefore represents the sense of feeling within embodied humanity. It consequently expresses the clinging, yielding, feminine portion of the human constitution. Upon the esoteric planisphere, Venus becomes the celestial Anael, prince of the astral light. In this character we behold her powers of transformation, and the "conservation of forces." As Isis represents the astral fluid in a state of rest, pregnant (by the Holy Ghost) with the things TO BE, Anael represents the same fluid in action. Therefore, the Moon

and Venus form the kabbalistic symbols for the two modes of motion within the soul of the universe.

Astrologically considered, the planet Venus may be said to represent mirth, joy and conviviality as the influx inclines those under her rule to pleasure-seeking and grand display. The pleasures of society are especially governed by Venus. Balls, parties, concerts and receptions possess almost irresistible attractions to those born under her influence. If afflicted in a feminine horoscope, without strong counteracting rays, the native becomes "unfortunate" and suffers from the loss of virtue, hence the position of Venus is very important.

Upon the Intellectual Plane, Venus controls the higher group of the domestic qualities and also the ideal, a æsthetic and musical sentiments. Those dominated by her influx excel in music, art and poetry and become noted for their refined accomplishments. But, at the same time, they lack true moral power. They are guided impulsively by their sentiments, passions and desires. Reason is conspicuous by its absence when their desires are aroused. Hence, the danger of being misled by flattery and sentimental nonsense is very great when Venus is not protected by harmonious rays.

Upon the Physical Plane, when Venus has chief dominion over the mind of the native, she induces a strong predilection for society, and inclines to dancing, music, drawing, etc. She also confers a good humored, witty, kind and charitable disposition. Men dominated by this influx are always great favorites with the fair sex, but they are

thoroughly deficient in firmness and self-control, and, if ill dignified, the male native will often find himself in awkward affairs, and is liable to fall into intemperance. A friendly aspect of Saturn in such cases would do much towards cooling and steadying the native's character and inducing reflection. Women born with Venus in the ascendant generally display the most amiable, engaging and fascinating qualities. If well aspected, they are neat and artistic in their dress and personal appearance; elegant in their homes and generally as virtuous as they are beautiful. It has been truly said, "The general disposition derived from Venus is that of mildness and genuine good nature, and whatever defects may fall to the lot of the native, they are seldom great ones, and are more the results of weakness and a strong animal nature than constitutional wickedness or a desire to do wrong." In this we fully concur, and will only add that the chances to do wrong are multiplied by a prepossessing externalism. They are of medium stature, of fair clear complexion, bright sparkling wicked eyes, handsome features and beautiful form.

CHAPTER IX.

THE NATURE AND INFLUENCE OF THE PLANETS.

(CONTINUED.)

The Planet Mars. (♂)

This planet, of all others, in its symbolical aspect, was the object of divine honors in the eyes of the ancient world. Mars seems to have been the most sincerely worshipped of all the gods by our northern ancestors. The greatest glory, in their rude times, was enjoyed by the greatest warrior. Hence Mars, in his universal character, represents the god of war. He was also symbolized as Vulcan, the celestial blacksmith, who forged the thunderbolts of Jove. This indicates the rule of Mars over iron, steel, fire and edged tools.

Kabbalistically, the planet Mars signifies aliveness within the grand man, and, therefore, represents the sense of taste in the human constitution. We have a direct reference to the expression of these martial forces in reference to the physical sensations in the New Testament, viz.: "eat, drink and be merry, for to-morrow we die." Upon the esoteric planisphere, Mars becomes transformed into the angel Samael (Zamael), wherein are shown the highest attributes of this spirit. As such, it represents the power and ability to appreciate the higher, finer and more ethereal essences of the life wave, and, therefore, to have dominion over the powers of absorption and assimilation.

Astrologically considered, Mars typifies and embodies, in his astral expression, the spirit of cruelty, bloodshed and of indiscriminate destruction. The true son of Mars is a genuine pugilist of the first water, and is never so happy as when thoroughly engaged in vanquishing his opponent. A type of this questionable spirit of enterprise may be found in the history of Great Britain. England is ruled by the sign Aries, the chief sign of Mars, and the typical Englishman is a Mars man. No better subject for study can be found to illustrate Mars than John Bull. He is always fighting some one, and his past history for a thousand years upon land and sea is the record of brilliant victories with very, very few reverses.

Upon the Intellectual Plane, Mars represents the spirit of enterprise, energy and courage. Without a spice of this planet all men would be shiftless, effeminate cowards. Those dominated by the Martial influx are mechanical in the highest degree, and possess an unconquerable, untiring energy and potent will.

Upon the Physical Plane, Mars signifies all those who are in any way engaged in the production of iron and steel. All Martial men prefer some business where sharp instruments, iron or fire are used, as in the case of butchers, barbers, blacksmiths, etc. When the planet is rising at birth, it always imparts a certain kind of ruddiness either upon the face or hair, a fiery look, and gives to the native a dauntless, manly appearance. If located in the second angle, it causes the native to become improvident and to spend money thoughtlessly. Such a person never becomes.

wealthy, but always lives up to his means. Located in the 10th or mid-heaven, it never fails to cause the native much suffering from slander and consequent detriment of character. When we compare the native of Mars with that of Saturn, we find them as polar opposites. The latter is like a slow, lingering consumptive disease, and the former like a raging fever. No matter who or what they may be, depend upon it you will always find the native of Mars fiery, headstrong, furious in temper, and in many respects cruel and destructive; and yet withal they are generous to excess with their friends, and fond of good company. The general description of a true Mars man is somewhat as follows: medium height, strong, well made body, ruddy complexion, piercing eyes, square set jaw, bold determined look and quick, quarrelsome temper. The color of the hair is variable, but it has generally a fiery tinge.

The Planet Jupiter. (2)

Under its symbolical aspect, we find Jupiter universally recognized among the ancient Greeks as Jove, the celestial father of all. Under the remoter Aryan symbolism, we find it represented as the "All father of Heaven." Both conceptions, Greek and Aryan, are identical. In the rude conceptions of the hardy sons of the north, we see the planet Jupiter depicted as Thor, from which comes the saxon Thors-day and the modern English Thursday,—the day over which the planet was supposed to rule.

Kabbalistically, the planet Jupiter signifies ethereal absorption within the grand man. It therefore represents

the power of scent or smell within the body of humanity. It is the sense by means of which the developed soul perceives and partakes the finer aromatic essences of nature. Upon the esoteric planisphere, Jupiter becomes transformed into the celestial Zachariel or Zadkiel, and thus represents the impartial spirit of disinterestedness. In this capacity, it signifies the principles and philosophy of arbitration, the perfect adjustment of equilibrium by the withdrawal of disturbing forces. As symbolical of the attributes of ethereal absorption, we are frequently reminded of this planet by the Kabbalistical writers of the books of Moses, who intimate that "a sweet smelling savor" was acceptable to the Lord during the sacred rites of the temple service.

Astrologically considered, the planet Jupiter is the largest, and next to Saturn the most potent planet in our solar system. He signifies all that is truly good and charitable in human life. His action is truly noble, far removed from the sheepish timidity of Saturn, or the impudent forwardness of Mars. The genuine son of Jupiter fills the atmosphere around him with genial warmth. His soul is brimming full of honest good nature. Utterly incapable of practicing fraud himself, he never suspects it in others, hence often becomes the victim of others' schemes and duplicity. This planet's nature suggests itself when we say that he takes every man to be honest until he is proven to be a rogue, and when this is proved will forgive him once or twice before punishing him.

Upon the Intellectual Plane, Jupiter signifies the higher moral nature, the humanitarian qualities, and is the author

of all noble and charitable institutions and enterprises. Those dominated by his influx express the highest form of human nature. There is something truly royal in this planet's influence, a mixture of the father, patriarch and king. Such natives do much to redeem mankind from their general depravity. There will always be found in the natives of Jupiter, upon the intellectual plane, a fine sense of discrimination, hence they possess rare qualities of justice which entitle them to be judges of the people. When they err it is always on the side of mercy.

Upon the Physical Plane, Jupiter may be called the greater fortune, when he rules over a nativity. He gives a sober, manly, commanding presence. The native is sober and grave in his speech, but at the same time kind and sympathetic. If well dignified, he makes the native sincere, honest and faithful; generous, liberal, prudent and aspiring; strongly given to religious and moral sentiments, and generally speaking, all that can be desired where morality, integrity and faithful service is required. Located in the 2nd, and well aspected, he brings great wealth to the native. Dignified in the 10th, he confers the highest honor upon the native. Such persons always attain unto very important and responsible positions which they fill with dignity to themselves, and honor to those who promote them. This planet's position, unafflicted in the 7th house, confers great matrimonial felicity; in the 11th, faithful and powerful friends; in the 5th, great gain and benefit through his offspring. But when Jupiter is afflicted and ill dignified, then his nature is greatly altered. The native is generally

a pretender to all these noble qualities. He externally simulates them, but at heart he is a shallow, scheming hypocrite, a wolf in sheep's clothing. He is the judge who renders his opinion according to the price. He is hollow, a fraud and a sham. The Jupiter man is generally a tall, well made, rather fleshy, generous looking, dignified person, sanguine complexion and brown hair.

The Planet Saturn. (♄)

Old Father Time, with his skeleton-like form and deathly scythe is, doubtless, well known to most of our readers. This is one of the many forms assumed by Saturn in his symbolical aspect. With the ancient Greeks he was known as Kronos, holding the cycle of necessity and eternity in one hand, and the symbol of death in the other; thus typifying eternal change of form, sphere and function. Among the ancient Hebrews, Saturn was called Shebo, a name that literally means seven. It is composed of Ashsheb, which means the star of old age, thus expressing the symbol of this planet.

Kabbalistically, the planet Saturn signifies silent meditation, and thus corresponds to the auricular attributes of the grand man, and, therefore, represents the senses and powers of hearing, listening, etc., within the constitution of humanity. We see, therefore, the mystical significance of the Kabbalistical conception of this orb as silent meditation. In order to meditate, there must be silence; hence listening, hearing. Meditation is but the listening of the mind to the inspirations of the soul. Upon the esoteric planisphere,

Saturn becomes the angel Cassiel, the genius of reflection in the astral light. It also presents to us the occult side of all theological mysteries; hence the medieval conception of this planet as the isolated hermit. It is in this sense that we find it symbolized in the Tarot, a system worthy of greater attention than seems to be paid to it by modern students of occult science.

Astrologically considered, the planet Saturn may be truthfully said to be the most potent and malignant of all the planets. This is not so much on account of the marked character of his influence, as the imperceptible, subtle manner in which his influx undermines the vitality of the physical organism of those it afflicts. Mars comes like a thunder-clap, and gives every one to understand that there is something decidedly wrong. But Saturn is exactly the reverse. His nature is slow and patient, cunning and stealthy. At least a good half of our world's suffering is due to the action of this planet, and in fact nine-tenths of the ills of human life are due to the malignant rays of Mars and Saturn combined. Mars commits crime in a passionate and unthinking manner, and very seldom indeed is guilty of premeditated wrong. Saturn is the reverse. He thinks over all his plans very carefully before he attempts to put them into execution, and seldom makes a mistake.

Upon the Intellectual Plane, Saturn governs the higher group of the selfish sentiments, and the whole of the reflective qualities. Those dominated by his influx are retired, reserved, slow in speech and action. They express the highest form of reflection; consequently they are studious,

scientific and close reasoners. They generally tend to exclusiveness, hence the hermit is a true type of this planet's action. They excel in all Occult studies.

Upon the Physical Plane, the only good that Saturn can do, is to strengthen the mentality, cool the passions, and make the native selfish and careful of his especial interests. When a person can claim these favors, he is exceedingly fortunate, because almost every aspect and position of this planet is rather more of a misfortune than a blessing. In nature it is cold and selfish, and is very apt to create a miserly disposition. If located in the mid-heaven, it brings ultimate ruin and disgrace. The horoscopes of Napoleon I. and Napoleon III. are splendid examples of this position. Both were born with Saturn in the M. C., and both attained to heights of fame, and then suffered from disgrace and died in exile. When Saturn is exactly upon the zenith and afflicting the sun and moon, the child born will not live twelve months. If in the ascendant, it makes the person timid and miserly, and generally produces a weak circulation. If in the 7th, the native may expect a miserable life when he marries. When in the 5th, the children of the native seldom live, unless one of the horoscopes, especially the wife's, counteracts this. The chief thing to note is whether the planet is well aspected or dignified. If such is the case, the native is much superior, and the influence is chiefly upon the mental plane. The native of Saturn is a thin, spare, lanky person; small, sharp eyes and black hair. He is inclined to melancholy.

We have now completed our description of the seven

planetary principles of Occult philosophy, and will but add an outline view of the two remaining orbs, Uranus and Neptune. They belong to another octave.

The Planet Uranus. (♅)

Uranus, the mythological parent of Saturn, commences the first series of a higher round or cycle of celestial influence. His nature is that of Mercury upon a more interior plane, and that of Mars and Saturn combined upon the lower or physical plane. As Mercury is the first of the planets, Uranus is the eighth or octave expression of the first, consequently we can only properly observe the real influx of this planet upon the higher or mental plane. This fact must be carefully noted. When Uranus is dignified and well aspected at birth, he will act as a benefic, and *vice versa*. A great number of otherwise tolerably good artists of astral science, make a very serious mistake in taking this planet solely as a malefic.

Astrologically considered, the planet Uranus has not so far been able to exert his full power upon the human brain, except in rare instances. The age is not yet ripe for his influence. Comparatively few possess the necessary etherealization of "brain stuff" for this planet to fully express his action. These few are almost without exception to be found in the ranks of Occult science and spiritualism. The natives of Uranus are always ahead of their time. They are veritable reformers upon the plane they occupy in humanity. Their contempt for the conventionalities by which they find themselves surrounded, always

creates the active hostility of those who admire the forms, customs and opinions of "society." Consequently they have many bitter enemies. They are always persecuted by popular opinion and the leaders thereof. But the Uranian soul does not care for consequences. His dauntless, intrepid spirit acts with perfect independence. Under these circumstances, Uranus always becomes a disturbing force, amid shallow, false or purely artificial conditions of life. This only adds further proof, if that were necessary, that the age is not yet ripe for the full action of this weird and eccentric orb.

Upon the Intellectual Plane, Uranus rules the ideal sentiments and the imagination to a very great extent. Those dominated by his influx possess the most extraordinary abilities in special directions. They are real geniuses whose talents are so strange and erratic that they seldom, if ever, become appreciated. They are inventive, original, acute observers, possessing large perceptive and executive powers, but much given to roaming over the face of the earth, in other words, are Bohemians.

Upon the Physical Plane, Uranus tends to make the native an object of comment, and those under his influence are odd in their ways, very eccentric, and stubborn to the last degree. They are strongly argumentative and opinionated. What they say is to the point, and asserted with a startling amount of confidence. If well aspected and dignified, Uranus produces sudden wealth. Cases of unexpected wealth, from the poor-house to the millionaire, are exactly the style of Uranus. When evilly aspected, etc., then he

becomes malefic in the highest degree, and brings sudden reverses, quite as unexpected as his gains. Sudden failure, collapse of banks and other commercial squalls which bring down the rich to the condition of poverty, are generally due to Uranian influence. When Uranus afflicts the significator of marriage in the natus, or is located in the 7th, illicit connections are brought about both before and after the legal unions. This planet is the great significator of the Occult, and his influence never fails to produce mystics.

The Planet Neptune. (♆)

This planet is the most recently discovered of the primary planets, and constitutes the present "scientific frontier," so to say, of modern astronomy. But it is not the last. There are others still more remote, whose action upon the mental and nervous constitution of mankind, at present, is nil. Each orb becomes visible to our earth only when the planetary life which it evolves is susceptible to the action and re-action of its influx. But at present the influence of Neptune is very small, except upon certain organisms; therefore, we are not prepared for the revolutions of still more ethereal forces. As the race evolves higher susceptibilities, the influence of Uranus and Neptune will increase, and that of Mercury and Venus will wane. Neptune expresses all the higher qualities at present known to us.

Astrologically considered, Neptune is the octave expression of the planet Venus; consequently its influx relates to the affectional and emotional qualities. This love, how-

ever, is purely platonic, and at present ideal. The influence is mild and genial, but it possesses no power of the lower orb upon the vitality: consequently, is utterly powerless to sustain physical life when the Hyleg is afflicted either by position or direction. This must be borne in mind or serious error will occur in astro-delineations.

From what has been stated, it will be apparent to the reader that the present generation has very little affinity with such an ethereal influence; therefore, the chief points to watch are those wherein Neptune is located in the ascendant, mid-heaven, seventh and lower meridian. At these points, only, will the influx be strongly manifested, or, in other words, when the planet is "angular."

Upon the Intellectual Plane, Neptune controls the platonic spirit of Universal Brotherhood which, strangely enough, since the planet's visible manifestation has been so loudly preached and theoretically accepted, is practically absolutely ignored by those who are most clamorous for its general recognition. Those dominated by its influx are pleasant, agreeable, pure, simple and also romantic. They desire the simple arcadian life of the golden age. They sigh for all things in common; consequently, they are considered by modern thinkers impractical visionaries. The world of Neptune's influx is decidedly Utopian.

Upon the Physical Plane, this planet has but little influence in the present age. His aspects (when powerful) with the Sun and Moon, tend greatly towards the production of clairvoyance. If located in the ascendant, Neptune always produces large blue, dreamy-looking eyes. In fact the

eyes of such natives are the most conspicuous feature they possess. This position also confers a strong predilection for books of romance and an aversion to hard, dry, matter-of-fact science; also, strangely enough, such natives manifest an aversion to water. When located in the 10th, the native generally obtains some pleasant, easy position, such as private secretary to some nobleman or philosophical institution, where the duties are light and the salary more or less heavy in proportion to the absence of actual work. When in the 7th, such a position indicates a pleasant married life, and, if in aspect with the Moon, with a rather impractical partner. In the 4th, it is a testimony of a natural death.

The Lost Orb.()*

Strange as it may seem it is nevertheless a fact, that there is a missing planet. It has been allegorically expressed by Jesus as the prodigal son; by Moses as Abel; and by the prophets of the Scandinavian Edda as "Ragnarok." To our esoteric system there are ten celestial bodies somewhere, viz.: the Sun and nine planets. At present we have only nine in all. Where, then, is the lost one? The exalted adept alone can solve this problem. Suffice it to say, that it symbolizes the missing soul within the human constitution. Pushed out of the line of march by disturbing forces this orb became, for a time, the prey of disruptive action and ultimately lost form, and is now a mass of fragments. The ring of planetoids between the orbits of Mars and Jupiter, indicates to us the empty throne

of Abel, whom Cain (Mars) slew in his anger. The time will ultimately come when this orb will be re-constituted, and Abel will rise up from the dead. Until that time the missing soul will seek its physical mate in vain, except in rare cases. When this day shall arrive, the Utopia of Neptune and the Millennium of St. John will begin upon earth. May that time speedily arrive !

Each planetary chain consists of seven active orbs and three latents. When one becomes latent another becomes active. Remember this occult fact. **THEY CORRESPOND TO THE TEN SEPHIROTH OF THE KAB-BALAH.**

CHAPTER X.

THE PRACTICAL APPLICATION OF THE SCIENCE OF THE STARS.

The next branch of this celestial science which requires our notice, is the practical application of the various laws, principles and influences in their direct relation to man and his material destiny. Therefore, we will first present a brief outline of the scientific basis, so to say, upon which the action and inter-action of stellar influences repose, and then offer a few concluding words of general advice.

The magnetic polarity of any given geographical point of our earth's surface is changing every moment. This continual changing in the earth is accompanied by a corresponding change in the electric and more ethereal vital currents of the atmosphere. Both these varying conditions

are caused, primarily, by the diurnal motion of the earth upon its axis from west to east, which causes the whole heavens to transit the visible horizon from east to west during the space of one natural day—24 hours. The secondary causes are the various motions and aspects of the Sun, Moon and planets as they relate to the positions of the earth in her annual orbit about the Sun. The primary basis, the diurnal motion of the planet, claims our attention first. We will, therefore, briefly examine its nature and philosophy.

The real motions of the earth are the only motions that have any real influence upon the physical organism of the earth's inhabitants. These motions determine the length of the day, measure out to us the proportion of light and darkness, regulate the seasons, and fix with the hand of fate, the exact duration of the year. All these have a manifest influence upon the organism of man.

As our mother earth revolves upon her axis, the whole of the celestial heavens seem to rise, culminate and set upon every portion of her surface. Though this rising and setting is only an appearance, so far as the heavens are concerned, it is absolutely real to the earth's inhabitants, because the influences, as they transit the earth from east to west, are exactly the same as if the earth was the stationary center of our solar system, and the heavens were revolving around it.

The varying conditions of the astral and magnetic forces are caused by the various angles, at which, in their apparent motions, the stellar influx is reflected to any given

point of the earth. For instance, the conditions at sunrise are practically different from the conditions prevailing at noon when the Sun is shining upon the meridian. At sunset we see another wonderful difference manifested, possessing nothing in common with either noon or sunrise. Then, again, we have the midnight state of the earth and the atmosphere in which the conditions are the polar opposite of those in force at noon. These cardinal points of the day indicate the greatest changes, but, as a matter of course, these changes from one to the other are gradual. To measure this gradual angular change the ancient astrologers divided that space of the heavens visible at any moment into six houses or mansions, as they termed them, and the opposite or invisible arc into the same number, making twelve in all, designated as the diurnal and nocturnal houses of the heavens. Modern astrologers follow out the same principles, because, being founded upon the rock of absolute truth, their influence can be verified in every correctly calculated horoscope, when the plane occupied by the native is taken into consideration.

These twelve houses contain, like the signs of the Zodiac, 30° of space each, but unlike them their distance is measured by degrees of right ascension, or time, instead of celestial longitude. This is the only real relation existing between the twelve houses and the twelve signs. The various symbolical relations between the two, such as Aries being the regent of the first mansion and so on, possess no influence or importance in the practical application of the

science, but pertain to the realm of Kabbalistical mythology.

If the reader will draw a circle three inches in diameter, and then in the center of this a smaller circle about one inch in diameter, he will possess two mathematical ideas in objective form. The smaller circle will represent the earth, the larger one the heaven around it. If we now divide the larger circle into quadrants, we shall see the angles which represent the four cardinal points of the day, and, upon a more extensive scale, the seasons of the year. These are no mere fanciful ideas, but they are external symbols of living realities upon the external plane of phenomena. If the reader will now divide the larger circle into twelve equal parts, he will possess another outline chart representing the twelve houses of the heavens, with the earth in the center. The horizontal line upon the left represents the eastern horizon or the point, in reference to the earth, which is occupied by the sun at sunrise. The perpendicular line above the horizon, marking off one quadrant of the circle, represents the zenith or meridian occupied, at noon, by the sun in its daily transit. Now between these two points, the horizon and the meridian, we have two angular lines which divide the quadrant of 90° into three parts containing 30° each. These are the two south-eastern houses which mark off the angular changes of solar and astral influx between sunrise and noon. The horizontal line opposite to and parallel with the line of the horizon, shows that point of the heavens which is occupied by the sun, in reference to the earth at sunset, and the two angular lines

between it and the meridian indicate the changes of terrestrial and celestial conditions between noon and sunset. Thus, in the space of the day time, the sun, stars and planets (if there should be any situated in that part of the heavens) have made the transit of the diurnal arc of six houses. During this time every conceivable change of polarity that is possible under solar influx has been manifested upon the earth, and thousands of human beings have been ushered into physical existence, each and all differing more or less widely from each other, according to the influence dominant at the exact moment of mortal birth. It is needless to repeat this description with the six nocturnal houses: it is similar—the perpendicular line opposite the zenith is the lower meridian where the sun is situated at midnight; then, still moving forward in its ceaseless round, the sun arrives upon the horizon again, at sunrise, to commence another day. In order to give a clearer idea of this than words can possibly convey, we insert a diagram which explains itself. We have only to add in this connection, that the earth is divided into positive and negative halves, which are continually changing from one to the other; the half under the sun's rays is always positive; that portion under the shades of evening is negative. Day and night then, like the sun and moon, are the polar opposites of each other, and so are the individuals born under the two conditions.

From the foregoing, it will be seen that any number of individuals, born during the course of a single day, at different times, will differ widely in their physical temperament and mental bias. Not only so, but they will differ

equally as widely in their fortunes and destiny. Herein, then, we see the grand basic principles of this science, which accounts, in a most philosophical manner, for the wonderful diversity in human beings, so that scarcely any two are alike either in mind, form or feature, because no two are born at exactly the same moment of time, under exactly the same position of the heavens. For instance, suppose one hundred children in different parts of the world were born at the same precise moment of time, the difference in the latitude and longitude of their respective birth-places would render it probable that no two would be alike; because of the different aspects presented by the heavens to different portions of the globe at exactly the same moment. The reader has only to bear in mind that it is sunrise, noon, sunset and midnight every moment at some point on the earth, in order to realize the great natural difference that exists between those who are born at the same moment of time in different parts of the world.

The secondary causes which regulate and modify the astral and planetary influx are the apparent motions of the sun, moon and planets in their orbits, as they either approach each other or recede. As before stated, it is the real motion of a planet which affects its inhabitants; therefore we need not repeat the reasons we have already given. When our earth is so situated as to appear to an observer in the sun to be moving through Cancer, the sun appears, to the inhabitants on earth, to be passing through the opposite sign, Capricorn, and so far as the earth is concerned it really is, because the solar center stands between the earth

and the sign, and the solar influx is, consequently, impregnated with the magnetic qualities of Capricorn, with which it permeates the earth. Hence, when we speak of the influence of the sun in Capricorn or any other sign, though only an astronomical appearance, we mean exactly what we say. Further, when the earth by its progressive motion moves faster or slower in a different direction from other planets and causes them to become alternately stationary, direct in motion or retrograde, we know that these are purely appearances, so far as the planets themselves are concerned, but their influx is just the same on earth as if it were a reality; because the real movements of our earth place them in those positions in reference to the apparent position of the sun. The various angular distances so formed, termed aspects, are so potent in their magnetic effects, that sometimes the whole good or evil influx of a given planet is completely polarized by them, and, almost always, these aspects are found to constitute very important factors in the native's horoscope.

The reader will perceive from the foregoing statement of astral principles, that in order to properly gauge and apply the actual influences in operation at a person's nativity, two primary considerations are necessary, viz.: the time and place of a person's physical birth. Without these nothing reliable can be scientifically determined. And any system of astral, planetary or solar influences, that pretends to determine the celestial influences upon man, which ignores these essential elements, is thoroughly inaccurate, if not utterly misleading.

Before concluding these brief remarks upon the basis of this science, we would point out the fact, for the benefit of some of our readers, that ancient astrology is not, as so many seem to think, "an exploded science," and, further, we wish to point out another very important fact, viz.: that not a single individual can be found who talks or writes of this astrological explosion who himself understands the fundamental principles of the science he is defaming. Many superficially learned individuals think that the old geocentric system of Claudius Ptolemy was the only foundation upon which the ancient astrology rested, and that when the present Newtonian system overturned the Ptolemaic theory of a "primum mobile," the astrology of the ancients was buried amid the ruins. We need scarcely add that such superficial minds are in sad need of a little true light. The observed effects of certain positions of the heavens, be they apparent or real, is the only foundation of judicial astrology, and it was upon the continuous observations of ages that the old Chaldean sages formulated their wonderful science of the stars. The eclipses of the Sun and Moon, conjunctions of the planets, and the exact length of the solar year, were all correctly computed ages before the days of Abraham. In reality, it makes little difference to astrology whether the earth moves about the Sun or the Sun about the earth, for it rests upon the absolute fact that one of them does indeed move.

So far as the physical organism of man is concerned, the planet which gave it birth is its center and the focus of all celestial influences; hence, the earth and its motions are

the only ones of vital importance upon the material plane. We would point out to all would-be heliocentric astrologers who desire to formulate special "solar" systems of planetary influence for themselves, that the whole basis of their systems rests upon a mere question of terms, and is as much an appearance as the geocentric conception. The orbits of the planets of our solar system are so small and insignificant compared with the inconceivable distances of the constellations, that to say that a planet is in any particular sign or constellation, is nothing but asserting that which is only an appearance. It is only removing the point of observation from the earth to the Sun. Both are optical illusions, but in this removal the illusion is intensified. What are the signs of the Zodiac but apparent lines and apparent spaces? They certainly have nothing to do with the real constellations of the heavens at the present day. Nevertheless, their influence is a demonstrated fact. These signs are nothing more nor less than angular distances in the heavens which mark off the increase and decrease of the solar influx upon the northern and southern hemisphere of the earth. Surely, then, the system which adopts one series of appearances is very incomplete that does not include the whole, embracing a map of the heavens. Away, then, forever with this pseudo-scientific sentimentalism which speaks so much of realities, when in the very truth it is embracing nothing but an aggregation of shadows and appearances.

It is utterly impossible, within the limits of the present work, to give the various mathematical details which

constitute the external and purely practical department of the science. This omission, however, is not of any serious importance, as the whole formula of exoteric astrology can be thoroughly studied out by each interested reader for himself from the numerous books published upon the subject. To guide the student of this science, we will say that "The Dictionary of Astrology," by James Wilson, and "The Text Book of Astrology," vol. I, by A. J. Pearce, are among the very finest works extant.

Our advice to any one commencing the serious study of "The Science of the Stars," is: to carefully read and re-read the works just referred to; then master the mathematical and mechanical details; thirdly, make yourself familiar with the various aspects, characters, etc., of the planets, and, lastly, study closely the occult laws and esoteric principles relating thereto as given in this work. When this course of study is completed, you may commence experiments by erecting the horoscopes of yourself and friends, and note how far the observed results agree with your astrological deductions. If this advice is followed out, you cannot go very far wrong; for it is upon the full realization of the occult and philosophical principles underlying this external formula that a real knowledge of astrology consists. It is this absolute knowledge of the stars that always distinguishes the true artist from the astrological pretender, and "fortune telling" impostor. It is these latter charlatans who, by their unprincipled methods and villainy, have caused the very name of astrology to become the synonym of superstition and fraud in the eyes of

nineteenth century intelligence. So different are the people and the conditions which surround them from those who lived in the days of old when the wise men of Chaldea inspected the beautiful constellations of heaven, and learned therefrom the mighty secrets of the soul's origin and destiny as well as the material details of their physical lives. The same book of nature is open now as then, but only the pure in heart can read its pages and trace the mystical chain of life from nature through the stars to nature's God.

THE SOUL AND THE STARS.

The beautiful, twinkling, glittering stars,
The rivals in splendor of Venus and Mars,
They come and they go,
Moulding the powers of our weal or our woe.

Shining serene in the heavens above,
Nightly teaching us lessons of love,
No discords nor jars
Appear to disturb these beautiful stars.

The soul seems to claim these jewels on high,
And struggles to soar to its source in the sky.
But sorrow and pain
Are the pathways that carry it homeward again.

How oft have we dreamed, when gazing above,
That the purified soul—the offspring of love,
When freed from earth's load,
Would find in the stars its peaceful abode.

So fondly we think of our homes in the sky,
Joined with the soul for whose presence we sigh;
Where Saturn nor Mars
Can embitter our joys mid the beautiful stars.

CONCLUSION.

THE MYSTICAL CHAIN; OR, THE UNION OF THE SOUL AND STARS.

As the soul unfolds in true spiritual light, the manifest unity between man and his divine source, also between man and the myriad creations of the infinite universe, becomes a self evident and absolute fact. But, unfortunately, the undeveloped soul sees none of these great facts of unity and identity, nor perceives the vital relations existing between the soul and the stars. The facts of the one seem to him totally irrelevant to the facts of the other; while, on the other hand, to the initiated seer, a true knowledge of the soul is impossible without a perfect understanding of the stars. Equally, are the stars incomprehensible, apart from the soul. Man, the microcosm, is in himself a miniature universe, composed of infinite atoms, which are, in a constant state of action and re-action, not only among themselves, but also with the infinite atoms of the larger universe, the macrocosm. Hence, a true science of the soul cannot be founded which does not also include a true science of the stars. It also follows, that deductions based upon a comprehension of these higher relations, which are self evident to the seer, will appear to the ordinary undeveloped human being as quite irrational and illogical, since the premises are to him incongruous and unrelated. With such all efforts at enlightenment are quite futile in the present state of evolution, but for those souls struggling to awake to the

higher truths of their existence and destiny, this conclusion is added to help them to grasp this grand union of the soul and the stars, this mystical chain which binds the infinite multiplicity into unity, as well as diversity into identity.

We have, therefore, to regard man in a somewhat different light from that in which we have hitherto considered him, viz., we have now to behold him as a grand, intelligent, spirito-material center for the expression of astro-celestial forces upon the internal and external planes of God's universe. Man, broadly speaking, is a duplex mirror, reflecting the stellar forces in two directions: 1st., the astral influx from his body to the planes below humanity; 2d., the finer ethereal essences of the stars from his soul to the aerial races in the spheres above. The first comprises seven degrees of sub-mundane life, from man to the mineral, forming as it were a lower octave of existence; the second is the ascending scale, or the higher octave of existence, containing seven degrees of super-mundane life between man and the angel. These seven degrees of super-mundane existence are the aerial races of bright, immortal souls, the spiritual superiors of humanity, in so far as concerns the realms they inhabit,* and the more etherealized conditions which surround them. But, on the other hand, they are very much inferior to man, both in spiritual quality, soul power and penetrative force, and are utterly incapable of entering upon the physical struggles of external life; hence

*These are the planetary angels mentioned in the Ritual of divine magic. Planetary angels do not exist upon the various objective planets, as so many occultists imagine, but in the series of seven spheres between the planets and the sun.

they are a purely subjective race, and are never incarnated in matter (as we understand the term). They depend upon the more positive spirit of humanity (which alone is capable of entering and subjecting material forces) for all their knowledge of external conditions.

The first degree consists of those souls who have the most penetrative force next to man, and are consequently nearest to our physical conditions. Each degree in the ascending scale becomes less potent (materially), more ethereal and refined, until it blends in the seventh with the purely spiritual or angelic world.

In the lower octave of existence, viz., the seven degrees of sub-mundane life, countless beautiful worlds are open to the inspection of the spiritual sight. We will briefly recount what we ourselves have witnessed therein, as we speak of each degree.

The first degree is that of the crystallized mineral in which the life atoms are latent, so to say. The rocks and stones are of both sexes, and impregnate each other with their magnetic forces. Their sympathies and antipathies constitute their laws of natural selection, which we see manifested externally by the vegetation they produce from their soil. The second degree pertains to the subjective spaces of the mineral world. The busy races within the higher rounds of the mineral zone (the *anima mineralis*), are beautiful in every detail, each life atom busy at its appointed task, happy beyond conception in its lowly spiritual state. As yet the scintillating monad knows nothing of the greater worlds above. To it the mineral

waves are the alpha and omega of its ideas. The third degree of life passes in review as the vegetable kingdom of which sufficient is already known to the reader. The higher we go the brighter the little creatures become. When we ascend to the fourth degree of life we behold the loveliest scenes that fairyland can present to the eyes of the seer. The exquisite form and the variety of these dazzling elemental sprites are beyond human language to describe. Each vortex or space of the *anima floralis* constitutes a veritable paradise of beauty, a wondrous world of delights in which the nymphs of the flowers and the bright fairies of the floral world sport like butterflies in the luminous ether of their round. The fifth degree passes before us as the animal kingdom. The sixth degree of life expresses itself as the semi-human round, the external correspondence of which may be seen in the ape family;* a world in which the soul begins to put forth its attributes of self-consciousness, a realm wherein the struggling monad gathers together the results of past sub-mundane victories, and prepares to graduate to that higher life round wherein it may commence to assume the human form. The seventh degree of life is the embryonic human round; a spiritual zone or soul world wherein exists the multitudes of prepared souls awaiting the conditions of their final incarnation. It is the realm of anxious expectations and glowing ideals of what external

*This realm of sub mundane life contains the astral world of the apes. It is these astral forms that are used by certain magicians (after the human principle has vacated them) for occult purposes. They become the trained elementals of magical science. Their chief quality is imitation, and under the influence of their master's mind they will personate anything, from an angel of light to a goblin damned.

human life may be. It is from this state or degree of life that the human soul takes its last plunge into objective material conditions, from which it emerges to the surface as the self acting, self conscious, individual man.

Let us now briefly turn our attention from man to the planet which he inhabits, and trace the correspondence. The planet, like the man, may be designated as a duplex mirror, reflecting stellar and planetary influx in two directions: 1st., to the various realms of elemental existence (corresponding to sub-mundane life) termed cosmic elementals belonging to the four occult elements of Fire, Earth, Air and Water; 2nd., to the astro-magnetic zones of the planet (corresponding to the super-mundane realms) termed magnetic elementals. The magnetic elementals are intelligent spirits known by various names, such as fairies, fauns, elves, nymphs, etc. One very important distinction must be noticed here between sub-mundane and super-mundane realms on the one hand, and cosmic elementals and magnetic elementals on the other hand, viz., that the two former are various degrees of human soul life, hence possess the germs of immortality when the human state is attained; while the two latter are not souls, and although they depend upon the soul of man for their differentiated existence, yet they do not derive their supply of sustenance from him, but from the latent forces of each orb of the planetary chain within the planet; hence they live only so long as the planet is able to sustain them. Therefore they are not immortal. When the planet has fulfilled its material purpose, they,

along with the orb which gave them life, become a thing of the past.

We have now reached a most important link in our mystical chain, viz.: since embodied man is the highest form of manifested existence upon the planet, he is the grand polarizing point for all four of the forms of existence we have been describing. The human organism is, therefore, the grand radiating center upon which the two vast realms, stellar and psychic, impinge and is the material link uniting the soul and the stars. Thus in very truth is man the microcosm, and the sacred adytum of the mysteries.

In order to render this more manifest, let us now endeavor to form as clear an idea as possible of the nature and *modus operandi* of stellar influx as transmitted to man from our solar system; for when we comprehend that portion of the mystical chain, then we can form some faint conception of the continued and unbroken chain which binds our solar system to other systems and constellations, on and on to the very interior of the soul of the universe. First, then, stands our Sun, and around it, like a group of obedient children, are the seven planets of the mystical chain,* each orb giving birth to an entirely different degree of life, so that the seven mystical degrees are completed. Each orb produces innumerable types of fauna and flora corresponding to the action of its own peculiar grade of spiritual force. Each, therefore, comprises a miniature universe of its own, and yet, at the same time, each planet contains all

*There are more than seven planets in the solar system, but only seven in each octave of life.

the forces of the other six, only that these six forces are latent in so far as to lend all their force for the more complete manifestation of the dominating one. Hence it follows that our earth contains, in addition to its own dominating degree of life, the latent forces of the various grades of life active upon the other planets, so that Mars, Venus, Mercury, etc., are here with us just as much as they are in the far off spaces. Herein is contained the great mystery of planetary influence upon man, for man, as before stated, is the highest type of life upon the globe, and becomes the great radiator of the different grades of life of the seven planets comprised within the one he inhabits. His sensitive sphere becomes the means of arousing countless races of astro-magnetic elementals into life and motion, and also into obedient servitude if he only possesses the knowledge; for each grade of planetary influx renders service and protection to the corresponding grade of men. Thus Mars to the martial natures, Saturn to the saturnine, and Jupiter to the jovial, and so forth. The interior secrets of the talisman and the mysteries of magic are concealed here, and the portals are open for the soul's exploration. This, also, is the philosophic basis for the various statements that certain planets rule certain soul attributes, mental qualities, physical instincts, classes of animals, plants, herbs, trees, minerals, precious stones, etc.

The reader who has followed us thus far, is now invited to join us in a short trip to the astral world and there behold man as he presents himself to the vision of the seer. A most wondrous and dazzling picture is before us, un-

dreamed of mysteries connected with the human form divine. Let us examine more closely. First we observe that from the spinal column of the stately form of man, and from the base of his luminous brain, issue living streams of vitalizing force which, as they flow from the various points of his odylic sphere, become refracted into the seven rays of the spectrum. These rays of living force from different individuals, become mutually attracted toward each other, each color blends with its kindred color from other organisms and gravitates to its own particular level in the prismatic ocean of life, until the whole of this mighty planet, with its millions of human beings scattered over its throbbing surface, presents to the eye of the initiated seer a perfect network of luminous springs, creeks, rivers and oceans of force flowing from the radiating organism of man. We also observe that these luminous oceans gradually assume the form of a spiral belt which encircles the planet—penetrating to its very center, and then expands itself, mist-like, within the planet's atmosphere where a prismatic reflection is cast around the earth, constituting a sort of astral rainbow (if we may use such a term), which is strictly confined within the limits of the planet's gaseous envelope. This prismatic reflection is the astro-magnetic sphere wherein are formed the astral zones of the magnetic elementals of planetary influx, to which we have previously referred as forming the grand mystical links in the chain of life which binds the organism of man to the soul of the stars.

So far we have only beheld our human duplex mirror

from the spinal column and the base of the brain as he reflects the astral influx from his body to the lower octave of life termed sub-mundane; we will now, therefore, regard the other half, or polar opposite surface of our duplex mirror, wherein the stellar forces are reflected from the soul to the higher octave of life, the realms of super-mundane beings.

We first observe that the odylic sphere of man, which forms the oval surface of our living mirror, is constantly polished by the vivid lightnings of the immortal soul within; next, we see that the forces reflected from it are received directly from above in an angle to the left of the sphere, and that, after passing through and leaving one portion to sustain the form and its functions, and also another portion to be radiated to the sub-mundane planes, then the higher and more ethereal principles undergo a change of polarity and are reflected upward again in an angle to the right of the sphere, to the aerial races of super-mundane life. Let us now, therefore, enter within the occult spaces of humanity upon this spiritual plane, and describe the phenomena as it passes in review before our spiritual sight.

We perceive that from the millions of earth's inhabitants there issue continual rays of reflected light, each ray partaking of the peculiar color represented by the soul from which it is reflected. As these rays ascend, they converge into streams and oceans within the astral light above the planet's atmosphere (whereas the former astral belt, just described, was confined within the limits of the planet's

atmosphere). All of these luminous oceans of etherealized light seek their own plane and maintain a strict relation to each other with the mathematical exactitude of the solar spectrum. We also notice that these oceans flow in one continual direction, viz.: in the opposite direction to the orbital motion of the earth. They flow backward in the orbit.* But in so doing they gradually ascend, assuming the spiral form: the first round being about the same circumference as the earth's annual orbit about the Sun, but increasing in size with each spiral in the ratio of 1-2. 4-8. 16-32-64. These spirals assume their own special color, commencing first with that which is nearest to the earth, which is Red; the second, Orange; the third, Yellow; the fourth, Green; the fifth, Blue; the sixth, Indigo; and the last, Violet. What there may be beyond this we cannot tell. All that we do know is, that it is the realm of the angels. These spirals, which we have just described constitute mighty zones,† which encircle an ethereal sphere or world of the same identical color,‡ similar to the bright rings round the body of Saturn. These spheres are the seven

*The writer cannot be positive upon this point, as these are his own actual experiences, and are related here as they actually appeared to him in the realms of spirit. It may be that this backward motion is only an appearance caused by the earth moving forward, just as the landscape from the window of a car in motion appears to the occupant to be moving.

†The clairvoyant medium, Andrew Jackson Davis, undoubtedly saw these beautiful etherealized zones when he described "the summer land" in his "Stellar Key." But he was quite mistaken in supposing them to be the homes of disembodied humanity. As the reader has seen, they are inhabited by aerial races who cannot penetrate the outer envelope of crystalized force, called objective matter.

‡We need scarcely add that these are the seven graduated spirit worlds between the earth and the Sun, constituting the chain previously mentioned.

etherealized worlds which form the subjective arc between the planet and its parent center—man and the angel.

Still gazing at this sublime panorama of nature's wonderful formations within the spiritual spaces of the astral light, we perceive that these astro-spiritual zones or belts contain the etherealized materials and essences of earth which sustain the external life forces of the aerial races who inhabit these glorious worlds. The first world, as we have previously shown, is nearest to our physical conditions and absorbs the coarsest portions. The next, being more ethereal, absorbs the next in spiritual quality. The finer the essence, the higher it ascends, so that the most ethereal of all reaches the confines of the angelic world, and diffuses its violet aromas within the spaces that are divine. As we perceive this fact we instantly comprehend the grand connection of the whole. MAN stands upon the central rung of the cyclic ladder as the meeting point of the equilibrium between the upper and the lower manifestations of the great ONE LIFE. In him lies concealed the sacred mystery of the lost word. He is the wonderful microcosm. By his duplex action of body and soul he becomes the grand conservator, generator, and radiator of spiritual and material life forces; first, absorbing the currents of the life wave, then separating it into its triune qualities; retaining one, then re-polarizing and transmitting the grosser portions in the form of an asuro-magnetic fluid to the planes of life below, and reflecting, from the mirror of his soul, in the form of an astro-spiritual essence, the finer and more ethereal portions of the realms above. What awful and un-

suspected mysteries lie concealed within our being! Verily, no mind can grasp all the mysteries of man.

Reader, the oceans of purified life essence, forming these spiral zones of the interior heavens which extend from the celestial worlds to the earth, from angel to man, and then which extend in a grosser form to our planet's very center, is the mystical chain of the great one life that unites man to all below him and binds him to the immortal realms above. It is the spiral cycle of necessity traversed by the life atoms in their descent into matter, and their ascent into the realms of conscious spiritual existence. It is the spiral cord of nature whose vibrations throughout the wide universe of manifested being, proclaim the unbroken union between the soul and the stars. The same yesterday, to-day and forever.

The mysteries of man are the mysteries of God, and who can solve them here? The soul answereth, "none." So be it.

In conclusion, we will only add that as a child of God, or the crystallization of force—as a spiritual entity, or a thing of dust—man's birth-right is ever the same, a progressive conscious immortality. He is the sustainer of universes below, of which even occultists have scarcely dreamed, and he is the generator of the essences which sustain the life of myriads in brighter worlds than ours.

FINIS.

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